

ARMY GROUP
INSURANCE FUND



AGI

JOURNAL

Volume XXXIX Issue April 2024



ECONOMY

FINANCE

INSURANCE

FINANCIAL PLANNING

FINANCIAL SECURITY

POST RETIREMENT CONNECT

FORTY EIGHT YEARS OF SERVICE

1976 - 2024

सरहद से आशियाँ तक

Welfare Schemes

House Building Advance

Conveyance Advance

Personal Computer Advance

Social Security Deposit

Loan Insurance

Advance Withdrawal from Maturity Benefits

Sustenance Allowance to Differently Abled Children

Ex Gratia Disability Allowance to Severely Disabled



SERVING PERSONNEL

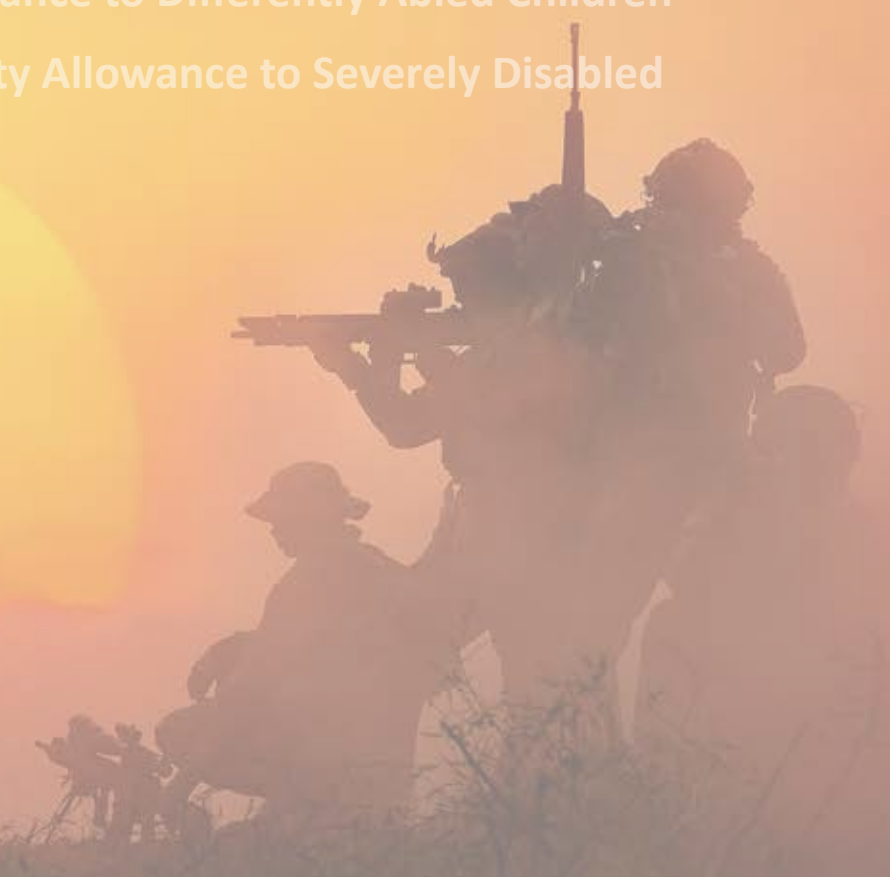
INSURANCE

MATURITY

LOANS

RETIRED PERSONNEL

EXTENDED INSURANCE





AGI Journal

VOLUME XXXIX ISSUE APRIL 2024

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CONTENTS



46



82



35



32



99

04 Message from the COAS

05 Foreword

06 MD's Desk

07 Chief Editor

08 AGIF: Boards and Committees

AGI Matters

10 Newsletter

16 Nomination: A vital action for seamless disbursement of insurance benefits

20 AGIF documents to Disburse Loans: Is it genuinely cumbersome

22 Role of Units and Records in Assisting AGIF to Discharge its Responsibilities

Economic & Money Matters

29 India's Economic Roadmap

32 Don't Bet Against India! The Best is yet to Come!

35 Indian Stock Market Growth Story: Should you Believe?

46 Personal Investment and Management by Individuals

49 Financial Freedom: A Practical Journey for Every Indian

52 Planning for Life's Financial Goals with Mutual Funds

54 Exchange Traded Funds: A Powerful Investment Vehicle

56 Mutual Funds and New Fund Offerings (NFO)

59 Prudent Investments After Retirement

61 Multi Asset Allocation Strategy

63 Don't Let These Common Misconceptions on Investing Sway You!

65 Mere Sapnon Ka Ghar A pragmatic guide to real estate investment for Indian Army soldiers

71 Taxation in India and Ways to Optimise Tax

77 Liberty From Loan Trap: Strategies for Achieving Financial Freedom

82 How to Protect Long Term Savings from Inflation and NPS

Hindi Section

91 Hindi Newsletter

99 सेना समूह बीमा निधि (एजीआईएफ) की मूल बातें समझना

102 आर्मी ग्रुप इन्श्योरेंस फंड से परिपक्वता (मैच्युरिटी से पूर्व) अग्रिम (एडवांस) मैच्युरिटी राशि निकासी के नुकसान

General Section

111 Army Welfare Placement Organisation (AWPO)

113 Welfare Schemes: Adjutant General's Branch

116 Directorate of Indian Army Veterans (DIAV)

118 Safeguarding Against Emerging Cyber Threats and Financial Frauds

123 Understanding Wills: A Quick Guide



Message



Gen Manoj Pande,
PVSM, AVSM, VSM, ADC
Chief of Army Staff

The prevailing geo-political situation across the globe presents an unprecedented set of challenges. Escalation of ongoing conflicts could have adverse globe repercussions on commodity and financial markets, as well as on trade and commerce.

Inspite of a turbulent geo-economic scenario, the Indian economy has emerged as a beacon of hope. With strong macro-economic fundamentals, improved consumer affluence, rising aspirations of the people and Government's watch over fiscal prudence, India is poised to grow economically, during the next decade.

Navigating successfully through such complex and challenging financial landscape, the Army Group Insurance Fund (AGIF) has displayed astute financial acumen and professionally managed the hard-earned money of our soldiers, to consistently deliver promised returns. Over the last five decades, AGIF has provided comprehensive risk cover while acting as the bedrock of financial security, for its members and their dependents. The issues discussed and analysed in this Journal are clear pointers of the right direction and focus of AGIF, towards ensuring continued monetary guarantees. My compliments to Team AGIF and best wishes for future endeavours.

'Jai Hind'

(Manoj Pande)
General
COAS



Foreword



Lt Gen C Bansi Ponnappa,
PVSM, AVSM, VSM
Adjutant General,
Chairman
Army Group Insurance Fund

The recent digital transformation, evolving people's expectations, global geo-economics and volatile market conditions leading to greater risks for investments are all immense challenges to the insurance and investment banking sectors.

The Army Group Insurance Fund (AGIF) research desk has remained constantly updated on the emerging situations and thus better prepared to respond to emerging threats. The AGIF has also adeptly traversed through risk ridden markets and adapted to changing situations to provide higher returns to all ranks while further improving its schemes.

The canvas covered by the Journal comprehensively highlights most of the major challenges to nations, institutions and individuals alike. The relevant, concise and focused issues analysed in this Journal by the established names in the financial industry aim at providing the Indian Army officers and soldiers a peek into Economy and Finance with emphasis on personal financial planning, both during service and post retirement. I am sanguine that the readers will find this Journal most useful and engaging.

My compliments to the Editorial Team for bringing out a fine compilation of interesting articles.

Jai Hind !

(C Bansi Ponnappa)
Lt Gen
AG



From the Managing Director's Desk



**Maj Gen S Kemparaj,
SM, VSM (Retd)
Managing Director
Army Group Insurance Fund**

The year gone by has only added to geo strategic and political uncertainties. Consequently, markets across the globe remain volatile and unfriendly to investors. Robust tax collections in India along with the Government's resolve towards fiscal prudence has exacerbated the situation for Indian investments.

However, under the astute guidance of our esteemed IAC members and backed by a sound research team, AGIF has consistently exploited market opportunities to invest across diverse asset classes to provide the promised returns even while ensuring maximum safety of investments. Conforming to schemes based on the rising aspirations of all members, it has leveraged modern technology and embraced industry's best practices to enhance efficiency, simplify processes and maximise returns.

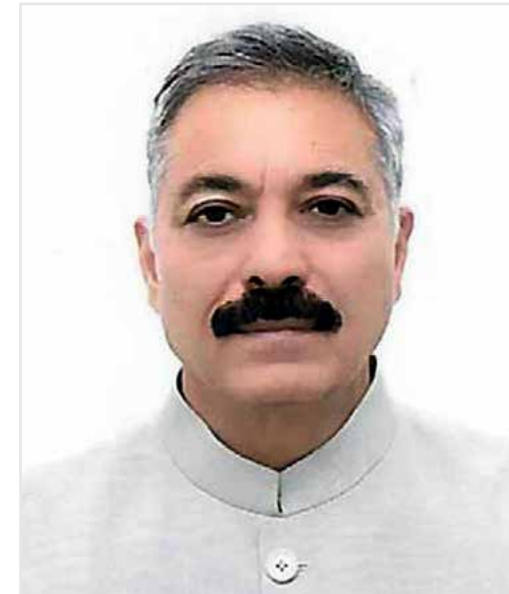
Aligned to AGIF's constant research, the canvas covered by the Journal 2024 shall keep the reader updated on current and new initiatives taken by the AGIF. It provides our soldiers a relevant, reliable and customised platform for providing an insight into the realm of the financial world with due emphasis on personal financial management, both during and after service. The readers shall, without doubt find the valuable articles, sourced from the captains of the financial industry, extremely interesting and informative.

Happy Reading.

Jai Hind !

(S Kemparaj)
Maj Gen (Retd)
MD, AGIF

Chief Editor



**Brig Subhash Yadav (Retd)
Principal Director Administration
& Secretary
Army Group Insurance Fund**

Dear Readers,

We are back with yet another stimulating Edition of AGI Journal, April 2024. Our previous publication evoked a hearty response from our diversified reader base that spans across Armed Forces, Veterans, government departments, industry and finance markets. Encouraged by your appreciation and in our attempt to bring something for everyone, we have endeavoured to compile valuable insights into economy, finance and personal investment domains authored by accomplished professionals in respective fields. I am sanguine that their profound knowledge and experience will bring about some rich perspectives through well articulated articles in 'Economic & Money Matters' Section.

AGI Journal also serves as a platform to keep our soldiers updated on current and new initiatives by AGIF and other sister organisations engaged in their financial well being and welfare. With this as an objective, other sections; AGI Matters, Hindi Section and General Section, are focused to provide relevant, reliable and customised information on matters closely related to these aspects.

I acknowledge the stellar contribution of our accomplished authors in fulfilling the objectives of this Journal. I also express my gratitude to others whose articles could not be accommodated in this Edition solely due to paucity of space. We continue to look forward to your support and guidance.

Wishing you a thought provoking journey

Jai Hind !

(Subhash Yadav)
Brig (Retd)
PDAS



AGIF: BOARDS AND COMMITTEES

Policy Making

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Jt Dir, AGI (EMI)
Secretary



ARMY GROUP INSURANCE FUND

Benefits Offered

BY VARIOUS SCHEMES

AGIF is a compulsory Group Insurance cum saving scheme designed to fulfill the objectives of providing

- Life insurance cover to Army personnel against all risks including war/ warlike situations, while in service.
- Lump sum maturity benefits on retirement/ release/ discharge to facilitate financial well-being.

Apportionment of Monthly Subscriptions and Benefits.

Category	Monthly Subscriptions			Benefits	
	Savings Element (₹)	Risk Element (₹)	Total (₹)	Savings Element	Risk Element
Regular Army				Provides lump sum maturity benefits on superannuation/ retirement/ discharge	Provides insurance cover & disability* benefits
Officers	8,722.00	1,278.00	10,000/- pm		Insurance- 1 Crore Disability - 25 Lakh
JCOs/ Other Ranks	4,440.00	560.00	5,000/- pm		Insurance- 50 Lakh Disability- 12.5 Lakh
Army Postal Service (Deputation)					
Officers	3,762.50	1,427.50	5,190/- pm		Insurance- 75 Lakh Disability- 25 Lakh
JCOs/ Other Ranks	1,867.50	657.50	2,525/- pm		Insurance- 37.5 Lakh Disability- 12.5 Lakh
Territorial Army					
Officers	38,244.00	9,756.00	48,000/- pa		Insurance- 50 Lakh Disability - 15 Lakh
JCOs/ Other Ranks	20,118.00	3,882.00	24,000/- pa		Insurance- 25 Lakh Disability- 7.5 Lakh
Defence Security Corps					
JCOs/ Other Ranks	1,646.50	943.50	2,590/- pm		Insurance- 37.5 Lakh Disability - 12.5 Lakh

*Disability amount indicated is for 100% disability and reduced proportionately up till disability of 20%. Applicable only to those who are invalidated out of service by Invalidment Medical Board (IMB) & who are not in receipt of any pension. Policy applicable with effect from 01 May 2018.

Cadets

- In Receipt of Stipend.** Same as Regular Army Officers.
- Not in Receipt of Stipend.**

Member	Subscription	Insurance Cover (₹)	Disability Cover (₹)	Remarks
Cadets of NDA, AFMC and TES (CME, MCME, MCTE)	₹ 7,200/- for the duration of training. Additional ₹1,355/- per relegated term	15 Lakh	15 Lakh	- Proportionately adjusted for disability above 20%. - For less than 20% disability, ex-gratia amount of ₹ 50,000/- in initial years of training & ₹ one Lakh in the last year of training.
B. Sc (Nursing)	₹ 4,625/- for the duration of training. Additional ₹ 645/- per relegated term	8 Lakh	4 Lakh	Conditions for award are same as above.

Maturity Benefit on Savings Element

- Lump sum Maturity benefit is accumulated on contributions made by the members along with the interest accrued each year during service. These are paid at the time of retirement/ discharge/ release from service. **In the unfortunate event of death, maturity benefits are paid to the beneficiaries in addition to the insurance amount.** AGIF makes payment of maturity benefit through NEFT and is credited to the member's bank account on the very next day of retirement subject to timely and correct receipt of documents.
- Withdrawal from Maturity Benefit.** It is permitted twice in entire service subject to following conditions:-
 - After completion of 15 years of physical service, members are allowed to withdraw upto 90% of their Maturity Benefit for education (12th and above) or marriage of their wards.
 - Members who have less than two years for superannuation can also withdraw upto 90% of maturity benefit for house building in addition to earlier withdrawal if already taken.
 - Minimum gap between two withdrawals should be more than six months.

Officers of Regular Army.

Date of Joining Scheme	Amount Contributed Upto 31 Mar 2024 (₹)	Contribution towards Savings Element 31 Mar 2024 (₹)	Amount Accrued as Maturity Benefit 31 Mar 2024 (₹)
01 Jan 82	1103625.00	897628.70	2858293.52
01 Jan 83	1102425.00	896718.30	2799279.33
01 Jan 84	1100985.00	895807.80	2734989.07
01 Jan 85	1099305.00	894532.70	2666908.54
01 Jan 86	1097385.00	893075.50	2596264.40
01 Jan 87	1095225.00	891496.00	2524090.02
01 Jan 88	1092825.00	889674.60	2451245.30
01 Jan 89	1090425.00	887853.30	2385355.41
01 Jan 90	1087350.00	885690.30	2315444.20
01 Jan 91	1084050.00	883413.40	2249522.66

**JCOs/OR of Regular Army.**

Date of Joining Scheme	Amount Contributed Upto 31 Mar 2024 (₹)	Contribution towards Savings Element 31 Mar 2024 (₹)	Amount Accrued as Maturity Benefit 31 Mar 2024 (₹)
01 Jan 90	536130.00	445178.61	1112210.07
01 Jan 91	534930.00	444310.17	1087116.22
01 Jan 92	533730.00	443441.73	1064758.39
01 Jan 93	532530.00	442573.29	1044932.66
01 Jan 94	531330.00	441704.85	1027427.04
01 Jan 95	530130.00	440836.32	1011961.36
01 Jan 96	528930.00	439967.76	998284.07
01 Jan 97	527730.00	439099.20	986214.45
01 Jan 98	525930.00	437760.16	970063.28
01 Jan 99	522930.00	435480.16	945385.33
01 Jan 00	519930.00	433200.16	923502.73
01 Jan 01	516930.00	430920.16	904108.67
01 Jan 02	513930.00	428625.76	886788.47
01 Jan 03	510930.00	426326.56	871184.00
01 Jan 04	506930.00	423154.60	851905.60
01 Jan 05	500930.00	418237.12	824477.67
01 Jan 06	491930.00	410860.96	786522.30
01 Jan 07	482930.00	403484.80	751503.57

Note.

- The above figures are only for Regular Army and will differ for other category members.
- Figures are based on uninterrupted contributions deducted by PAO/ CDA on behalf of members and interest paid by AGIF each year, as decided by Board of Governors.
- Amount accrued as Maturity Benefit is paid to members based on actual contributions and may vary due to interruptions in contributions.
- Similar table exists for all members recruited till date. However limited data has been displayed for sake of space and relevance.

AGIF Medical Benefit Scheme for Non-Pensioners

The erstwhile Disability Benefit Scheme has been modified with effect from 01 May 2018 and renamed as 'AGIF Medical Benefit Scheme for Non-Pensioner's'. The benefits of the scheme in its new form exclude following types of cases i.e. no disability benefit is paid if :-

- Disability is below 20% as assessed by the Medical Board on release.
- Individual who is in receipt of any kind of pension.
- The individual proceeds on superannuation or normal retirement/ release (no cut short in service).

- Personnel proceeding on pension/ discharge at their own request.
- Individual discharged on disciplinary grounds/ undesirable.
- Personnel granted extension, who were Low Medical Category (LMC), Temporary or Permanent or were in hospital on the crucial date of commencement of extension and subsequently released in LMC or invalidated out in category SHAPE-5 during the currency of the extended tenure.
- The disability is caused due to drug addiction or alcoholism.
- Diseases of pre-enrolment origin.

- Medical benefit payable for various percentages of disabilities:-

Percentage of Disability	Amount Payable (₹)	
	Officers	JCOs/OR
20	5,00,000	2,50,000
30	7,50,000	3,75,000
40	10,00,000	5,00,000
50	12,50,000	6,25,000
60	15,00,000	7,50,000
70	17,50,000	8,75,000
80	20,00,000	10,00,000
90	22,50,000	11,25,000
100	25,00,000	12,50,000

- Broad banding of Disability percentage is not applicable on AGIF Medical Benefit Scheme.

Ex Gratia Allowance Scheme

In addition to Medical Benefit amount paid to members, an Ex Gratia Allowance is granted to those who are invalidated out with 100 percent disability and granted Constant Attendance Allowance by the medical authority. A Corpus of ₹25 lakh and ₹12.5 lakh for officers and JCOs/ OR respectively is set aside in Assets Under Management (AUM) and managed by AGIF wef 01 May 2023. Interest earnings on this corpus (equal to interest declared on MMF each year) are remitted to the concerned member every quarter. On demise of the beneficiary, the corpus amount is ploughed back to AUM. Thus any member who is released/ discharged/ boarded out without any types of pension and 100% disability with CAA permanent with any of the following disabilities are awarded Ex-Gratia Allowance :-

- Total blindness (both eyes).
- Paraplegia.
- Quadriplegia.
- Irreversible comatose conditions due to irreversible brain damage as a result of trauma, infection, stroke or any cause leading to permanent vegetative state or equivalent.
- Loss of both limbs, i.e. amputation of both legs above knee or both arms above elbow.

Sustenance Allowance Scheme

AGIF grants a monthly sustenance allowance of ₹12,000/- wef 01 Jun 2023 per month per child for up to two specially abled children of service personnel who

die in harness. Eligibility conditions are as under :-

- The extent of disability as certified by medical authority must not be less than 40 percent.
- The child is unable to earn a living.
- The disability of the child should manifest itself before the death of the service personnel while in service.
- The disabilities covered in the scheme are as follows:-
 - Autistic Spectrum Disorders.
 - Cerebral Palsy.
 - Mental Retardation.
 - Multiple Disabilities:-
 - Blindness.
 - Low Vision.
 - Leprosy-cured.
 - Hearing Impairment.
 - Locomotor Disability.
 - Mental illness.

Extended Insurance (EI) Scheme

The Extended Insurance (EI) is a mandatory group scheme and an extension of the insurance cover post retirement/discharge up to a specified period by charging a one-time subscription at the time of retirement/discharge/ release. The one-time subscription charged has been made refundable on maturity in the modified scheme applicable to members retiring on or after 31 May 2022 as follows :-

Category	Subscription (One-time Refundable (₹))	Insurance Cover (₹)	Duration of Cover
Officers	1,60,000/-	15 Lakh	26 years post retirement or 80 years of age, whichever is earlier.
JCOs/OR	68,000/-	7.5 Lakh	30 years post retirement or 75 years of age, whichever is earlier.



Social Security Deposit (SSD) Scheme

SSD Scheme safeguards the interests of minor children and widows of members who expire while in service. The insurance benefits paid to minor children are invested by the AGIF in Nationalised Banks in cumulative/ non-cumulative Fixed Deposits (FDs) till they attain the age of majority. The insurance benefit share of widow may also be managed in similar way, based on her request for a period ranging up to three years. Quarterly interest is paid to beneficiary if the FD is non-cumulative. At the end of stipulated period, the principal/ matured amount is paid to the beneficiary after deducting Tax Deducted at Source as applicable. In case of minor children, quarterly interest can also be paid to the natural/ legal guardian.

- The Next of Kins availing SSD Scheme are advised to provide their PAN, Aadhar and 15G forms regularly.

Nomination for Army Group Insurance Scheme(s)

On joining service, every AGI member is duty bound to nominate a person to receive the insurance benefits. All members are required to make nominations as per guidelines issued vide AGIF letter No A/56271/36/AG/Ins (Coord) dated 26 Mar 2019. The salient aspects are as follows:-

- Eligibility.** All existing members (married and unmarried) of AGIF must make a fresh nomination as per revised Nomination Form.
- Validity.** Validity of old nomination form has expired wef 31 Jan 20. All insurance claims must be accompanied by the revised nomination form only.
- Unmarried Personnel**
 - Mother and father.
 - Dependent minor brothers and unmarried/ widowed sisters can only be nominated in the event when both the parents are not alive.
 - If an individual has no one in family i.e. Parents, Brothers, Sisters, he may nominate a person or persons or a body of persons or a corporate body as 'others'.
 - 100% share can be given to one nominee. The share can also be divided amongst persons stated therein but total of part shares should add upto 100%.

- Married Personnel**
 - The legally wedded wife and children.
 - Mother and father.
 - The minor brothers and unmarried/ widowed sisters can only be nominated, if wife, children and both parents are not alive.
 - Proportionate share of insurance benefits as per law of succession are paid to all Class I legal heirs (mother, spouse and children) in case of disputes. Therefore, nomination should to be done by keeping this important aspect in mind.
- Correctness of Details** Explanatory notes have also been incorporated in the revised nomination form. Incorrect and faulty details will render the nomination invalid.

Loan Schemes

- House Building Advance (HBA).**
 - Maximum HBA of ₹ 80 Lakhs, ₹ 35 Lakhs, ₹ 30 Lakhs is permissible for Officers, JCOs and OR respectively for purchase/ construction of house.
 - HBA for purchase of plot and construction of house on it (one integrated project) is also permitted.
 - Rate of Interest (ROI) is at 7.5% pa for Officers and 7% pa for JCOs/OR.
 - Duration is upto 20 years or 6 months before retirement in present rank whichever is earlier.
 - In addition HBA (Repair/ Alteration) is also permissible for ₹ 20 Lakhs to all members.
 - ROI on repair/ alteration of existing house is 8% pa for Officers and 7.5% pa for JCOs/OR.
 - Both types of advances can be availed concurrently.
- Conveyance Advance (CA).**
 - ROI is 8.25%.
 - Four Wheelers** ₹ 20 Lakh for Officers and ₹ 10 Lakh for JCOs/OR.
 - Four Wheelers(EV)** ₹ 25 Lakh for Officers and ₹ 15 Lakh for JCOs/OR.
 - Two Wheelers** ₹ 10 Lakh for Officers and ₹ 2 Lakh for JCOs/OR.
 - ROI on all types of CA is 8.25% pa.
 - CA is permissible only three times in entire service out of which four wheeler adv is restricted to two times.

- Personal Computer Advance (PCA).**
 - Maximum amount for PCA is ₹ 1 Lakh for all members.
 - ROI is 8.5% pa.
 - Second PCA may be availed on liquidation of first.
- Measures to Minimise Risk.**
 - All type of payments by AGIF will be made only in salary accounts.
- Members advised to forward only salary account details or documents for all types of loans, maturity benefit or any other payments.
- Online procedures for receipt and processing of applications for loans and maturity withdrawal are being evolved and will be implemented shortly.

NO OBJECTION CERTIFICATE (NOC) PRIOR TO PMR

MEMBERS WHO HAVE TAKEN ANY TYPE OF LOAN FROM AGIF AND ARE DESIROUS OF APPLYING FOR PRE-MATURE DISCHARGE MUST CLEAR THEIR DUES AND OBTAIN NOC PRIOR TO PROCESSING THEIR REQUEST.

REVISION OF AGI NOMINATION FORM

AGI NOMINATION FORM HAS BEEN REVISED WEF 26 MAR 2019. ALL MEMBERS ARE REQUIRED TO REVISE THEIR AGIF NOMINATIONS IF NOT ALREADY DONE

CAUTION : BEWARE OF FRAUDSTERS

- BEWARE OF ANY FRAUDSTERS OR TOUTS CONTACTING MEMBERS BY TELE CALLS/ MESSAGES/ E-MAILS OR IN PERSON TO RENDER ASSISTANCE IN ANY WAYS OR SPECIALLY FOR
 - ASSISTANCE IN GETTING OUTSTANDING DUES
 - EARLY PROCESSING OF CLAIMS
 - PROCESSING OR PAYMENT OF LOANS/ ADVANCES
- AGIF DOES NOT EMPLOY ANY MEDIATORIES / BROKERS / TOUTS
- ALL COMMUNICATIONS ARE DIRECTLY WITH MEMBER
- THE AGIF OR ANY OF ITS SCHEMES DOES NOT DEMAND ANY CASH OR ANY TYPE OF FEE FROM ITS MEMBERS

Director (Coord)	Civil No 011-26142749, Extn 206 34439 (Military)
Director (Claims)	Civil No 011-26145709, Extn 404 39275 (Military)
Director (Loan)	Civil No 011-26142749, Extn 506 39274 (Military)





Nomination:

A Vital Action for Seamless Disbursal of Insurance Benefits

By Col Rajiv Mehrotra (Retd), Jt Dir (Legal), AGIF

The word “Nomination” has not been defined in the AGIF Rules, bye-laws or the AO 23/2002/AGI. It has also not been defined in the Insurance Act, 1938. However, going by practice, in the context of AGIF, the Nomination would mean, the act of nominating person(s) by the Army person who is member of the AGIF Group Insurance Scheme that who/who all, would receive the insurance/maturity benefits emanating from the AGIF Group Insurance Schemes after the death of concerned member.

Nomination made by a member of AGIF in his life time is actually acted upon only after the death of the member, if the death takes place during the currency of the Insurance Scheme. Nomination in that sense is the last wish of the member

regarding how the insurance benefits are to be disbursed to person (s) nominated by him/her.

Existing Provisions of Nomination in AGIF

Para 9 of AO 23/2002/AGI makes it obligatory for all ranks to make a nomination for the AGIF Insurance Scheme so that the beneficiaries as per AGIF Rules are not deprived of benefits in the event of unfortunate death of a member, if it takes place during the currency of the AGIF Group Insurance Scheme. Further, Paras 10 to 20 of ibid AO delineate various facets of nomination i.e the manner in which it is to be done, its invalidity, re-nomination etc. These provisions also provide for giving freedom to the member for apportioning the percentage of

share of benefit to the concerned nominee(s). These provisions, as indicated in Paras 9 to 20 of AO 23/2002/AGI, nowhere bind/limit the person making the nomination, to nominate, only in accordance with the Law of Succession governing the concerned member of AGIF.

Para 39 of AO 23/2002/AGI reproduced below provides for payment of accrued Insurance benefits to the nominee(s) as per valid nomination but in cases of disputes between legal heirs such payments are to be made in accordance with the law of succession governing him/her :-

“Para 39. On receipt of Insurance Claim and relevant documents from the beneficiary, the insurance benefits accrued to

an individual at the time of his death while in service, shall be paid to the person or persons on whom the right to receive the benefits is conferred by means of a valid nomination. However, the payment will be made subject to clear understanding that she/he will be liable to share and/or part with proportionate share of any other heir to the said property of the deceased according to law of succession applicable in their behalf. In disputed cases between legal heirs, the payment will be made in accordance with the law of succession after obtaining approval of the Claims Committee of AGIF.”

Para 43 of ibid AO reproduced below, further provides that the cases of disputes will be referred to “Claim Committee” of AGIF:-

“43. Disputed Cases. Cases of disputes if any between legal heirs shall be referred to the Claim Committee Meeting of AGIF whose decision will be final. However, if the case is in the court of law, its decision will be complied with.”

AGIF policy circulated in Army vide letter No A/56271/R/AG/ Ins (Coord) dt 12 Nov 2009 amplifies the aspects of nomination in the following manner :-

- Allows married members to nominate dependent parent/ minor brothers and unmarried sisters, if they decide to do so, to receive up to a maximum of 33 per cent of insurance benefits. In case a member desires to nominate his wife and children to receive 100 per cent insurance benefits, he may do so.
- If a member wishes to nominate more than one person, the exact

share of each member must be specified in percentage terms. However, in case of married member, he will have the option to nominate his mother/ father/minor brother/sister also to receive a total share not exceeding 33 per cent of the total insurance amount and the balance share of 67 per cent will have to be in the name of wife and children.

- In case there is no nomination/ faulty nomination, then payment of insurance benefits will be made as per provision of the Law of Succession or as per direction of the court on the matter if the dependents take the matter to a Court of Law.
- In the case of minor sons and daughters, their mother will be deemed to be the natural guardian and their shares can be paid to the mother without production of guardianship certificate.
- In case a member nominates his wife and children for 100 per cent benefit or and unmarried member, after marriage does not renew his AGIF nomination as per policy in vogue, then in such an eventuality, if the widow is young and issueless or death of the member takes place within first year of marriage and the widow leaves the home immediately after death of the husband to stay with her own parents and the parents of the deceased soldier make a special request for payment of insurance amount then payment of insurance benefit will be made as per provision of the Law of Succession.

Lady Members Including MNS Officers It is not mandatory for such members to only nominate her

husband. They can nominate any member of their “family” (which include her family members prior to her marriage. It is also not obligatory for a Lady member to change the AGIF Nomination in the name of her husband on getting married and the Insurance payments will be made as per nomination made at her discretion only. In case a Lady member desires to nominate the husband as beneficiary for 100% insurance benefits, she may do so.

Nomination – as provided in Insurance Laws of our Country

The insurance laws in our country do not bind the insurance policy holder to nominate only in terms of law of succession. He/She is at liberty to nominate any person or persons and also is at liberty to apportion any percentage of share to one or more. However, the disputes of disbursal of insurance benefits in civil are also resolved in accordance with laws of succession. Section 39 of the Insurance Act of 1938 confers upon the holder of the policy of life assurance issued upon his own life, the right to nominate a person or persons to whom the policy money may be paid in the event of his death.

The said Section provides that a holder of a policy of life insurance on his own, he may when effecting the policy or at any time before the policy matures for payment, nominate the person or persons to whom the money secured by the policy shall be paid in the event of his death. If the nominee is a minor, the policy holder may appoint any person to receive the money in the event of his death during the minority of the nominee. That means that if the policy-holder is alive when





the policy matures for payment, he alone will receive payment of the money due under the policy and not the nominee. Any such nomination may at any time before the policy matures for payment be cancelled or changed, but before such cancellation or change is notified to the insurer if he makes the payment bonafide to the nominee already registered with him, the insurer gets a valid discharge. Such power or cancellation of or effecting a change in the nomination implies that the nominee has no right to the amount on the lifetime of the assured. If the nominee or where there are nominees more than one all the nominees die before the policy matures for payment the money under the policy is payable to the heirs or legal representatives or the holder of a succession certificate.

Apex Court Ruling on Nomination

The **Apex Court in the case of Smt Sarbati Devi and Another Vs Usha Devi decided on 6-12-1983** (which is still the landmark ruling) on the status of nominees, have held in the following terms:-

“We approve the views expressed by the other High Courts on the meaning of Section 39 of the Act and hold that a mere nomination made under Section 39 of the Act does not have the effect of conferring on the nominee any beneficial interest in the amount payable under the life insurance policy on the death of the assured. The nomination only indicates the hand which is authorized to receive the amount on the payment of which the insurer

gets a valid discharge of its liability under the policy. The amount, however, can be claimed by the heirs of the assured in accordance with the law of succession governing them”.

Analysis of Provisions of Army Order 23/2002/AGI in the backdrop of Civil Laws and Ratios of Courts

The AGIF, as per the provisions of AO 23/2002/AGI read with other policy letters as discussed above, follow the ratio of the Apex Court held in the case of Sarbati Devi (supra) in letter and spirit. It in turn gives discretion to a member to nominate as per his wish but we ensure that he does not nominate

his wife and children for less than 67% amount. For remaining 33%, he can nominate his parents and/or his other siblings. AGIF honours such nomination, if there is no dispute between legal heirs after his death. However, when nomination does not subsist for being invalid or not made in accordance with AGIF Rules/policies or when the family heirs disregard the nomination done by the members, then in such cases of disputes, the Claim Committee of AGIF follows the laws of succession and distribute death insurance benefits to all entitled legal heirs accordingly. The law of the land also demands such a methodology.

In view of what has been delineated above, it leads to the conclusion that Nomination is a very vital action to be done by the member who is insured or under the cover of insurance policy during his life time. It is for the members to do it judiciously to avoid possible disputes/litigation in his/her family after his/her death which leads to delay in disbursement of insurance benefits. Recognising its importance, the AGIF has issued a detailed policy and the revised Nomination Form vide its policy letter No A/56271/36/AG/Ins (Coord) dt 26 March 2019. This is a detailed policy where guidance for filling Nomination form is provided. If such policy letter is followed by each member through their Unit concerned, the AGIF would be in a position to disburse the Insurance claims to legitimate Nominees/legal heirs at an early date on receipt of Insurance claims.

Suggestions

There are certain suggestions which, if followed, may lead to greater satisfaction level amongst the members of families of deceased

soldiers as also the same may not give, the courts, an opportunity, to interfere and pass adverse remarks against the AGIF or the claimants. These are as under :-

- The member must exercise their absolute freedom and discretion to nominate as per his/her wish.
- Members must be provided the guidance by their Units/Records/Training Centre for filling the Nomination Form to obviate the possibilities of situations like; No Nomination or Invalid Nomination or after the death of the member, possible disputes amongst Nominees because the disbursement of the insurance benefits would be done by AGIF Claims Committee as per the provisions of Para 39 of AO 23/2002/AGI in accordance with Law of Succession governing them when there is no Nomination or Invalid Nomination or dispute amongst Nominees.
- In order to ensure that Nomination Form is filled and nomination is done properly, the same should be ensured by Training Centre as part of enrolment process for OR and for Officers, the concerned Training Establishment should

specifically guide them to ensure its correctness. This will obviate a substantial percentage of disputes in this regard.

- After marriage, the member must be asked, to file fresh nomination, and his Unit must ensure the same. If she/ he somehow does not do so, he be apprised that the law of Succession would be followed in disbursing his insurance benefits by the AGIF Claims Committee without any ifs and buts as has been provided in Para 39 of the AO 23/2002/AGI.



COL RAJIV MEHROTRA (RETD)

Col Rajiv Mehrotra (Retd) Commissioned in JAG Deptt of the Army on 09 Mar 1985. He is an alumnus of Lucknow University and completed his LLB in 1983. He is presently serving at AGIF as Jt Dir (Legal) since May 2018

Conclusion

The existing system of providing freedom to member to nominate exists in the Army. The same shall be allowed to continue and members must be guided and ensured to fill Nomination Form preferably after scrutiny at various levels only at the respective Records/Training Centre/Units and AG/MP Dte should send the invalid Nomination back to persons concerned for rendering fresh nominations, where the above mentioned suggestions be followed. The members also be provided guiding tables as circulated by AGIF vide its policy letter dated 26 Mar 2019 to make proper nomination.





AGIF Documents to Disburse Loans: Is It Genuinely Cumbersome

Dafadar Clerk (SD) Inderwesh (Retd)

Documentation

Processing of any loan of a soldier of any rank from AGIF requires basic documentation viz loan application signed by applicant and countersigned by CO unit/ IO alongwith requisite documents wherever applicable as per requirement of that type of loan. From individual information to repaying capacity, one has to provide all related documents.

Documents Req'd for House Building Advance (HBA)

The basic need of property documents i.e., Registry of the plot/ house, Mutation/ Jamabandi/ Dakhil Kharij in the name of applicant or jointly owned by the loanee and spouse with first registrant being himself/ herself. Stamp papers worth Rs 10/- and 100/-, wherever applicable in

addition to one latest pay slip and a cancelled cheque of the salary account of the loanee. In case of new construction, foundation/ plinth level photos and estimate by a registered architect are required followed by photos of progress of construction alongwith loan disbursement schedule. For Re-sale house loan, one has to provide agreement and advance payment receipt from the owner selling his house alongwith photos of the house signed by registered architect. The concept of house being not more than 10 years old has now been taken away making the procedure more simple one. Search Report from Advocate on letter head and approved building plan from revenue authority have also been taken away reducing the expenses and extra time taking steps for approval of documents required for loan. In case of builder's property, an applicant has to provide Builder Buyer's Agreement and permission to mortgage from builder on their

letter head. For repair/renovation of existing house, one has to provide photocopy of Registry, original Mutation, estimate and photos of house signed by registered architect/ engineer. Also, HBA being taken on property purchased from AWHO/ CGEWHO and societies, similar necessary documents are required. Advocate's 13/30 years search report on letter head and approved building plan from revenue authority have been removed from list of documents to reduce the burden of applicants in terms of time factor, expenses and extra tension while preparing such type documents.

Documents Required for Conveyance Advance (CA)

As regards processing of loans for CA, applicant has to produce original quotation from dealer/agency from which vehicle is being purchased in

addition to copy of driving licence, latest pay slip and a cancelled cheque of salary account and for second hand car, copies of registration certificate and insurance in the name of previous owner, from whom vehicle is being purchased, alongwith individual's completed application.

Documents Required for Personal Computer Advance (PCA) Loan

For PCA loan, the applicant has to produce original quotation from dealer/ agency from which computer/ laptop is being purchased in addition to copy of latest pay slip and a cancelled cheque of salary account alongwith individual's completed application.

Processing Charges and Application Fee

Processing charges and application fee are not applicable for loans from AGIF. Neither any penal fee/ charges are taken in case of pre-payment or mid term finalization.

Fixed Rate of Interest

ROI is fixed for every type of loan from AGIF and it is reduced by the system itself whenever reduced by a decision taken during Board of Governors (BOG). Moreover, a loanee is not effected by an increased ROI if the same is increased by BOG after taking of the loan.

Difference Between AGIF and Banks/Fin Institutions Loans

A comparative statement showing the major differences between documentation of loans of AGIF and

various banks/fin institutions is enumerated below:-

Type of Loan	Documents Required By Banks/ Finance Institutions	Documents Required in AGIF
HBA	Valuation Report is mandatorily required	Exempted
-do-	Search cum Encumbrance	-do-
-do-	Approved building Plan	-do-
do	Change Land Use Certificate (CLU)	-do- (Only when required by the Legal Advisor for Agricultural Lands)
-do	Visit of construction site and property being mortgaged	Exempted
-do-	File Charges, Legal charges and processing fee/ charges are taken	-do-
CA	CA for second hand car is given as per valuation report of their reps only for vehicles not more than 3-4 years old	AGIF goes for no valuation report from inner or outer side. Loan is given for car's IDV in insurance document upto not more than six years old vehicles

Conclusion

AGIF Docus to Disburse Loans Are Not Genuinely Cumbersome.

On comparing public sector banks and other fin/non-financial institutions, we can conclude that documentation procedure of AGIF for various loans is far better, cheaper and easier than those all other agencies outside. Hence, it is strongly recommended for all serving soldiers of Indian Army that while going for any type of loan, keep all these facts in mind and have a better opportunity to save money, have a loan on cheaper and fixed rates of interest and furthermore, second time loan also concurrently or on liquidation of first loan from AGIF. AGIF wishes all the very best and happiness, prosperity and wellbeing of all soldiers!

Jai hind



**DAFADAR CLERK (SD)
INDERWESH (RETD),**

Dafadar Clerk (SD) Inderwesh (Retd), served with Armd Corps (Armd Corps Records – 15 Armd Regt – 22 RR Bn (PUNJAB) – HQ AWHO – 67 Armd Regt) from 26/08/1996 to 31/05/2012. He is presently re-employed with AGIF (on contractual basis) since 03 March 2014.



Role of Units and Records

In Assisting AGIF to Discharge its Responsibilities

By Lt Col Mrigank Mehrotra, Jt Dir (Mat), AGIF

The AGI scheme is meant only for Army personnel. Hence, a requirement to establish an interlink between AGIF (Registered Society) and the Army for ease of expression of views and dissemination of important policy decisions to its members was inescapable. The Adjutant General's Branch of the Integrated HQ of MOD (Army) presides over all welfare schemes of Army personnel.

Role of Units in Assisting AGIF

Units play a pivotal role in assisting the Army Group Insurance Fund (AGIF) to discharge its responsibilities effectively by providing correct and accurate information about the personnel. The units have a crucial role in maintaining accurate data of the soldiers and providing the same to AGIF thereby facilitating smooth processing of any kind of claims.

Units can assist AGIF in following ways:-

- **General Awareness About AGIF Schemes.** The most important role that units can play is to spread awareness about the schemes of AGIF. Majority of the serving personnel are either unaware or have incorrect information regarding AGIF schemes. Command and junior leadership plays a vital role in spreading awareness amongst the troops regarding these schemes. To do the same, it is imperative that they are themselves aware of the schemes. The schemes are clearly mentioned in the beginning of this Journal. Certain issues that need to be highlighted to troops at unit level are as under:-
- **Advance Withdrawal of Maturity Amount (MAWD).** The provision of advance withdrawal of maturity is an option given to the members

who require the amount either for education of wards in Class XIIth or above or for marriage of wards or for repair and renovation in the last two years of service. It is important that applications are thoroughly checked at unit level to ensure that the reason mentioned is genuine. As far as possible, individuals should be discouraged from withdrawing this amount since it is by far the best returning fund (Member Maturity Fund (MMF) accumulated during service of soldiers and paid on retirement) that compounds over long period of service to accumulate to sizeable amount on retirement.

- **Fraudulent Documents.** Units play a major role in instituting stringent measures to ensure that genuine documents are forwarded for loans/claims.

In the past, cases have come to light where individuals have forwarded fraudulent documents without knowledge of units.

- **Timely Reporting of Casualties.** Units are required to intimate AGIF about casualties such as individuals becoming deserters and reinstated in service, death of individuals, Individuals getting medically boarded out, at the earliest so that the same can be updated in the records maintained at AGIF.
- **Account Details.** Units and Records maintain detailed records of service personnel and provide relevant data to Army Group Insurance (AGI). Accurate financial data enables AGIF to process claims and other benefits without any errors. Units and Records need to ensure that the data being forwarded by them especially the data related to bank account i.e. acct number and IFSC code is doubly checked at their end to avoid any financial loss to the individual. It is reiterated that AGIF does not process or maintain individual records/data and entirely banks on units/Records for timely and accurate data.
- **Personal Information.** Personal data in respect of serving as well as retired Army personnel is maintained at unit level and by the Records. The same is forwarded to AGIF in case of death/retirement of the person. It helps AGIF to identify beneficiaries and ensure that coverage is extended to eligible family members. This information is vital for timely and accurate

disbursement of insurance benefits. It is important for units to continuously update data of individual and their NoK, parents, spouse and children from time to time.

- **Processing of Claims.** Detailed records assist in the prompt processing of insurance claims. Units play a pivotal role in documenting incidents, injuries, or fatalities, helping AGIF to assess and fulfill claims swiftly, supporting the families of military personnel.
- **Risk Assessment.** Units contribute to risk assessment by providing data on deployment, duties, and potential hazards. This information aids AGIF in determining appropriate coverage levels and adjusting policies to meet the evolving needs of military personnel.
- **Communication.** Effective communication between units, AGIF is essential for disseminating information about insurance policies, benefits, and any changes. Clear and accurate records ensure that relevant information reaches all stakeholders in a timely manner.
- **Compliance Monitoring.** Units and Records assist in monitoring compliance with insurance policies and ensuring that all eligible personnel are covered. Regular audits of records help identify gaps or discrepancies, enabling AGIF to take corrective actions as needed.
- **Reinstated Cases.** In certain cases, the dismissal, discharge or invalidment is cancelled or

set aside by the competent authority or through a court order. Such individuals are taken back on the strength of the Army i.e. reinstated either by the Govt or under the delegated powers, by the Adjutant General. This information is not shared with AGIF resulting in problems which can be best avoided. On reinstatement the individual is supposed to again resume the payment of monthly subscription to AGIF to get the uninterrupted death insurance cover and other benefits under the AGIF Group Insurance scheme. The reinstatement of the individual entails following mandatory actions which the units need to ensure and educate the troops:-

- Individual has to refund AGIF benefits paid to him at the time of his dismissal/disch/invalidment like maturity benefits, medical benefits for non-pensioners.
- PAO/Indl/PAO(OR) should ensure the following:-
 - Resumption of monthly subscription of the concerned member to AGIF, for resuming the AGIF cover.
 - Deduct amount equivalent to total of such subscriptions for the period that he/she remained out of service.
- AGIF has to carry out following actions:-
- Cancel the Extended Insurance cover provided to him/her at the time of his/her discharge from the Army.
- Refund the unused EI subscription amount to the



individual by adding the same to his maturity account along with interest on same.

- Non remittance/ non refund of subscription/ bulk benefits involved in para above on reinstatement by the individual/Records/ PAO (OR) to AGIF results in loss to AGIF and prolonged correspondence/ litigation as also absence of insurance cover to the individual.
- Most of the time, the individual, post his reinstatement approaches the courts to get his dues from AGIF. Defence of such litigation adds avoidable burden of litigation cost to AGIF and also dents the credibility and image of the Army in general and AGIF in particular. Such occurrences are avoidable through a simple action of informing AGIF about the reinstatement of indl promptly as and when it occurs. This can be done by any agency involved in the entire process.
- The above mentioned contingencies can be tackled by AGIF and loss of money belonging to the members of the Army can be prevented, if the copy of Govt Sanction issued by DV Directorate or PS Directorate, to reinstate the concerned member in service, is also endorsed to AGIF (Claim Division and Finance Division) at the same time when it is endorsed to all other stake holders. On receipt of such copy of Govt Sanction, AGIF will be in a position to promptly approach the concerned Record Office / CDA(O)

Pune and guide them on the correct course of action.

- **Disability Benefits.** There have been cases where individual got invalidated out from service and received AGIF disability benefit. However, the individual challenged his discharge in AFT and got reinstated. The same was not informed to AGIF. The individual was supposed to return the amount he received as disability pension along with interest. However, despite repeated reminders to unit and Records, the case has not been resolved. It is recommended that the units should inform AGIF regarding such cases at the earliest.
- **Nomination for Insurance Benefits.** To facilitate easy disbursement of AGIF benefits to NOK as per law of succession, the following should be adhered to:-
 - Regular Updating of Nomination - Correct nomination details must be refilled on occurrence of imp events in family.
 - Inclusion of all CI-I heirs in nomination.
 - Nomination to align with Law of succession.
 - Avoid common errors in filling.
 - Guidelines to fill the nomination form are disseminated to the environment regularly.

Role of Records in Assisting AGIF

Records have an essential role in collecting, compiling and collating data received from all the units and thereafter forwarding it timely for processing at AGIF. Some essential documents required to be forwarded

by Records are as under :-

- Documents for mat benefits on retirement/death.
- Appx 'A' and CSV data in r/o retirees of proceeding month (in Bulk).
- Appx 'G' duly completed in all respect for Post retirement Cases (PRC).
- AGI recovery certificate duly filled by PAO (OR) and countersigned by Record Officer.
- Supporting Part-II Order wrt all retirement cases except normal retirees.
- Payment of maturity benefits will be made on Jt acct only except exceptional cases.
- **Documents required for payment of Insurance claim in r/o death in service personnel.**
 - Appx 'C' to AO 23/2002/AGI.
 - Nomination executed by the indl (Nomination form).
 - Affidavit cum Indemnity bond- through beneficiary.
 - Bank acct details i.e cancelled cheque/ First page of bank pass book/ NEFT mandate form.
 - Photocopy of AADHAR Card of beneficiaries.
 - Photocopy of PAN Card of beneficiaries.
- **Documents required for payment of Extended Insurance Claim (EIC) in r/o death after retirement.**
 - **In case the claimant is Nominee or Contingent Nominee.**
 - Death cert of member (Veteran) with valid QR Code.

- Extended Insurance (EI) certificate in original, if available.
- Cancelled cheque (or) 1st page of bank pass book copy with name of claimant to be printed on it. This is required to ascertain the Account No to credit the proceeds through NEFT/RTGS.
- Copy of AADHAR card of NOK (Claimant) for identification mentioning Mob / contact Number of claimant.
- Death cert of Nominee with valid QR Code, if claimant is Contingent Nominee.
- **In case the claimant is other than Nominee or Contingent Nominee.** The Extended Insurance (EI) amount will be distributed amongst remaining Class I legal heirs. If none of the Class I legal heirs survive, then the amount may be claimed by Class II legal heirs. The list of documents to be submitted is as follows:-
 - Death certificate of member (Veteran) with valid QR Code.
 - Death certificate of Nominee and Contingent Nominee with valid QR Code.
 - Extended Insurance (EI) certificate in original, if available.
 - Cancelled cheque (or) 1st page of bank pass book copy of each beneficiary with name of claimant to be printed on it. This is required to ascertain the

Account No to credit the proceeds through NEFT/RTGS.

- Copy of AADHAR card of NOK (each Claimant) for identification mentioning Mob/Contact No of each claimant.
- PAN Card of each claimant.
- Claim affidavit (as per format attached by each beneficiary).
- In case any remaining Class I legal heirs decide to disavow their share, a "consent certificate" (format attached) will be required in favour of remaining Class I legal heir(s).

invitation card attached.

- In cases where MAWD applications are forwarded and the concerned individual passes away due to unforeseen circumstances, the same needs to be informed to AGIF on priority in order to stop the processing of application any further.
- To summarise, units and records play an integral role in smooth functioning of the Army Group Insurance Fund. Accurate data, efficient record-keeping, and seamless communication contribute to AGIF's ability to fulfill its responsibilities towards military personnel and their families effectively which is the main goal of AGIF.

Common Observations in Documents

Certain errors/ observations in applications received by AGIF are given below. It would act as a checklist for units to ensure that documents forwarded to AGIF are in order:-

- Account number does not match with cancelled cheque and pay slip.
- Name of child does not match with CTC of birth Part II order.
- Applications are signed by company commanders instead of CO/ OC units.
- Application for withdrawal of maturity amount for repair and renovation of house are sent without being approved by architect and counter sign of CO.
- Applications for withdrawal of maturity amount for marriage of wards do not have marriage



LT COL MRIGANK MEHROTRA

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-  PAI cover for Pensioners up to 80 Years of Age for INR 40 Lakh.



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ECONOMIC & MONEY MATTERS



India's Economic Roadmap

By Navneet Munot

Few weeks ago, the ship for CY2024 set sail. While we look forward to what's in store in the 2024, its interesting to note that last few years have been eventful for financial markets in more ways than one. Fight against multi-decadal high inflation, accompanied by ripple effects of geo-political conflicts have meant that financial market participants were kept on toes. Amidst all the uncertainty looming around the global economy, Indian economy has stood tall with one of the fastest GDP growth among large economies.

India has indeed been an oasis in the desert of global economy over the past few years. As we move forward in Amritkaal, the positivity and conviction around India, driven by its structural growth factors is there for all to see.

Tiger pounces ahead of the Dragon

Last year, India overtook China on the population leader board to become the most populous country. This has naturally led to comparison of India's journey with China's.

While India is taking a leaf out of China's book through a resolute focus on manufacturing and infrastructure; unlike China, India's holistic approach to infrastructure push will focus on People, Planet and Prosperity.

India's growth is expected to be more inclusive though

Unlike China, where the growth model has been state-driven and environmentally unsustainable, in

India, one can expect the growth to be more inclusive - driven by entrepreneurship and with the Government acting more as a facilitator. Vibrancy of Indian capital markets too makes India's growth more inclusive. In fact, in China, while the economy has witnessed a robust growth over the last 3 decades, MSCI China Index yielded paltry returns during the same period. On the other hand, in India, sustained economic growth has been matched by growth in corporate profitability and commensurate returns from equity markets.



Ticking the right boxes

If one looks at the journey of countries from developing to developed economies, one can observe that they have ticked certain key boxes, first of which would be the 'Ease of doing business' and simplification of regulations. This is something where India has taken major steps in the right direction recently and almost every Union Budget in recent times has been mindful of this too. Second factor is Education. On this front too, the increased digital connectivity across the length and breadth of the country means that access to online education and digital resources is not just restricted to a select few. Worth noting here that India has one of

the largest internet user base in the world. Another key factor happens to be that of inclusive growth. Here too, we have been moving in the right direction. While the 90s broadened horizon of India's economy, 2014 ushered in a new era of financial inclusion. The Government initiated the Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana in August 2014 on the guiding principle of banking the unbanked, securing the unsecured, funding the unfunded and serving unserved and underserved areas. The powerful trinity of Jan Dhan Yojana, Aadhar and Mobile number (JAM) has truly ushered in an era of financial inclusion in India. Other schemes like Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana (Housing), Janaushadi Yojana

(Medicines at affordable prices), Ayushman Bharat (free health insurance coverage), Ujjwala Yojana (LPG connection) etc. have also been steps in the right direction.

Capital markets aiding better capital allocation

Goes without saying that one of the key ingredients to reap rich demographic dividend happens to be efficient allocation of capital/robustness of a country's capital markets. Over the years, Indian capital markets have certainly come a long way. From a dozen odd brokers trading under a banyan tree

over a century ago to becoming the 5th most valued stock market in the world, Indian capital markets have traversed quite a journey. More importantly, Indian equity markets have steadily built a credibility of being one of the most transparent, sophisticated and digitally evolved markets in the world.

Digital tailwinds

India's trailblazing adoption of technology is another tailwind which can propel it in the right direction. Over the years, India's education system has not been able to match up to the standards of our more developed peers. Wider digital adoption could provide the panacea to this challenge by bringing the world of knowledge to the fingertips of masses making our education system much more inclusive.

Troika of Macros, Micros and Domestic liquidity to aid India story

While there are numerous reasons why one can be optimistic about India, there are **3 key reasons** why I am bullish as a long-term investor. Firstly, **India's macro-economic stability makes it much more resilient** compared to other peers. Strong macro-economic fundamentals, pro-business environment and sustained structural reforms hold India in good stead. What's equally noteworthy is that India's growth journey has a long runway ahead given the low starting base in terms of per capita GDP. Secondly, **India has large number of companies with wide array of businesses catering to a diverse set of customers.** This presents a diverse set of opportunities in term

of stock selection – something which cannot be paralleled by most peers. With high quality management, strong corporate governance, emphasis on capital efficiency, robust regulatory framework and wide array of investment avenues, Indian equity market can live up to its billing of being a 'Stock pickers paradise'. Thirdly, **sustained domestic liquidity now makes Indian markets relatively less susceptible to volatility associated with foreign capital flows.** While foreign capital will continue to hit Indian shores owing to India's relative attractiveness to foreign investors, robust domestic flows from DIIs can help to provide the counterbalancing stability.

'Kos Kos pe badle paani, char kos pe baani'. This popular aphorism - which translates to 'the taste of

water changes every Kilometer and the language every few Kilometers' - sums up the diversity of India like none other. By most accounts, there are more than 100 languages and thousands of dialects India speaks in. Today, there is another language which India speaks and writes in. One which has usage across states, across length and breadth of our country - The language of economic development. With persistent steps in the right direction, India is steadily marching towards the goal of becoming an economic powerhouse in Amritkaal.



NAVNEET MUNOT

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He has 3 decades of rich experience in the industry. He has been the Executive director and Chief Investment officer of SBI Funds management Private Limited. He was also a Director on the board of SBI Pension Funds (P) Limited as well as the Executive Director & Head – multi-strategy boutique with Morgan Stanley Investment Management and Chief Investment Officer – Fixed Income and Hybrid Funds at Birla Sun Life Mutual Fund.

He has a master's degree in Accountancy and Business Statistics and is a qualified Chartered Accountant.





Don't Bet Against India!

The Best is Yet to Come!

By Raamdeo Agrawal, Chairman, Motilal Oswal Financial Services Limited (MOFSL)

Don't bet against India – a Nation on the cusp of transformative growth, poised to become the world's growth engine in the coming years. As Honorable Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi rightly predicts, 'India will become the growth engine for the world in the coming years. 'This proclamation is not just rhetoric; it reflects a well-founded optimism grounded in the confluence of factors propelling India into a super-cycle of prosperity reminiscent of other nations at similar pivotal moments in the past. Despite global growth uncertainties, India is expected to be the fastest-growing large economy, with projections of over 6.4% GDP

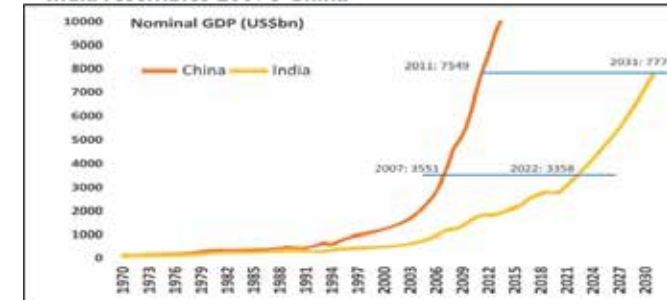
Growth in FY25, accompanied by robust corporate earnings growth. The driving forces behind this growth are the 6-Ds: Democracy, Demography, De-globalization, Digitization, Decade of Government Reforms and Developing Capital Markets.

- **Democracy:** India boasts the world's largest populace and is the largest democracy with a well-established federal structure. A stable majority government at the center facilitates effective policy-making and developmental initiatives.
- **Demography:** With a youth-dominated population, India is

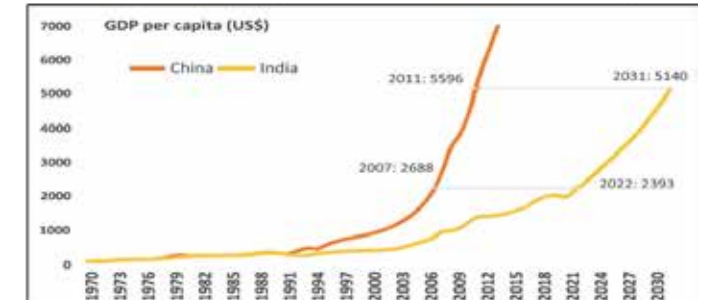
set to contribute around 21% of the global incremental working-age group, fostering positive demographic trends that support income growth. Resembling China of 2007, India's per capita income is expected to double by this decade's end to approximately \$5,000. This shift will reshape India's income pyramid, with 46% of households moving to \$10k-\$35k income brackets (from 24%) and 7% above \$35k (from 2%), sparking a significant discretionary spending boom.

- **De-globalization:** India's manufacturing share is expected to rise to 21% by 2031 from

From a nominal GDP and per-capita income perspective, India resembles 2007's China



Over the next decade, we expect India to follow China's path



Source: Morgan Stanley Research Reports

~16% today, indicating a nominal output surge from US\$447 billion to around US\$1.5 trillion. Multinationals exhibit heightened optimism in investing in India, supported by the government's encouragement through infrastructure development and land allocation for factories. Accompanied by increasing labour productivity and one of the lowest manufacturing wage rates, India is strategically positioned for the 'China +1' supply chain shift. Additionally, India's substantial domestic market across various categories and the potential for increased export opportunities make it advantageous for supply chains to shift. The PLI scheme has

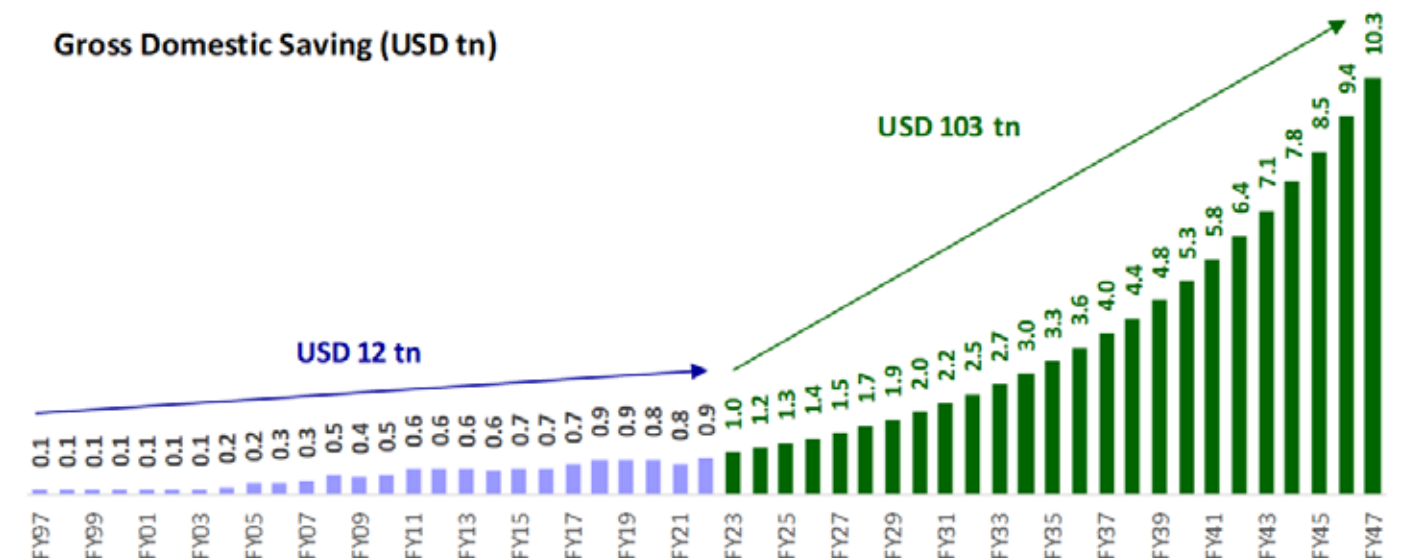
already demonstrated positive outcomes, with expectations of a significant rise in capital expenditure in FY24 and FY25.

- **Digitization:** The JAM trinity (Jan Dhan, Aadhaar, Mobile internet penetration) fuels a digital revolution. Internet penetration is projected to reach 65% by 2031, with digital commerce penetration at 11-12%. The UPI transactions surpassed 100 billion in 2023, marking a milestone in the ongoing digital transformation. Benefits like direct benefit transfers aid welfare dissemination, ensuring targeted delivery. Initiatives like the Open Network for Digital Commerce (ONDC) aim to democratize digital commerce,

particularly benefiting the MSME segment. The increasing internet penetration anticipates a credit boom, leveraging available data for a rise in the retail credit cycle. The surge in bank account openings, demat accounts and financial services attests to the broad-ranging advantages of India's digital leap.

- **Decade of Government Reforms:** Over the past decade, India has witnessed substantial reforms, including GST implementation, corporate tax rate reduction, land and labour reforms, PLI schemes, and codes like the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (IBC). These reforms aim at enhancing ease of doing business, fostering formalisation, transparency and

Gross Domestic Saving (USD tn)



Source: Motilal Oswal Internal Analysis



increased investments.

- **Developing Capital Markets:** Domestic investors, with only 5% of household assets in equities, have emerged as a robust support for Indian equity markets, evident in the tripling of demat accounts in the last three years to 14 crs as of Dec 2023. This nascent equity culture among Indian households is poised for meaningful expansion, providing a strong cushion to foreign flows. We expect \$103 tn of savings over next 25 years' v/s \$12 tn in past 25 years providing a massive opportunity for Capital Markets.

This is already visible in a massive rise in SIP flows which has doubled in the last 4 years from Rs 85 bn in Jan'20 to Rs 170 bn in Nov'23. We expect this trend to be sustainable in the long term.

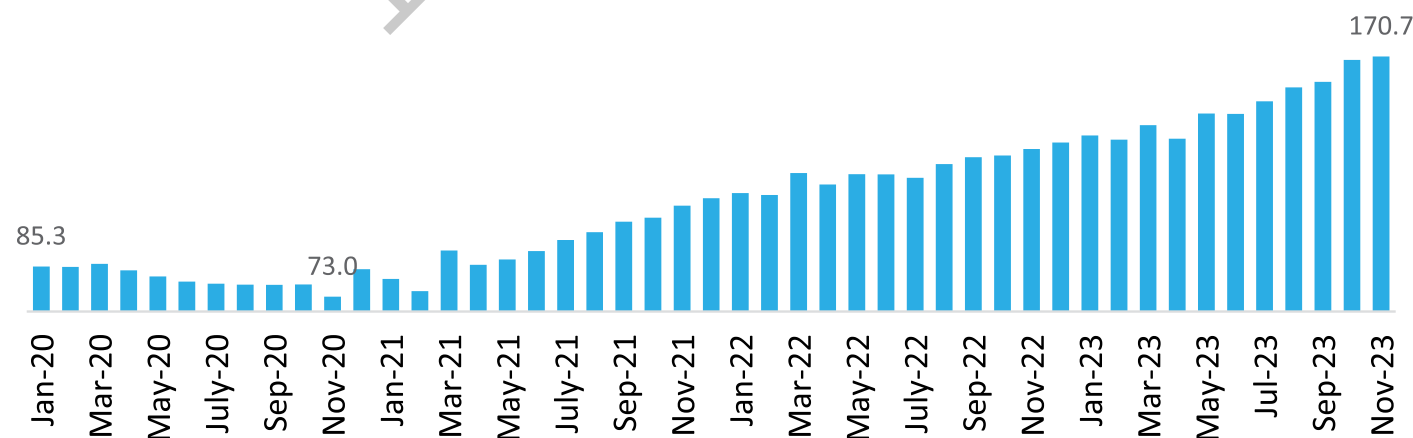
India is currently in a phase akin to what propelled massive wealth creation in economies like the US during the 1980s and China from 2005-2010. S&P compounded at ~18%, doubling the US economy from \$3 trillion to \$6 trillion, while China compounded at ~25%, reaching \$6 trillion. India, is now in a similar phase and holds tremendous potential for wealth creation.

Moreover, the overall economic growth is expected to sustain for an extended period, driven by increased income and job opportunities resulting from heightened investments, both domestic and foreign. Given the economic and corporate earnings matrix, Indian equities are positioned to outperform other asset classes in the long run. The best is yet to come for the Indian equity markets, remaining one of the most rightly valued markets due to the growth potential in the current decade. Investors should maintain a disciplined approach, reveling in their wealth creation journey as the India growth story unfolds in this decade and beyond.

Disclaimer: The information contained in this document is for general purposes only and not a complete disclosure of every material fact. The information/data here alone is not sufficient and shouldn't be used for the development or implementation of an investment strategy. It should not be construed as investment advice to any party.

Investments in securities market are subject to market risks, read all relevant documents carefully.

SIP Flows (INR bn)



Source: AMFI, Motilal Oswal Internal Analysis



RAAMDEO AGRAWAL

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Mr. Agrawal has created the "QGLP" (Quality Growth Longevity & favorable Price) Investment Process and its 'Buy Right, Sit Tight' investing philosophy.

Mr Agrawal is also the driving force behind the MOFSL Groups highly awarded research. He has been authoring the annual Motilal Oswal Wealth Creation Study since its inception in 1996.

Mr. Agrawal is an Associate of Institute of Chartered Accountant of India and a member of the National Committee on Capital Markets of the Confederation of Indian Industry.



Indian Stock Market Growth Story:

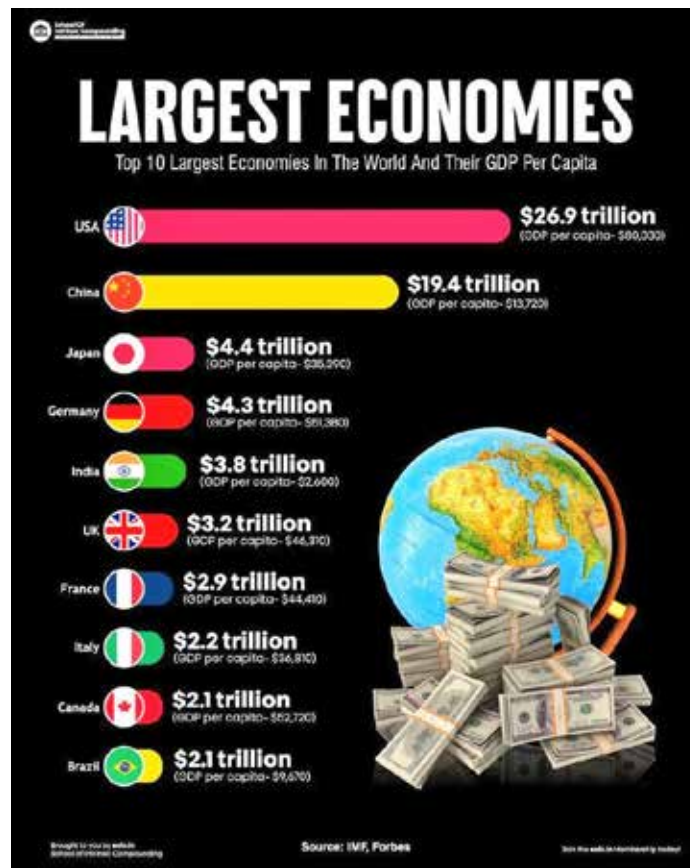
Should You Believe?

By Major Arnab Roy

Every day most of my seniors and juniors ask me during any discussion "where is Market heading"? They also express surprisingly to me that market has added too much return in portfolios and now it seem the doomsday is coming for us for sure? The future of the Indian stock market has long been a focal point for investors seeking opportunities in emerging economies. With a diverse and dynamic economy, India has witnessed significant growth in various sectors, contributing to the narrative of a promising stock market. Indian stock market has traditionally displayed a small correlation with

global markets. Being the world's most populated nation, the world's fastest growing emerging economy, and the third-largest of all by 2027 when International Monetary Fund anticipates it to overtake Japan and Germany, India has become the new heartthrob of investors around the world. ¹ We also place claim to be the world's fourth largest stock market behind only the US, China and Japan and in response to this growth story, the outside world has responded by pumping large quantum of money into the Indian equity market in 2023 despite global uncertainties. ^{2,3} These inflows and the strong possibility of continuation

of same Government in power have facilitated to push the stock market indices to new record highs in recent days. Since inception in 1995, the Indian market has offered robust returns with reduced volatility and has delivered eight consecutive years of gains.⁴ Indian economy is set to become the world's third largest, but share price valuations are extremely rich because of which the burning question today among all of us is "whether we should believe in the Indian stock market growth story and keep investing". I would try to analyze the same in a simple manner for my dear comrades in arms.



Good Days Ahead for Indian Economy

• **Geopolitical Influence and Shift in Economic Power:** The balance of economic power is gradually shifting, with emerging economies playing a more influential role. India, with its large and dynamic population, is positioned to become a key driver of global economic growth. As the world is moving beyond traditional economic powerhouses, India's contribution is expected to be substantial. India's strategic location and diplomatic engagements position it as a key player in shaping international economic policies. Collaborations with various countries and participation in forums like the G20 magnify India's voice on the global economic stage. As protectionist sentiments fade



in some parts of the world, India's role in fostering trade and economic cooperation is likely to expand. The country's diverse economy makes it an attractive partner for nations seeking collaboration in different sectors. Today the power of the Indian economy has taken focus for those investing in Asia and emerging markets. Global

investors are understanding and recognizing that this is the market one can not ignore.

• **Technology and Innovation Hub:** India is fast emerging as a global hub for technology and innovation. The country's vibrant startup ecosystem, coupled with a growing emphasis on research and development,

positions it as a major player in shaping the technological landscape. Indian companies are increasingly at the forefront of innovation, contributing to advancements in various sectors. India's strength in information technology domestically, has powered the rise of Infosys, Wipro, Tata Consultancy Services and so many more. The largest companies in the world are run by Indian nationals and that will continue to be.⁵

• **Population and Demography:** We have recently surpassed China as the most populous nation in the world.⁶ Economic growth is reinforced by promising demographics, with nearly 70 per cent of our 1.4bn population in the working-age bracket. We now have the world's largest youth populations with literacy rate at roughly 87 percent.⁷ We have the most university graduates, third largest group of scientists and technicians in the world.⁸ Much like its impact on the Indian stock market, our demographic dividend holds significant implications for the world economy. A youthful population contributes to a productive workforce and increased consumption, fueling economic growth not only domestically but also influencing global demand patterns. India can become an investment alternative to China as India has the ability to imitate China's manufacturing driven growth model. India's demographic dividend is likely still ahead, while China needs to find a way to support an aging and declining population. India is also a democratic country, with dispute resolution mechanisms and natural safeguards against unfair practices. Our per-capita

GDP has crossed the US\$2,000 mark and is likely to grow by nearly 70 percent to USD 4000 by FY 2030 from USD 2450 in FY 2023, helping it become a middle income economy with USD 6 trillion GDP.⁹ One in every three Indians is "middle class" in India with income between Rs 5 lakh to Rs 30 lakh per annum. This number is expected to double by 2047, places two out of every three Indians in the category.¹⁰ "Consumption, particularly among the middle class, will be a significant theme for investors. By 2050, India is projected to contribute approximately 40 per cent to global middle-class consumption, a substantial increase from the current 5 per cent."¹¹

• **Well Managed Economy:** India continues to sensibly manage both its monetary and fiscal policies. Inflation has started to decline, the rupee is stable, and at a time when the world is surrounded by many uncertainties, India has emerged as a new ray of hope. Though global growth is expected to slow down 2.6 percent last year to 2.4 percent in 2024, India is booming. Our economy grew by 7.6 percent in the last 12 months beating nearly every forecast and most economists expect annual growth of 6 percent or more for rest of this decade.¹² We have seen that currencies around the world have weakened against the dollar but the rupee has held strong. The Reserve Bank of India is actively using its reserves to defend the rupee against exterior breezes, which is why the Indian rupee was steady in 2023 despite a strong US Dollar.¹³ As an oil importing country, oil prices have an impact on India's current account and inflation

which the present government has managed well with strong diplomatic relations. With a focus on sustainable development, the global economy is gradually transitioning towards green practices. India's commitment to renewable energy, environmental conservation, and sustainable practices positions it as a key player in fostering a green economy. As the world grapples with climate change, India's contributions in this arena has been crucial and government is continuously working towards the same.

• **Structural Reforms and Infrastructure Development:** India is benefiting both from its own reform agenda and from broader global trends. Domestically, a range of growth enhancing reforms such as the Aadhaar, which has been permissible for unique customer identification; United Payments Interface (UPI), the national digital payment system that has smoothed digital transactions and rollout of the Goods and Services Tax (GST), which replaced a multitude of local taxes. In addition to growing the digital economy, production linked incentive programs, lower corporate tax rates and the "Make in India" Program have all helped improve the ease of doing business in India. In many cases, India is well behind in terms of infrastructure, but the government is now focusing on moving people around with their huge investment in airports and planes like proposal construct around 80 airports in the subsequent five years. India's ambitious infrastructure development projects, including the "Smart Cities" initiative and

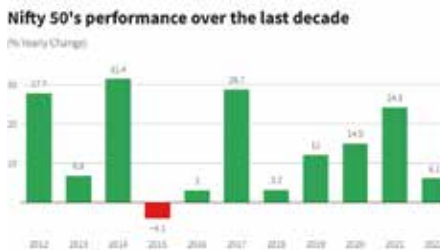


investments in transportation networks, are integral to global economic dynamics. Improved connectivity can enhance trade, foster economic partnerships, and contribute to the overall resilience of the global supply chain. "This is likely to result in more foreign direct investment as Asia-oriented global companies have learnt lessons from the Covid pandemic and Russia's invasion of Ukraine. They will be simplifying their supply chain to where it's closer to where it needs to be, potentially doing more in India, given that Asia accounts for 60 per cent of the global population".¹⁴

- **Stability in Political Domain:** The basic demand of any economic development and stock market boom is stability in political domain. Prime Minister Narendra Modi led BJP has been in power since 2014 and recently won three significant state elections- Chhattisgarh, Madhya Pradesh and Rajasthan. There are bound to be increase in social subsidies before general election, coupled with this positive economic performance and ongoing government reforms are likely to reinforce support for the present government ahead of upcoming 2024 Lok Sabha Elections. The re-election of current political dispensation with majority would be an important catalyst of boost in the economy, as the newly elected government will increase spending to support public sentiment and will sanction new initiatives to encourage consumption. This combination of continuous good governance and development would further solidify economic stability for this decade.

Should you Believe the Story and Stay Invested?

- If you are yet to believe in your own Nation's growth story or your personal political alignment is stopping you from believing the truth let me summarize and make it simpler for you. The Indian stock market remained resilient throughout the year 2023 among geopolitical worries. Our benchmark indices, Sensex and Nifty 50 clocked eight consecutive years of positive returns (Please leave pandemic months aside) and swelled around 17 percent last year. The uptrend in the Indian stock market was driven by assuaging concerns on political continuity, strong domestic investors' participation, solid corporate earnings, robust macro and micro factors, rally in foreign fund inflows and expectation of further boom ahead. "India is now undeniably the leader in emerging markets and is almost stepping on China's toes. Overall, India remains a private consumption driven economy accounting for 60 per cent of gross domestic product, which gives the economy a lot of immunity from external forces".¹⁵ We are currently experiencing the highest growth among key economies. Hence, despite high valuations and doubt among retail investors, the above factors indicate thrive with prospective for further upside.



Conclusion

World economy is intricately linked with the contributions of emerging economies, and India stands at the forefront of this transformative journey. As the country navigates its way through technological advancements, sustainability initiatives, and global collaborations, its impact on the world economy is set to be both significant and far-reaching. The world is witnessing a new era, and India's role in shaping its economic landscape is undeniably central. There is no denying that while the Indian stock market growth story presents compelling opportunities, potential investors especially Fauji trend followers should approach it with a judicious eye. Understanding economic fundamentals, market volatility, sectorial dynamics, regulatory environments, and global factors is essential for making informed decisions. So you don't need to believe me but please analyze the risks and opportunities yourself to believe in the Indian stock market growth story.

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MAJOR ARNAB ROY

Major Arnab Roy got Commissioned in The Madras Regiment in 2013 and presently serving as a Training Company Commander in Madras Regimental Centre, Wellington. The Officer is MBA in Finance and follows Indian and world economy very closely.



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Personal Investment and Management by Individuals

By Kailash Kulkarni, Chief Executive Officer, HSBC Mutual Fund, India

Investing may seem complicated, but it really is as simple as our everyday lives! If you make smart decisions and invest in the right places, you can reduce the risk factor, increase the reward factor, and generate meaningful returns.

Let's divide the holistic investment plans of an individual into four important steps –



Goals



Growth



Protection



Distribution

This might include saving, setting spending priorities, budgeting, and various forms of risk mitigation that all come together to offer a holistic vision of your wealth.



Goals

First and foremost is to understand the unique personal and financial goals you are working toward. For many people, saving for retirement is at the top of the list. But this is likely not the only goal you have — you might be looking to build a dream home, start a family, pay for college or a wedding, start or grow a business, holiday planning, or change careers — or something else entirely. By understanding what's important to you and what you want to accomplish in your life, your financial advisor will be able to build a financial plan that empowers you to reach your goals as per your risk appetite.

Growth

How you grow your wealth will be dependent on your personal financial situation. But doing so will almost certainly involve some form of investing. It is critical to understand your goals and risk tolerance to construct and manage an investment portfolio that aligns with your goals.

Protection

As you work to grow your wealth, it's equally important to protect the wealth you've already accrued. Your emergency fund, insurance (including health and life insurance), and tax mitigation strategy are all integral to this. It is very important to position your wealth with investments, insurance, cash and other financial vehicles.

Distribution

This is a critical piece of investment management, because at some point, you will want to use your wealth. A financial advisor will help

you to maximise your wealth as you distribute it by being strategic about where you withdraw funds and shield you from other risks like market downturns.

Your financial advisor will help you bring everything together by creating a plan that incorporates the individual pieces of your financial life, while also helping you understand how those pieces all work together.

Now, let's decode some of the key pointers on how to manage investments.

Start Investing Early

Start early and over time your savings could grow into a sizeable sum.

When you start saving early, your money has more time to grow. Moreover, you benefit from the power of compounding - your investment earns income and that income earns more income. So, the sooner you start, the better your chance at building wealth in the long-term.

Keep Some Money Aside for Emergencies

Ideally about three to six months of expenses is considered a good amount.

You don't really have to keep the cash lying idle - just make sure you can withdraw the amount when you need to - without penalties.

Why you may need your money at short notice

- An emergency such as hospitalisation

- An unexpected expense such as for repairing your car
- To manage expenses during a job shift or in case of a job loss

Think Carefully About How Long You Will be Investing for

Categorise your goals in terms of time frame

A simple, yet effective way would be to divide your goals into short, medium and long-term. Look at the stock market only if you are prepared to put your money away for five or ten years, or perhaps even longer. For example, to meet long-term goals such as retirement or children's education or marriage.

If you are likely to need your money any sooner, keep it in an investment in which the chance of a loss in capital is lesser.

Remember that Inflation Will Eat into Your Savings

Equity-oriented investments are more suited to generate better post-inflation returns.

Returns on risk-free cash investments may sound comforting, but when you consider the impact of inflation you may not be so impressed. For long-term growth you need to make your money work harder.

Ask Yourself How Much Risk You Can Take

Be realistic about your appetite for risk



The potential of high returns may not be of much use if you are going to lose sleep over the risk associated with your investment. Also consider other aspects such as your financial obligations and life stage to gauge your overall risk taking ability.

Spread Your Money Across a Range of Investments

You will be less likely to lose out if one type of investment does badly

Depending on your goals, life-stage and attitude to risk, you will probably want to spread your money across different types of investments – equities, bonds and cash. You may also want to diversify within each of these categories. An equity fund, for example, will invest your money in a variety of companies but you may want to ensure you have a range of industries or sectors too.

Choose Your Funds Carefully

Select investments based on your personal circumstances and goals

Ideally equity funds are most suited for long-term goals – five or ten years at least. For goals that are medium to short-term in nature, it's best to opt for lower-risk options.

Don't opt for the flavour of the season, unless you are sure it will be right for you in the future. Don't assume all funds investing in Indian equities are the same – look at what a fund invests in and check if you are comfortable with its investment style and objectives.

Invest Regularly

Every little bit adds up Investing

regularly is easy if you treat your investment as part of your monthly budget. A Systematic Investment Plan (SIP) is a great way to build a sizeable sum. Moreover, investing regularly also allows you to capitalise on a phenomenon called “Rupee cost averaging”.

Review Your Investments

Review your investments regularly so they match your long-term goals

There is nothing constant in life. Situations keep changing. A portfolio that is right for you at one point in your life may not be quite so suitable a few years later. Your investments need to adapt to changes in your circumstances, such as getting married, having children or starting a business. It's also a good idea to check that each of the funds in your portfolio is living up to your expectations.

Getting the Right Mix

For the greatest long-term growth potential, you could invest all your money in equities. But this could be a high-risk strategy as the markets could dip just before you need the money. You may need to think about making changes to your portfolio over time. You could aim for strong growth in the early years, and then, lock in gains you may have made and move into lower-risk investments. As you get closer to needing your money, bonds and cash investments could be your emphasis.

Stay Invested for the Long-Term

Remember that time not timing is the key to successful investing

It is very tempting to invest when the markets are high and everyone else is investing and to redeem when the markets are falling. During volatile periods, markets can swing in both directions; it is better to remain calm and take a long-term view, so you have time to ride out any ups and downs.



KAILASH KULKARNI

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He was a member of the SEBI Mutual Fund Advisory Committee and was on the board of Association of Mutual Funds of India (AMFI). He has also headed the Financial Literacy Committee for AMFI, in the past. Mr. Kulkarni is a management graduate from the Institute of Management Development and Research.



Financial Freedom

A Practical Journey for Every Indian

By Nilesh Shah, Group President & Managing Director,
Kotak Mahindra Asset Management Company

There are many paths to Nirvana, and similarly, there are many paths to achieving financial freedom. The basic ingredients remain three things.

First, you have to be a long-term investor. You can't grow mangoes unless you wait for 12 years. My first time investing in stocks was a failure. I was drawn to the market in the 90s hoping to make fast money. I relied on tips to buy stocks, but quickly lost everything. It was a tough lesson, but it made me learn more about investing.

Secondly, you have to be a regular investor. No matter how small the amount, investing regularly creates

a steady stream of investments. Little drops of water make an ocean. Thirdly, disciplined asset allocation is crucial. The new year brings many changes, but some things should stay the same, like maintaining a disciplined approach to investing. Many people lose money because they invest based on past returns. Others lose money because they get scared when markets go down and redeem at the wrong time. Diversification across debt, equities, commodities, real estate, and offshore assets will create a portfolio that should outperform inflation. The adage 'Don't put all your eggs in one basket' is applicable here as well.

So, while there are many paths to achieving financial freedom, the core ingredients remain: long-term investing, regular investing, and disciplined asset allocation.

For most people in India, the concept of financial freedom signifies having enough money to live life on your own terms without being dependent on others. It is about having the independence and flexibility to make major life choices without being constrained by financial limitations. Financial freedom does not necessarily mean accumulating massive wealth or assets. It simply means attaining a stage where you do not have to worry about money for your basic



needs and can take major financial decisions without being anxious about the costs involved.

The journey to financial freedom requires cultivating some basic habits, imbibing time-tested investment principles, and having the patience to see your corpus grow over time. While the road to financial freedom may seem daunting initially, it is achievable by most Indians if they adopt a disciplined and focused approach. Here are some practical suggestions to make your journey a success:

Build a Habit of Regular Saving

The foundation of financial freedom is regular saving. Make it a habit to save a portion of your income each month before you start spending on other things. How much you can save will depend on your income levels and expenses, but do not neglect this critical first step. Instead of $\text{Income} - \text{expenses} = \text{savings}$, practice $\text{Income} - \text{savings} = \text{expenses}$. Over time, these monthly savings will build into a substantial corpus that will give you solid financial security.

An SIP, or Systematic Investment Plan in mutual funds, encourages regular investing regardless of market conditions. This avoids the need to time the market and averages out the cost of mutual fund units over time.

Even if an investor buys units at a high price through an SIP, they will also buy at lower prices at times, balancing the costs in the long run. With a ₹50,000 EMI, buying a luxury car isn't feasible. But with a ₹50,000 SIP invested for a sufficient period, you can afford one.

Cultivate a Long-Term Investment Mindset

Real wealth creation happens over long periods of time. Do not get tempted by the prospect of quick gains from speculating in stocks or gold. This is risky and unsustainable. Instead, develop a long-term, disciplined approach to investing your savings. Understand that building a strong investment portfolio is like tending a garden- it requires patience and care for many years before you can enjoy the fruits. Stay focused on the horizon rather than looking for short cuts.

As a child, I saw a movie scene where a father places his turban at someone's feet, symbolizing his honor, to borrow money for events like weddings or education. That was India back then.

Imagine a new scene: a hero says, "You don't need to do this, you've invested in mutual funds. Let's redeem them" I think we're moving in the right direction as a country.

Diversify to Mitigate Risks

All investments carry some degree of risk, but you can reduce risks by diversifying across various asset classes like equity, debt, gold, real estate, etc. Each asset class has its own risk-return profile and they perform differently at different times. By allocating your savings across various assets, you minimize the chances of losing a large part of your portfolio due to any single event. This time-tested principle is - do not put all your eggs in one basket. Spread your risks evenly.

Stay Rational in Volatile Markets

Equity markets will inevitably witness volatility and corrections from time to time. However, do not get unnerved by this. Stay calm and rational without getting influenced by extreme market movements. Sometimes, the best strategy is to stay put and ride out the storm instead of panicking and exiting the market at the wrong time. Like an able captain sailing on the high seas, keep your focus on the destination and do not get distracted by the gusts and waves. Irrational decisions often turn out to be costly in the long run.

Acquire Basic Financial Literacy

You do not need to be a financial wizard, but acquire basic literacy regarding different investment products and their risks and returns. This will help you take informed decisions and avoid pitfall. For instance, understand the difference between real estate, equity, debt and gold products. Learn about asset allocation, inflation, taxation, risk profiling among other concepts. You can start small and increase your knowledge. An informed investor has a tremendous advantage.

When you're sick, you visit a doctor and then get medicine from a chemist. Similarly, for investing, consult a good advisor with your savings details and goals, then invest based on their advice. Many online sites can also guide you.

But don't delay; start early. The saying "Do tomorrow's work today, today's work now" fits well with investing.

Customize Investments to Your Needs

There is no one-size-fits-all approach to investing. Your financial decisions should be tailored to factors like your income, risk appetite, investment goals and time horizon. For instance, a young person can take higher risks for higher returns, while an older investor close to retirement would need a more stable portfolio. Similarly, investing a surplus or investing your retirement corpus require different strategies. Always customize your investment plan based on your unique situation and needs.

Leverage India's Growth Story

India is witnessing rapid economic development which is creating tremendous opportunities for investors, both retail and institutional. Sectors like financial services, IT, pharmaceuticals, consumer goods, infrastructure and manufacturing are key to India's growth trajectory. Align your investments to sectors that benefit from India's growth. Companies with sound business models in these sectors have the potential to create substantial wealth for investors over the long term. A mutual fund (MF) is a balanced choice to

participate in this growth, benefiting the distributor, fund manager and investor alike. Mutual Fund Distributors help investors buy and sell, while fund managers pool investor money into stocks, bonds, and short-term debt. Investors gain when returns are good.

Stay Disciplined and Focused

People often think investing is simple and SIP returns are steady. But the "Āgni Pariksha" or real test for SIP investors was in March 2020. Returns were negative for three years, low for 5-7 years, and moderate for 7-10 years. Only those who stayed invested are seeing double-digit returns now.

The road to financial freedom requires cultivating financial discipline and keeping the bigger picture in mind. There will be many temptations to divert you from your path, but stay focused on your goal. Keep learning and updating your knowledge. Do not get affected by fear or greed. Investing is a marathon, not a sprint. With the right savings and investment habits cultivated over many years, you will eventually reach your destination. Financial freedom is waiting for you in the future if you stay steadfast in your journey.

The suggestions above cover some key practical aspects of how one can progress towards financial freedom. The process requires time and patience, but is very achievable. With the right discipline and focus, you can build the investment portfolio that will liberate you financially and give you the life you desire. The journey will have its share of ups and downs, but you have to power through without losing hope or direction. Stay balanced in your approach and your efforts will bear fruit. Financial freedom is not a myth; it can become a reality with commitment and perseverance. Make a beginning today. Your future self will thank you.



NILESH SHAH

Mr. Nilesh Shah Group President, Managing Director Kotak Mahindra Asset Management Company (KMAMC) & Managing Director of Kotak AMC. He lead his team to the Best Fund House of the Year Award during his stint with Kotak, ICICI Prudential and Franklin Templeton Mutual Fund. He is a part time member of the Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister and Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI). He is a member of the Board of Association of Mutual Funds in India and a Member of CoBoSAC committee of SEBI





Planning for *Life's Financial Goals* with Mutual Funds

By Shamsher Singh, Managing Director & Chief Executive Officer,
SBI Funds Management Limited

India is one of the fastest growing economies amongst the global economies and stands out as a beacon of potential with its diverse demographic and entrepreneurship zeal. This potential is not just reflected in the recent surge in equity markets but also in the aspirations of countless new investors who are eager to participate in this growth story. Retail Investors today are acting as a counterweight to Foreign Institutional Investors, by investing through Systematic Investment Plans (SIPs) at a record pace. New SIP account registrations reached a record high with monthly inflows of Rs. 17,610 crore and 7.64 crore SIP accounts as of December 2023. A large number of these investments are by new investors, each with dreams of wealth creation for their financial goals in life.

The Journey to Financial Freedom

For many, financial independence is the culmination of years of hard work, careful planning between needs and wants. While some might achieve financial freedom sooner, for the majority of investors, reaching milestones like purchasing a house, funding a child's aspiration, or securing a comfortable retirement takes significant hard work, time, and commitment. The journey begins by adopting a simple yet powerful mindset of saving and investing first while spending what is left, often called delayed gratification. This simple yet foundational principle is usually the bedrock for a secure financial future.

Simple Yet Smart Financial Habits

Starting small, saving, and investing consistently is the first step on this path. Prioritize setting aside a portion of income regularly. This practice establishes a solid financial foundation, enabling the pursuit of larger goals down the road. Make a percentage of your monthly income, a non-negotiable part of your financial routine. This powerful habit inculcates financial discipline and smoothes a lot of budgetary concerns ahead in life.

Consider this, every rupee saved today becomes a stepping stone towards your tomorrow's aspirations. Small contributions made consistently, through a Systematic Investment Plan (SIP), can accumulate into substantial amounts over time. It is the financial equivalent of planting seeds that,

with nurturing and patience, grow into fruit-bearing trees.

What Next? Invest Your Savings!

Once you start saving, the logical question is what to do next? Savings alone are unlikely to provide the growth needed to achieve long-term financial goals. Your hard-earned money needs to be invested wisely. But where to invest? Investing can be daunting, as it needs a plan, research and understanding several interlinked factors that affect markets, economy, and your own personal financial needs.

In such a situation, solutions like mutual funds can be a favourable option, as expert fund managers professionally and transparently manage these. The fact that the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) regulates mutual funds, adds another layer of trust for investors which has ensured that the industry has evolved with changing times to ensure that investors' interest remain at the center of the industry.

Diversification and Risk Management

Mutual funds offer a practical solution for those seeking to invest without being overwhelmed by the complexities of the financial markets. One of the key benefits is diversification. When you invest in a mutual fund, your money is pooled together with that of other investors. This pooled fund is then invested in a diversified portfolio of assets such as stocks (domestic and international), bonds, commodities (like gold, silver, etc.) or a mix of all. This diversification optimizes risk as which asset class will do well in a particular year cannot be

predicted so diversification remains the better solution and mutual funds offer solutions accessible to a common investor.

Furthermore, the funds are managed by experienced professionals who carefully analyze market trends and make informed investment decisions on your behalf. This expertise can help navigate the potential complexities of the financial world thus lending you an opportunity to invest your money for potentially better returns over the long term.

Start Early, Seek Qualified Advice, and Stay Focussed

As millions of new investors embark on this investing journey for their financial goals, it is crucial to get the basics right. This journey is not just about some numbers, it is about achieving aspirations, realizing goals, and securing stability for yourself and your loved ones.

In this pursuit, remember that well-begun ensures that your investing journey is half done. To get the results suited for your personal financial needs, as an investor, try to start your investments as early as possible. Moreover, do not take arbitrary decisions on buying and selling investment products. It is always a good idea to reach out to qualified financial advisers to assist you in your investments-related decisions. Finally, as your income grows in your career or profession, ensure that you step-up or increase your investment in line with your growing lifestyle.

Let me leave you with a thought to ponder upon. If you start with a monthly SIP of, say Rs 10,000 when you turn 30 years old, and increase the SIP amount by 10% every year,

you are likely to save more for the different financial goals in your life than if you choose to keep the SIP amount as Rs.10,000 only till you turn 50 years old. Most of us in life's daily activities forget to align our investments in line with our aspirations and lifestyle ending up with a smaller corpus in retirement than we would like.

The entire investment journey is about setting and achieving goals, adapting to changing circumstances, and maintaining a resilient approach even in the face of challenges. As you, as an investor, set your eyes on your long-term aspirations, your commitment, discipline, and decisions will steer you towards achieving your financial goals in life and a fulfilling future.



SHAMSHER SINGH

Mr. Shamsher Singh, Deputy Managing Director of State Bank of India (SBI), is on deputation to SBI Funds Management Limited (SBIFML) since November 2022.

He joined SBI in June 1990 and has more than 32 years of rich experience working with SBI in various verticals. He has worked in different geographical locations in India and abroad heading various business functions.

He is a commerce graduate from Delhi University, Certified Associate from Indian Institute of Bankers and is a certified Anti Money Laundering Specialist (ACAMS).



Exchange Traded Funds

A Powerful Investment Vehicle

By Swarup Anand Mohanty, Vice Chairman & CEO,
Mirae Asset Investment Managers (India) Pvt. Ltd.

On January 18, 2024, the world got to know that at the end of December 2023, passive mutual funds including Exchange Traded Funds (ETFs) held about \$13.3tn in assets in US while active funds had just over \$13.2tn. This means that for the first time AUM under passive investment strategy in the United States was more than the AUM under active investment in the United States. Passive mutual funds were merely around 25% a decade ago.

We have recently seen a similar trend in passive funds and specially ETFs in India. Share of passive in total mutual funds AUM has increased from 6 % in 2019 to approx. 18% by the end of 2023. The share of passive folios count has increased from 2% in 2019 to 15% in 2023.

ETFs account for 75% of the total AUM in passive category.

Passive Fund like ETFs are types of mutual funds that aim to track the performance of a specific index. For example: A NIFTY 50 ETF will be investing in securities, in the exact same proportion as present in NIFTY 50 Index and in order to generate return similar to NIFTY 50 Total Return Index. It's a simple yet powerful investment method, which carries low cost and doesn't carry the risk of underperformance like Active funds does.

Additionally, ETFs can be bought and sold on exchange just like stocks at their intra day value, unlike Mutual funds which can only be purchased at day close NAV.

Though ETFs have been in existence in India for 22 years, the growth in ETF has been actually witnessed in last 5-6 years. Some of the reasons which have contributed to rise in ETF AUM in India are:

- Low cost and focussed approach to mirror the portfolio and performance of an underlying index like Nifty 50, Nifty Bank, Nifty Midcap 150 etc, makes it a power medium to do robust asset allocation.
- Since ETFs mirror underlying index, it doesn't carry the risk of fund manager underperformance which has been seen in active mutual fund industry especially in the large cap space, making investors evaluate the merit of paying higher expense ratio cost

for active funds.

- Government's use of ETFs as a preferred route for disinvestment has increased the participation of retail investors
- ETFs are being used by EPFO and private PF bodies to take exposure to the equity market
- ETFs can be based on indexes which track certain market segments or asset classes or a specific sector or theme or may be based on single or multiple strategies. These innovative ETFs are providing investors the opportunity to take exposure in several unique and attractive segments like Artificial Intelligence, Electric Vehicles etc.

As of December 2023, close, there were a total of 190 ETFs in India, which comprised of 141 equity index ETFs, 24 debt index ETFs, 15 gold ETFs and 10 silver ETFs. Total Trading volume in ETF stood at Rs. 26,000 Cr in FY 2016- 2017. This has increased to Rs. Rs. 120,000 Cr in FY 22-23 and for the 9 month of FY 23-24 it has already crossed Rs. 120,000 Cr.

The most popular ETFs are obviously

the one tracking broad based indices such as S&P500, Nifty50 etc, since as the market becomes informationally more efficient, outperforming the benchmark becomes progressively difficult and it becomes more prudent to invest in market tracking funds like ETFs

Further, both globally and in India, people are finding theme based and strategy-based ETFs increasingly attractive to target a certain emerging segment like Artificial Intelligence, FANG, Manufacturing etc or a certain risk or return profile like Low Volatility, High Dividend etc.

Going forward, the penetration of passive funds will further increase not only through plain vanilla products like Nifty 50 but also through innovative offerings. With rise in investor awareness and DIY investing, increase in retail participation can provide next inflection point in the journey of ETFs in India.



SWARUP ANAND MOHANTY

Mr. Swarup Anand Mohanty is the Vice Chairman & Chief Executive Officer of Mirae Asset Investment Managers (India) Private Limited. As a financial group Mirae Asset takes a collaborative approach in managing a fully diversified investment platform. Mr. Mohanty has over 29 years of experience in the field of financial services including 20 years plus experience in Asset Management Sales. He is overall responsible for the India AMC. Mirae Asset Mutual Fund is driven with an idea of providing innovative investment solutions and help its Partners & Investors construct portfolios





Mutual Funds and New Fund Offerings (NFO)

By Maj Gen Neeraj Varshney, VSM

Almost every one these days gets unlimited “stock tips” which could double in one month on the internet and social media. If people knew the future so well and all of those tips were reliable, all of us could have taken premature retirement a long time ago and would be relaxing on a beach in Jamaica sipping a Pinacolada.

But all such measures and attempts should be dissuaded and discouraged because we must not equate stock markets with a gambling den or a race track, where one puts his or her money on a horse or a number and then either loses all or wins big. On such risky gambles, the probability of losing is extremely high and gaining very poor as described by

the Nobel laureate Kahneman in his Prospect Theory.

Very simply put, stock markets are a structured system to participate in the business growth of a company by being a part owner of a business which you have bought. The profits generated by that business or company are shared between all share holders on a pro-rata basis (infantry officers can understand it too well !!). And stable well-earning businesses do not double their profits every month, thus, stocks which can give 100% returns in a month are a rarity and an aberration, just like a guy hitting a jackpot has a one in a million chance.

In the last few months, a lot of

retirees are unsure of where to deploy their retirement benefits. A lot of army personnel are contacted by MF advisors or bank representatives or insurance agents to help them deploy their money. Army personnel usually have far too many MF schemes in which they have invested their money. Some have as many as twenty schemes. And another major problem which most of investors face is that their investment time horizon is very short and they think three years is a long term.

Undoubtedly, the best method to participate in stock markets for novices and financially uneducated and inexperienced investors is the mutual fund route. Caveat, one

should have an outlook of minimum ten years and not two or three years. Money walks and grows like a tortoise. Slow and steady. One will certainly beat the returns from Defence Services Officers’ Provident Fund (DSOPF) or Armed Forces Personnel Provident (AFPP) Fund hands down if you have a 10 to 20 year outlook on the direct growth options of MF schemes.

Being greedy as we are (it is a basic human instinct which drives a majority of us), we start looking at the Net Asset Value (NAV) every day. And switch schemes or sell very early. The investor returns are always lesser than the MF returns. Majority of investors are never able to capture the returns which the MF Schemes have made because they lose patience and sell too early.

The second problem is of investing in too many funds in the portfolio. As has been proven by empirical data to back up, only about 10-15% of all MF schemes give a return greater than the index returns. And within that band of 10-15%, the post expenses returns vary between 0.5 to 3% higher.

Why does it happen that way? The answer is simple, the returns are based on two things – the stocks the fund house owns and the expenses it makes annually. Almost all MFs have the same top holdings, only their number of shares of a particular company vary. HDFC Balanced may have 50 crores invested in Reliance whereas IDFC Premier Equity may have 70 crores in Reliance. I picked up one scheme each of a diversified equity fund from ten different AMCs and found that the stocks held by them were similar. Only the proportion was different – Reliance, Infosys, TCS, HCL, SBI, ICICI, HDFC

Bank, Tata Motors, Maruti Suzuki, Bajaj Auto, ITC, P&G, Asian Paints, L&T, Tata Steel, JSW Steel, Dr Reddy, Cipla etc. So how can their returns be very different? Some fund managers hold on to more cash or are lucky to take advantage of low prices and give a little better return. **Investors would do well to stay the course of 10-15 years at least with a good MF scheme.**

In one of the cases, a Veer Nari was being heckled by someone in her bank to switch her existing MF schemes to a new fund offering (NFO) of Union Business Cycle Fund. She needed a periodic income and had invested bulk of whatever she had received from AGIF and the army in Dividend Options of various MF schemes. So far so good. They were all generally good schemes and had been paying a respectable dividend also.

But should she invest in the NFO? Investors should avoid NFOs. Let us understand a mutual fund and a New Fund Offering (NFO). A mutual fund is pooling in of money “mutually” by various persons and giving it to a certain Mr. ABC to invest in stock markets on their behalf. ABC is now our Fund Manager. Since, ABC may not be known to us and we want some backing and assurance of a big name, so a company like HDFC Bank or Union Bank hires ABC to manage the fund and launches a new fund. Union Bank becomes the Asset Management Company (AMC). How does Union get people to invest in the mutual fund? It advertises, markets and picks a theme for the new fund. It could launch a new scheme called XYZ. The new scheme would be a New Fund Offer (NFO). And it could have a charter that XYZ Fund would invest only in companies where there is a potential of corpus

of 1 lakh crore and above. So, ABC and his team will start researching for companies which meet that criteria, telecom companies, coal companies, arms manufacturers etc.

Another Veer Nari was also facing a similar dilemma. She was being asked to invest in the NFO of Union Business Cycle Fund. The banker could not explain what was so unique about the fund which was not available already in the market place through other Growth Options of Equity MFs. If one were to read the objective of the scheme, one would realise that it would invest in businesses. What do other mutual funds do? They also invest in businesses. All businesses undergo ups and downs or “stages of a business cycle”. So, this NFO was also like old wine in a new bottle.

The NFOs issue new units at Rs 10/- per unit. The first mistake that investors make is, they equate NFOs with initial public offerings (IPO) of stocks. They are as different as chalk from cheese. The MF will deduct the advertising, marketing and distribution expenses from your Rs 10/-. Then, ABC’s salary plus the brokerage on the shares purchased/sold by the fund would also be a cost attributed to the investor. By the way, the MF House would also pay some commission to the agent or person ‘advising/ motivating’ the investors to make a switch or apply in the NFO and that commission also goes from your pocket in case of the regular schemes of the NFOs. These days all banks have given instructions to their staff to garner subscriptions for various schemes, Mutual funds, Fixed Deposits, Loans, Credit Cards etc from their customers. Nothing wrong in it. But since they get incentives on it, they end up trying to give our Veer Naris



and Ex Servicemen very poor advice. For a typical new open ended fund offering, the recurring expenses could be 2.5% for the first 100 crores of assets, 2.25% for the next 300 crores, 2% for the next 300 crores, and then 1.75% for the balance. So, a fund which garners about 700 crores can easily spend upto 8.5% or 85 paise from the Rs 10 of its Net Asset Value of the unit at the start point. An investor would thus, start with an NAV of Rs 9.15/- for each unit bought for Rs 10/-. Funny, that one has to earn a return of approx 10% to just reach the purchase price. This process is called amortization of expenses. And MF AMCs take advantage of it. Thus, most of the people who apply in NFOs have difficulty in initial years and the NAV of their units would be below the purchase price. QED.

What Should Investors Do?

Step 1. Do not apply for MF NFOs unless there is something unique or new to offer in terms of investing style or restriction of number of stocks or lesser turnover of stocks by the MF. Your agent/advisor would always encourage you into investing in NFOs because his/her commission is maximum in NFOs.

Step 2. Find a good fund which has least expense ratio and has given a better return compared to returns of an index fund in the last 5 to 10 years.

Step 3. Instead of putting Rs 50000/- and buying 5000 units @ Rs 10 in an NFO, it may be a better idea to buy 2000 units of any established running MF Scheme (Direct Option) with NAV of Rs 25/-. You would be investing in a fund where initial

expenses have been amortized and the returns should be similar or more. A gain of 20% in both from start point would result in an NAV of Rs 9.15+1.83=10.18 in the first NFO and your 50000 would become Rs 54900/- at the end of year one whereas in the second fund, it would become Rs (25+5)=30x2000=Rs 60,000 because there are no amortization charges on this MF Scheme.

The optimal solution would be to pick one or two funds/ schemes of reputed AMCs. Start an auto pilot systematic investment plan (SIP). Keep the SIP going for at least ten years on a monthly basis. Do not look at where the index or Mr Market is. And have the discipline and patience to reap the rewards after that period. If one has to compare returns then they should be compared over at least one bear and one bull cycle and within same time periods. For example a period of returns from March 2006 to March 2012 could give one an idea of what kind of returns to expect. If an investor had commenced a SIP of Rs 5000/- per month, one would have invested Rs 3,65,000/- it would have been worth Rs 5,60,000/- or so, giving a CAGR or XIRR of 14% or thereabouts. One should not get swayed by one year returns of schemes, they are part of the marketing gimmicks because they always give a rider in the end, "MF returns are subject to market risks and the performance may or may not be repeated in future".

Pick any one good direct growth option of a Equity Based MF Scheme and leave your money for the long haul. These funds should give an investor above index returns in the long run.



**MAJ GEN NEERAJ
VARSHNEY, VSM**

An alumnus of National Defence Academy, Khadakvasla. Commissioned into Indian Army in 1986 in the Corps of EME.

Has attended the Defence Services Staff College Course at Wellington, the Higher Command Course at Army War College and the APPPA Course at IIPA, New Delhi.

He has ample operational command & staff experience. Notable being AQ(Ops) of a Strike Corps, Col GS Faculty of Studies at War College, Director (Ops & Plans) at EME Directorate, Army HQ, Command of 12 RAPID EME Bn, Brig EME of 16 Corps, Commandant of 512 Army Base Wksp, DDG Tech Int in DIA and ADG EME at Army HQ.

Prudent Investments After Retirement

By Lt Col Rajesh Tiwary (Retd), Jt Dir (EMI), AGIF



Investing after retirement comes with its own set of challenges, as the financial landscape changes when individuals transition from their working years to a period of relying on retirement savings for income. Challenges associated with investing after retirement could be:-

- **Market Volatility.** Retirees may have a lower risk tolerance due to a reduced ability to recover from market downturns. Sharp declines in the market can significantly impact retirement portfolios, potentially affecting the income stream.
- **Longevity Risk.** With increasing life expectancies, retirees face the risk of outliving their savings. It becomes crucial to ensure that investments generate enough income to sustain a potentially longer retirement period.
- **Inflation.** Inflation erodes the purchasing power of money over time. Retirees need to invest in assets that can provide returns

that outpace inflation to maintain their standard of living.

- **Decline in Interest Rates.** Persistently low interest rates can pose a challenge for retirees seeking income from fixed-income investments like bonds. It may be difficult to generate sufficient returns without taking on higher levels of risk.
- **Healthcare Expenses.** Healthcare expenses tend to increase with age and retirees may face unexpected medical costs. Planning for healthcare expenses is essential, and investment decisions should consider potential future medical needs.
- **Appropriate Withdrawal Strategy.** Deciding on an appropriate withdrawal strategy is crucial. Retirees need to balance withdrawing enough to meet living expenses while ensuring that the portfolio can sustain withdrawals over the long term.

- **Taxes.** Managing taxes becomes more complex in retirement, especially with withdrawals from different types of accounts. Tax-efficient withdrawal strategies can impact the overall after-tax income.
- **Lack of Regular Income.** Unlike a steady monthly pay during one's working years, retirees may need to create a reliable income stream from their investments. Designing an income strategy that provides stability while considering market conditions is important.
- **Cognitive Decline.** As individuals age, there may be a decline in cognitive abilities. Managing a complex investment portfolio may become challenging. Retirees may need assistance or automated solutions to ensure sound financial decisions.

To navigate these challenges, retirees often benefit from a well-



thought-out retirement plan, regular financial reviews, and, in some cases, consultation with financial advisors. Diversification, periodic rebalancing, and adjusting investment strategies based on changing circumstances can help address these challenges and provide a more secure financial future in retirement.

Prudent investments

A prudent investment is one which is made after making careful and sensible financial decisions to preserve and grow capital. While planning the concept of minimising loss through prudent investments, several factors could be considered:-

- **Diversification**

- o Diversifying investments across different asset classes like stocks, bonds and real estate can help spread risk and reduce the impact of poor performance in any single investment.
- o Geographic diversification across different markets and regions can also be beneficial

- **Risk Assessment**

- o Understanding and assessing the risk associated with each investment is crucial. Different investments carry different levels of risk and aligning investments with your risk tolerance is important.
- o Conservative investments may be suitable for those seeking to minimize risk, such as government bonds or blue-chip stocks.

- **Long Term Perspective**

- o Adopting a long-term

investment horizon allows investors to ride out short-term market fluctuations and benefit from the compounding effect over time.

- o Panic selling during market downturns can lead to significant losses; a long-term perspective helps avoid impulsive decisions.

- **Research and Due Diligence.**

- o Thorough research and due diligence before making any investment decisions are essential.
- o Understanding the fundamentals of an investment, its historical performance and future prospects can help in making informed choices.

- **Professional Advice.** Seeking advice from financial professionals, such as financial advisors or investment experts, can provide valuable insights and guidance based on individual financial goals and risk tolerance.

- **Emergency Fund.**

- o Maintaining an emergency fund can prevent the need to sell investments at unfavourable times.
- o This fund serves as a financial cushion during unexpected expenses or income disruptions.

- **Regular Monitoring.**

- o Regularly reviewing and rebalancing your investment portfolio helps ensure that it aligns with one's financial goals and risk tolerance.

- o Market changes and shifts in economic conditions may require adjustments.

- **Quality Investments.**

- o Focusing on high-quality, fundamentally sound investments can contribute to a more stable and resilient portfolio.
- o This may involve investing in companies with strong financials, competitive advantages and proven track records.

One must remember that all investments carry some level of risk and there are no guarantees in the financial markets. Prudent investing involves a thoughtful and strategic approach tailored to individual financial goals and circumstances. It is advisable to stay informed, adapt to changing market conditions and make adjustments to one's investment strategy as needed.



LT COL RAJESH TIWARY (RETD)

Lt Col Rajesh Tiwary (Retd) served in the Army from 1981 to 2002. He worked in the Corporate Sector for 15 years and is currently employed in the AGIF as Jt Dir (EMI).



Multi Asset Allocation Strategy

By Kalpen Parekh, Managing Director & CEO, DSP Asset Managers Private Limited

We have all heard the statement “Don’t put all your eggs in one basket”. This is a founding principle when it comes to the world of investing. While personal finance is deeply personal and no two people can have the same portfolio preferences, there are some basic tenets of investing which do not change. Diversification is one such key principle; let us understand the problem statements and plausible solutions for the same.

Investors tend to overexpose themselves to that one asset class or product where they have most comfort, in psychological realms displaying strong familiarity and endowment bias. So, one will find

huge disposition in an investor portfolio to any single asset class be it Land/ Real estate, Bank FDs, Gold or Equity at any given point of time. Real estate is not the most liquid or highest return generator, bank deposits and gold may not be the best wealth creators over longer periods of time, while Equity can be too volatile in the short term. No one asset class can deliver at all points of time in a linear fashion.

Ever noticed the magnificence and the durability of an aeroplane? A massive metal machine soaring the skies with impeccable elegance. What is this wonder machine made of? If you are thinking Aluminium, you are on the

right track. But introduce elements like copper or zinc into its structure, and voilà! You get an alloy that's not only stronger but also corrosion-resistant which then becomes an indispensable part of aircraft design. This idea of transformation, the metallurgical magic of combining diverse elements to produce something stronger and more resilient, finds an exciting parallel in the world of investments with Multi Asset Allocation (MAA) strategies. Spreading your investments across different asset types helps reduce risk and potentially even enhance long-term returns.



Correlation Among Different Asset Classes: Why MAA Works

A Multi-asset Allocation strategy (MAA) just hits differently. MAA strategy's effectiveness lies in its ability to extract value from low correlations between different asset classes. When assets have low or negative correlations, they don't all move in the same direction simultaneously. Let us take some random periods and check asset class returns to corroborate the point:

- From Jan 2013 to Dec 2016 when Equity delivered an absolute return of 45%, Gold delivered -9% and Debt matched equity by returning 40%
- From Jan 2005 to Dec 2009, Debt delivered an absolute return of 35% while Equity and Gold both returned 175%
- From Jan 2008 to Dec 2013, when Gold thrived by delivering 175% stocks struggled by giving only 10% return for the same period and Debt safely added 35%

(Nifty 50 TRI has been taken for Equity return, Gold in INR for Gold returns and Crisil 10 year Gild Index for Debt return. All returns are depicted in absolute for easier concept clarity)

Thus, it is quite evident that it can be a daunting task to predict which asset class will outperform in the short term or even next 3 years. MAA helps you navigate this uncertainty by mixing it up, ensuring your portfolio isn't overly dependent on one asset class's performance.

The simple story here is that no single asset class outperforms

every time. The rankings change, and each of them can both outperform or underperform. The case for Multi Asset Allocation Funds, the financial equivalent of our alloyed aluminium is now quite strong, if you've gone through the evidence above. To summarize in favour of MAA:

- **Acts as a Shield Against Fluctuations:** Just as diverse elements provide strength to Aluminium; different asset classes offer a protective barrier against the fickle nature of domestic or global events.
- **Helps You Tap Correctly into Diversity:** A correctly diversified portfolio by its very nature won't always be the best performer. But in times when things aren't looking good, the different elements will play their part to reduce the impact of fluctuations, thereby helping you survive better, and for much longer.
- **Dynamic Portfolio Management:** With a pulse on domestic and global trends, a good strategy manager will recalibrate and shuffle assets, ensuring that the investment mix remains optimal, much like a metallurgist refining an alloy formula depending on evolving needs.
- **Taxation:** There is clear tax efficiency embedded in the very structure of a multi asset allocation strategy, when run as a mutual fund. Unlike individual investors who face tax impact each time they buy/ sell stocks or funds or rebalance their portfolios, these funds can recalibrate allocation without triggering tax liabilities for investors.

Multi Asset Allocation or its abbreviation "MAA" is a thoughtful choice, not just a happy coincidence. Just like your mother is always there

to take care of you, this strategy's very aim is to make your investing journey smoother and keep your long-term game on point.



KALPEN PAREKH

Mr Kalpen Parekh is the Managing Director & CEO of DSP Asset Managers Private Limited. He has over two decades of experience in finance and asset management. Prior to joining DSP, Mr. Parekh was responsible for growing businesses at IDFC Mutual Fund, Birla Sun Life Asset Management Company Limited and ICICI Prudential Asset Management Company Limited. He is passionate about behavioural finance and believes that investor behaviour is one of the most crucial aspects to a good investment experience. Mr. Parekh holds a master's degree in management studies in finance from the Narsee Monjee Institute of Management Studies and a bachelor's degree in chemical engineering from Bharati Vidyapeeth, Pune.



Don't Let These Common Misconceptions on Investing Sway You!

By B Gopkumar, Managing Director & Chief Executive Officer
Axis Asset Management Company Ltd

In the last few years, there have been several initiatives to increase awareness about investing amongst investors. Despite that, some common misconceptions continue to prevail. It is a myth that 'Investing is complicated and meant only for the rich or those with a big stomach for risk.' The truth is that you don't need a degree in finance or accounting to be a successful investor. With help from professionals and initiatives on your behalf to take ownership of your investment portfolio, you can make wise investment decisions just as well.

You just don't have to let some of these common misconceptions sway you from your goal or even getting started in the first place!

Is There a Right Time to Enter the Market?

No one can guarantee when the market will perform well. Surely you can make predictions but even

the most seasoned market advisors will not be able to tell you when you should enter/exit the market. The answer is that you just enter! What investors must understand is that time invested in the market is more important than timing the market. When you invest, the ideal approach should be to invest for the long time to ensure capital appreciation and wealth creation.

Risk is Bad for Investors

Is it, really? Seasoned investors understand that risk and returns go hand in hand. Investors think that taking high risk will give them high returns, but that's not the reality. Truth be told, taking low risk can also give you reasonable returns. There is no investment which comes



with 'No risk'; taking calculated risks is what is important. Investors must aim for 'risk-adjusted' returns and that will change your perspective!

Pull All Money Out When Markets are Down!

As retail investors, it is easy to get swayed by everyday market news. Continuously reacting to market volatility can jeopardize returns. Temporary market upheaval cannot be treated as a benchmark for future returns. When you are investing for the long run, it is important that you understand how certain standard risks can affect your portfolio and make the necessary corrections in your strategy to protect it. Reacting to news on continuous basis and taking investment decision basis that, might not only hamper return but also the invested corpus.

SIPs are Available Only for Equity Funds

That is not true, even in the least! Debt Funds and Hybrid Funds too have SIP options. *Now, there are funds that allow investors to invest with a sum as low as INR 100! In fact, it is a good idea to invest in multiple assets (like equity, fixed income, hybrid funds) to protect your capital. Having exposure to at least 3-4 asset classes will ensure benefit of diversification.

I Can not Increase My SIP Amount!

To combat this myth, we have the option of Step-Up SIP. A Step-Up SIP is a variation to the traditional SIP approach wherein investors can incrementally increase

their investment amount over time. All investors need to do is assess their long-term goals. It could range anything from retirement planning to buying your dream home to saving up for higher education. Once the goal has been fixed, investors need to calculate how much money they would need at the end of the tenure. Based on this amount, the initial base investment and the suitable step-up percentage can be decided. It is imperative to note that this amount and percentage may vary depending on the investors expected growth in income and the end financial objective.

Is It Really Necessary to Invest in Quality Avenues?

Investing in options that grow exponentially in a short time frame may turn out to be one of the riskiest things one may do. On the other hand, investing in companies that promise quality and growth in the long run can be ideal approach. Quality investing aims to identify opportunities in companies that are backed by strong management and have a proven track record of performance. Even in times of crisis, these companies continue to stay resilient.

Investors need to understand that taking ownership of their investments is the most crucial thing. It is imperative that you invest in yourself by taking the initiative to learn and understand financial terminologies as well. After all, it is your hard-earned money that you are hoping grows well! It is always advisable to take help of your financial advisors before making any investments. Apart from this, don't redeem your portfolio randomly without any specific reason,

'Redeem only when you require it for end use.'

Mutual Fund Investments are subject to market risks, read all scheme related documents carefully.



B. GOPKUMAR

Managing Director & Chief Executive Officer (MD & CEO)
Axis Asset Management Company Ltd.

With almost three decades of experience in the financial services industry, Mr. Gopkumar has successfully navigated challenging roles in sales & distribution and marketing & branding. He is known for his proficiency in managing large teams and building digital ecosystems. Prior to this, he was the MD & CEO of Axis Securities from 2019. Before that, he has chaired leadership positions at several reputed firms including Reliance Securities and Kotak Group. He passionately believes that technology-driven solutions are imperative to empower investors and partners to unlock the true potential of the Indian financial services landscape. He is an avid reader, a fitness enthusiast, and a passionate marathoner.



Mere Sapnon Ka Ghar

A Pragmatic Guide to Real Estate Investment for Indian Army Soldiers

By Colonel Sandeep Sharma, SM, Dir (EMI), AGIF

"Sleep peacefully at your homes. Indian Army is guarding the frontiers."

- Anonymous

The average Indian gets comforted in his home with the above quoted belief and the deep-rooted faith in the Indian Army. However, for an average Indian soldier, the prospect of owning a house of his dreams as per his peculiar requirements in face of unparalleled constraints is a difficult one, if not impossible. The quest for the perfect abode involves navigating through a myriad of choices, legalities and financial considerations and seems daunting, especially for the soldiers hailing from diverse landscapes, cultures and requirements. Due to limited financial capability and frequent transfers, the house should not only

give a roof over his head, but must serve as an instrument of financial security for his family. Apropos, a house of their dreams has emerged as one of the major milestones in life for Indian Army soldiers.

The word Real Estate, derived from Latin and French words 'Real' and 'Estat' literally means 'Real Status'. Though several options for investment exist, owning a house forms part of the basic essential triad of 'Roti, Kapda aur Makaan', and hence holds tremendous sentimental value. Hence it is prudent that the critical decision of buying a house is not based on

sentiments alone but on sound logic and pragmatic financial wisdom. The demand for housing in India is projected to remain robust due to factors such as growing population, urbanization, rising middle class, advent of nuclear families and millennials, upgraded facilities, affordable interest rates, tax benefits, increased accountability post RERA and government aid for low and middle income groups. According to IMARC Group, a leading market research expert, the Indian real estate market is expected to exhibit a growth rate (CAGR) of 9.2% during 2023-2028.



This article explores the peculiar requirements and challenges uniquely faced by Officers as well as Other Ranks while striving to build their **Sapnon ka Ghar**. It further lays down a pragmatic and progressive approach to home buying by covering the associated aspects of **‘Why, What, Where, When and How’** of investment in Real Estate to fulfill the eventual goal of their dream house either pre or post-retirement.

Why is This a Challenge for a Soldier?

- **Ever Growing Needs.** With rapid socio-economic changes, advent of nuclear families, rising aspirations, educated and working spouses, requirement of good educational prospects for children in bigger cities, upgradation of ancestral houses in native towns/ villages seldom meets the aspirations of soldiers or their families. Owning a house provides stability and a sense of predictability for soldiers for future planning who may need to relocate frequently due to postings or transfers.
- **Limited Budget.** There is always a never ending gap between the aspirations and savings/ disposable income of a soldier for purchasing his dream house. This problem is further accentuated for Other Ranks due to short period of assured service, which severely restrains his repaying capacity. High EMIs even at right RoI will squeeze his monthly expenditure and affect his lifestyle adversely.
- **Uncertainty in Duration of Service.** Due to the uncertainty in duration of service linked to promotions and post retirement avenues, especially for Other Ranks, there is always a dilemma as to ‘which product in which location purchased at what time’ shall suit the personal requirements of a soldier and his family. While Tier 1 cities are out of reach, Tier 2 cities don’t seem to have requisite facilities.
- **‘Too soon Vs Too late’.** During his active service, a soldier gets the option of staying in status married accommodation. So, if he buys a house too early in service, the same will be in dilapidated condition by the time he shifts in it post his retirement. Conversely, with the estimated steep escalation in property prices, he may not be able to buy a house after his retirement with his limited savings. He may also not be able to avail Home Loan and thus reap the IT benefits.
- **Lack of Information & Research.** Difficult service conditions in inhospitable terrains, frequent transfers and limited leave severely limits the exposure of soldiers to acquire and absorb the art of home buying. Time is a scarce commodity for serving soldiers and often their own welfare/personal affairs take a back seat. Lack of time to make an informed decision and later for the time consuming process of purchasing a house pose major challenges peculiar to soldiers. Most of the soldiers buy a house in their respective places of posting merely based

on hearsay, in the company of equally misinformed colleagues.

What to Buy in Real Estate?

Just like other asset classes, various investment avenues within

Real Estate come with their own inherent characteristics and challenges.

- **Agricultural Land.** With dwindling water levels, unless the farmer cultivates himself, the returns from agriculture are dismal. Price escalation in farmland is not guaranteed and generally lower as compared to residential or commercial land.
- **Commercial Real Estate.** Apart from being costly, post COVID, even fractional ownership concept is a risky proposition with lower occupancy. Longer lease periods in commercial spaces pose higher risk of legal hassles post lease period.
- **Residential Flats.** Assuming that a soldier takes a house loan for 20 years for buying a flat. While RoI for home loans is hovering around 8-9%, brokerage, depreciation and long term maintenance costs add up to 2-3%, thus translating into an overall impact of 12-13% per annum. Conventional residential flats give only 2-3% rental yield. Even post IT waiver on home loan and projected rental escalation, there a net negative income/ loss of approx 6-7% every year. Unless there is sure shot, commensurate and continuous high escalation in it’s prices, a residential flat doesn’t give as good returns as other alternatives. Moreover, conventional flats with a shelf life of 25-35 years depreciate with each passing year and may not be fit for personal occupation later.
- **Independent House.** Due to heightened land rates and construction cost, purchasing and independent houses is generally not feasible in Tier 1 cities. On the other hand, in Tier 2 cities/ towns, they are not bound to give requisite rental yields. Moreover,

there is a need for monitoring the construction along with lack of amenities coupled with the fear of encroachment.

Where to Buy in Real Estate?

As elucidated above, due to the service conditions and dynamic family obligations, deciding the location of the ultimate retirement home in the initial stages can be a really daunting task. As an interim investment, most of us just buy something lucrative in our respective place of posting based on the advice of our colleagues in the unit/ HQ or some relative wherever they are making their investments. This is an incorrect approach as each individual and his family members have unique requirements, assets, financial appetite and liabilities. Thus everyone must conduct a thorough analysis of his own requirements in consultation with family members. The recommended way to do it is to invest in an upcoming city near respective native place. Alternatively, they can invest in a city where RERA guidelines have been implemented and where one has family or friends to supervise the asset. However, since the residential unit is not required for self-occupation on immediate basis, it is financially prudent to invest either in emerging Tier 2 cities or outskirts of Tier 1 cities, where better integrated development is planned as per the Master Plan.

When to Acquire?

This has a simple answer- As early as possible. Rather than timing the Real Estate market, a serving soldier must start investing in smaller assets within his capability. Alternatively, the initial investment can be made

jointly with family members but with clearly documented share and conditions. This will not only give him the requisite confidence but also build a foundation for the future acquisitions to build up the requisite capital to buy the retirement house as per his prevailing requirements.

So.....How to do it?

‘Rome was not built in a day!’

The above age-old adage attests to the need for time to create great things. For a soldier with limited salary, time, exposure and opportunities, there is an imperative need to adopt a gradual approach wherein a soldier should build the requisite financial muscle to buy the desired house at the time, location and specifications of his choosing as per his personal and family obligations at that point of time. There is a need to start small and gradually climb up the ladder, without compromising on quality of life today.

So, the pertinent question is-What to buy among Real Estate assets as an interim investment to lay the foundation of the ultimate dream house? The answer lies in building a portfolio of **Positive cash flow properties** in a progressive manner. Such properties generate rental income exceeding the expenses associated with owning and maintaining the property. Here are some examples:

- **Affordable Housing Units.** Compact/ budget-friendly housing developments. These units are highly subsidized by the Government and are allotted through Draw of Lots. They have a comfortable payment plan, low maintenance charges and NO hidden charges. Not just the

soldiers, even their children can apply for the same once they turn 18 years old.

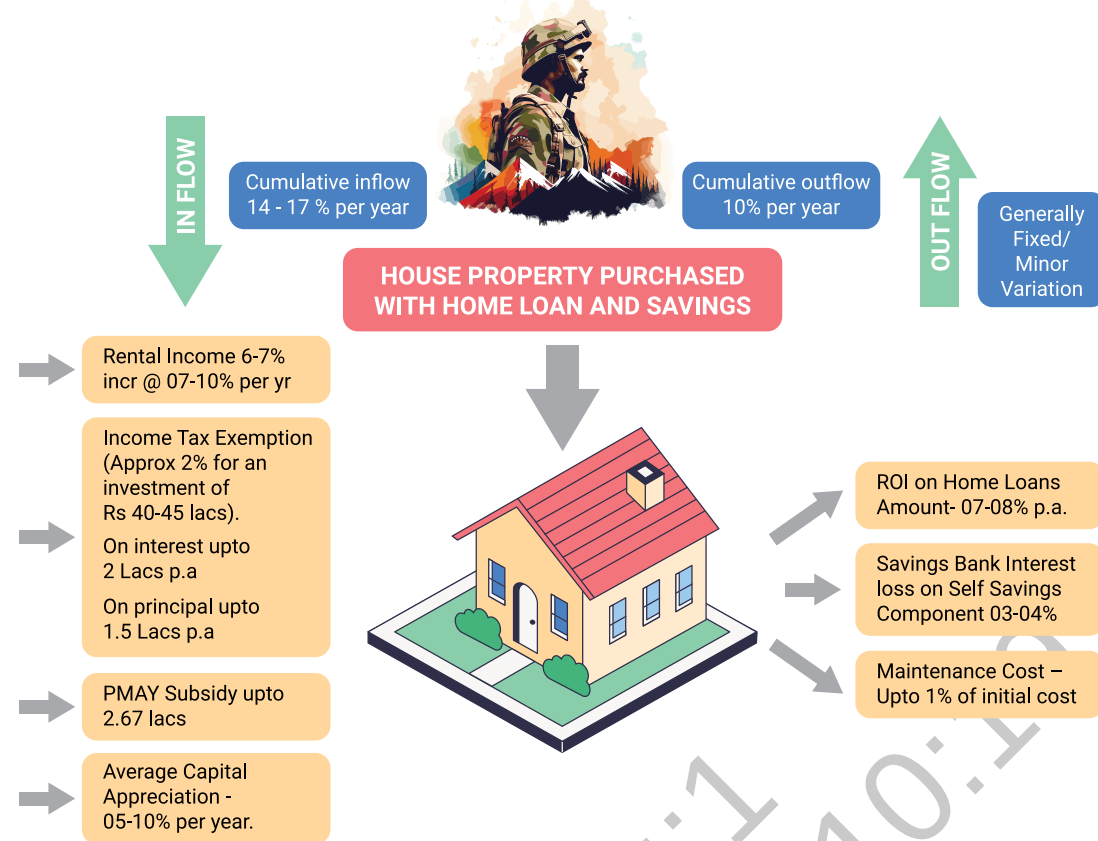
- **Single-Family Homes in High-Demand Areas.** Houses in urban centers, tech hubs, or industrial zones.
- **Student Housing.** Properties near educational institutions or universities, in cities with high student populations.
- **Co-Living Spaces.** Shared accommodations for young professionals by renting out individual rooms or beds.
- **Vacation Rentals.** Properties in tourist destinations can be rented out on platforms like Airbnb or Booking.com.
- **Serviced Apartments.** Furnished/ serviced residences leased out on short-term or long-term basis.
- **Mixed-Use Developments.** Integrated developments combining residential, commercial and retail spaces.
- **Warehouses.** In case of existing ancestral land near industrial parks or for storage of agricultural produce in native villages.

This is How to Do it- The Suggested Approach.....

- **Define Investment Goals.** Clearly define investment objectives, whether it's long-term capital appreciation, rental income or diversification of investment. Adopt a long-term investment perspective, focusing on fundamentals, cash flow generation, and wealth accumulation over time, rather than short-term speculation or market fluctuations.



IN FLOW Vs OUT FLOW



- **Research.** Stay informed about real estate, both nationally and locally. Conduct thorough research, including market analysis, market trends, identify areas with high growth potential, areas undergoing development or regions benefiting from infrastructure projects along with rental yield calculations, and due diligence on expenses to identify and invest in positive cash flow properties. Locations with strong rental demand and potential for appreciation, such as military bases, educational institutions, medical hubs, employment hubs, or upcoming commercial developments are ideal.
- **Financial Planning:** Plan finances prudently, considering loan options, interest rates, tax implications, and potential rental income to ensure the investment aligns with long-term financial goals. Assess present and

estimated financial capability, availability and location of ancestral land and liabilities. If not feasible in individual capacity, assets can be bought jointly as HUF or well-defined and documented partnership with family / friends.

- **Loan.** To augment his financial capability as well as to reap the benefits of IT exemption, a soldier must take home loan as per his capability. He must try to first augment it with personal loans from family and friends by offering them similar or higher rates than the prevailing savings bank interest rates. Since the returns are comparatively more in the range of 6-9% to cover a significant portion of the EMIs, maximum 'fitting and furnishing' loan and even Top Up Loan in future can be taken. One must leverage his advantage of being a Central Govt employee and

negotiate hard for the best bargain on the interest rates. Home loan eligibility as well as reasonable interest rate depends largely on CIBIL score, which must be maintained and improved by ensuring timely payments and using credit wisely. Preferably, Home Loan should be taken from AGIF or Public Sector Banks for higher transparency and low processing charges. The other advantages of Home Loan include authentic

title verification by bank and safe custody of the property documents. All attempts should be made to make timely pre-payments to reduce the burden of interest.

- **Acquire Clean Property.** The property should be duly registered with clear title and should be free of any litigations or encroachments. If bought from a developer, one must opt for Grade A developer under RERA regulations. If constructed, a reliable contractor with proven track record should be chosen. Perform due diligence on property type, size, amenities, construction quality, rental yield potential and exit strategy.
- **Avail Govt Incentives.** Government incentives, such as tax credits, subsidies, or first-time homebuyer programs, can make homeownership more financially attractive. **Government schemes**

such as **Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana (PMAY), Affordable Housing Scheme, Deen Dayal Jan Awas Yojana, Smart Cities Mission, and Affordable Rental Housing Complexes (ARHCs)** aim to address housing shortages and promote affordable housing development. Subsidized interest rate on home loans: Depending on your income group, you can get an interest subsidy of 3% to 6.5% per annum on home loans up to a certain amount and tenure. You need to apply for a home loan from a lender that is approved under the PMAY scheme and offers the interest subsidy. Tax Deduction on Home Loan Interest under Section 24(b) of the Income Tax Act, up to Rs. 2 lakh per annum for a self-occupied property. For a property that is let-out or deemed to be let-out, there is no upper limit on the interest deduction. Homeowners can claim deductions on the principal repayment of home loan up to a maximum of Rs. 1.5 lakh per annum.

- **Leverage Your Benefits as a Soldier.** As a soldier of the Indian army, one must utilise all perks and privileges. For example, access to low-interest loans from AGIF, subsidized housing through AWHO, property tax waiver from State Govts, Defence Quota in Govt Allotment Schemes or other special government schemes to finance property purchase, reduce costs or increase your returns.
- **Leave and License Agreement.** In lieu of Rent Agreement, it is advisable to execute a 'Leave and License' Agreement through which the Landlord grants temporary permission to use the premises on contract basis

for a limited period. Under this contract, the legal interest of tenant is not created. Thus, the landlord has the right to enter the property, while the tenant (License) cannot claim full possession. It makes eviction easier and provides greater powers to the landlord to avoid illegal encroachment and legal complications in future.

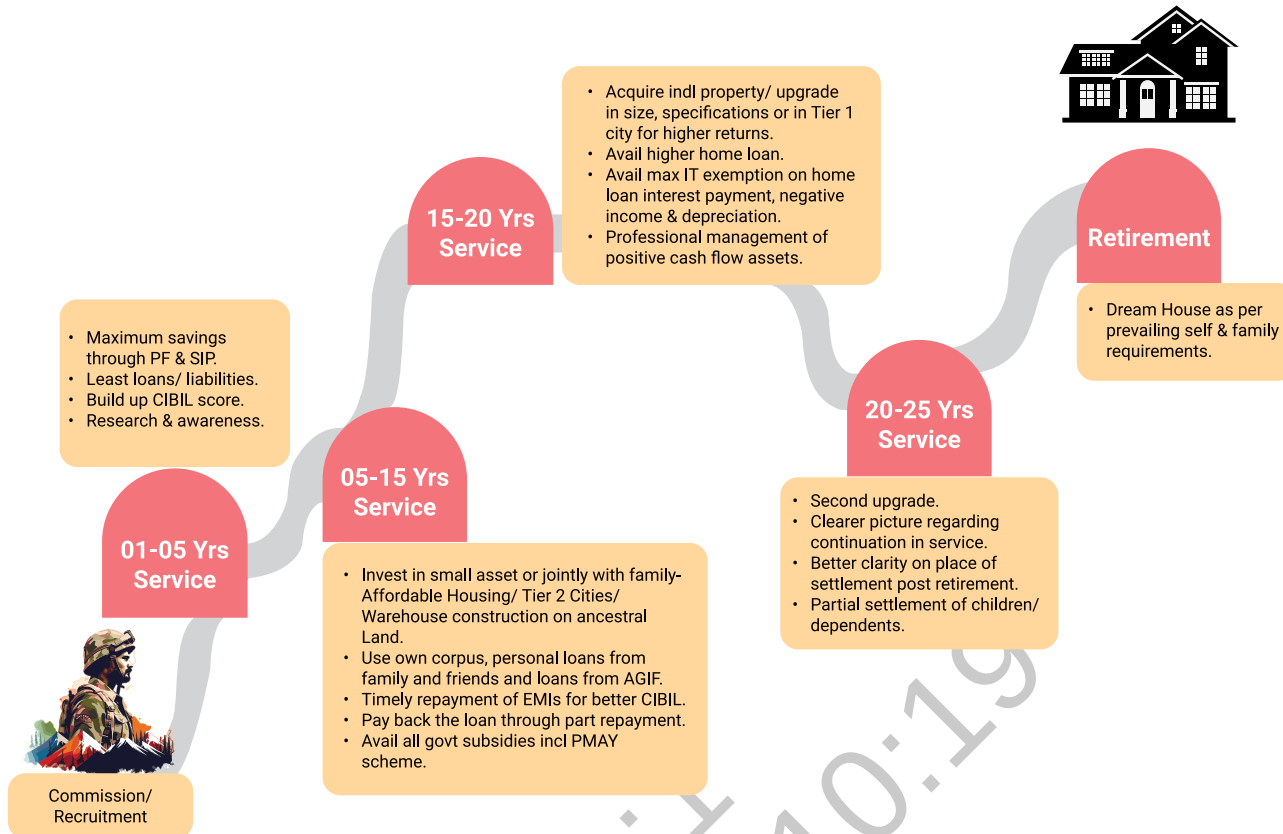
- **Asset Management:** Implement effective asset management strategies to optimize property performance including proactive tenant management, regular maintenance, rental income optimization and capital expenditure planning. Furnished properties give higher rentals returns.
- **Recycle/ Upgrade.** Continuously monitor the real estate market dynamics, rental trends, and property performance. In addition to the annual increase in rentals at a rate equivalent or higher than the inflation, these assets appreciate comparatively faster. Thus, during the upward Real Estate cycle, these properties can be sold/ monetized through Loan against Property (LAP) to buy larger assets or upgrade the existing ones to generate higher rentals.
- **Realise.** Over the years, once the final location and specifications of the house is finalized based on requirements at that time, these assets can be monetized to realise one's dream home.
- **Rent Out.** Meanwhile, if the family is required to stay in a particular city/ town while the soldier is away on field posting, either an SF or rental accommodation can be taken.
- **Diversification:** Personnel with

greater appetite or at a later stage may consider diversifying the investment portfolio in different types of properties (e.g., residential, commercial, or mixed-use) and across different locations to spread risk and maximize returns.

- **Agricultural Land.** In case a soldier has ancestral agricultural land or can acquire it at nominal rates, positive Cash Flow can be generated through resorting to cash crops, organic farming, drip irrigation, tree plantation, construction of warehouses or install solar power panels while availing agricultural sector through subsidies and tax exemption on agricultural income. However, it's essential to conduct proper market research, consider agro-climatic conditions, adopt modern agricultural practices, and ensure access to irrigation facilities and quality inputs.
- **Play as a Team.** If acquiring and managing the properties in individual capacity seems daunting, a group of like-minded soldiers from the same unit/ native place and similar requirements can discuss and explore good opportunities together in same location to monitor the assets on time sharing basis.
- **REIT as Alternative.** In case of limited initial corpus or need for diversification, soldiers may also explore the Real Estate Investment Trust (REIT) route to invest in Real Estate. REIT is a SEBI regulated, tax efficient and professionally managed investment vehicle that allows investors to own in interest income producing real estate to generate regular distribution yields with in-built appreciation.



STEP BY STEP PROCESS TO BUILD YOUR DREAM HOME

The Final Words.....

Overall, the demand for housing in India is expected to remain buoyant in the foreseeable future, driven by demographic, economic, and policy factors. However, challenges such as affordability, urban infrastructure constraints, regulatory hurdles and economic uncertainties need to be addressed to ensure sustainable growth in the housing sector. Buying a house in India offers financial, emotional, and practical benefits along with the emotional satisfaction of owning a home.

By following a systematic approach and considering the above mentioned process, soldiers can easily overcome their predicament to acquire real estate properties that offer both high appreciation potential and rental earnings to build the requisite corpus to eventually realise their lifelong dream of owning the Perfect Home.

"A house is made of bricks and beams. A home is made of hopes and dreams."



COL SANDEEP SHARMA, SM

An alumnus of National Defence Academy, Khadakwasla, the officer got commissioned in the 7th Battalion, the SIKH Light Infantry in Dec 2002, which he later commanded at Ambala Cantt and Siachen (SSW). The officer holds 'Instructor' grading in all the courses incl YOs, Ghatak, JC, TSOC and SC. He was adjudged the 'Best Student' in Tac & SD in TSOC. He has attended the prestigious Naval Higher Command Course at Naval War College. The officer has been awarded 'Sena Medal' (Gallantry) for his gallant action in UN Peace Keeping Mission in DR Congo. He has tenanted instructional appointments in NDA, Khadakwasla and Army War College, Mhow. As GSO 1 (Wpns) at IHQ (MoD) of Army, he played a pivotal role in induction of new age weapons and equipment in IA. The officer is presently tenating the appointment of Director (EMI), AGIF, where he deals with investment of the AGIF Corpus.



Taxation in India

and Ways to Optimise Tax

By Lt Col Dharmjot Singh, SM, Jt Dir (Fin), AGIF

Introduction

Each individual is required to fulfil their tax obligations on earned income as stipulated by the Income-tax Act. The tax rates are proportionate to the income, escalating as earnings increase. Integrally intertwined with financial planning, Tax Planning is a fundamental practice. This strategic approach aids individuals in minimizing their tax liability, consequently preserving a greater portion of their capital. Typically, individuals initiate the process of "Tax Planning" towards the conclusion of the financial year. However, delaying tax planning until the last moment may result in erroneous

investment decisions. Consequently, it is advisable to embark on tax planning at the commencement of the year, ensuring a well-thought-out approach.

In India, the intricate realm of income taxation is governed by an elaborate framework of rules and regulations. This article aims to present an exhaustive examination of income taxation in India, delving into its various constituents, tax structures, and methodologies for optimizing tax liabilities.

Understanding the Components of Income Taxation

Income tax in India is levied on the total income of individuals, Hindu Undivided Families (HUFs), and other entities. The income is broadly categorized into five heads:

- **Income from Salary:** This includes income received by an individual for services rendered as an employee.
- **Income from House Property:** Rental income from owned property falls under this category.
- **Income from Business or Profession:** Profits and gains



derived from a business or profession are considered under this head.

- **Income from Capital Gains:** Profits arising from the sale of capital assets such as property or securities are categorized as capital gains.
- **Income from Other Sources:** Any income not covered under the above heads is included here, such as interest income, winnings from lotteries, and gifts.

Tax Planning

Tax planning is an essential part of financial planning and involves analysing your financial situation, identifying tax-saving opportunities, and implementing strategies to reduce your tax liability. By minimizing your tax burden, you can increase your disposable income and allocate more resources toward achieving your financial goals.

Importance of Tax Planning

Tax planning is important for several reasons as listed below:

- **Minimizing Tax Liability:** Tax planning aims to reduce the amount of tax that an individual or business owes by taking advantage of all available deductions, credits, exemptions, and other tax-saving opportunities.
- **Maximizing Tax Efficiency:** Tax planning seeks to optimize the use of tax-advantaged investment vehicles and strategies, such as retirement plans, tax-deferred accounts, and tax-exempt investments.
- **Achieving Financial Goals:** Tax planning is an integral part

of financial planning and helps individuals and businesses to achieve their financial objectives by minimizing taxes and maximizing after-tax returns.

- **Ensuring Compliance:** Tax planning also involves ensuring compliance with all applicable tax laws and regulations to avoid penalties, fines, and other legal consequences.
- **Managing Risk:** Tax planning also involves assessing and managing tax-related risks, such as the risk of an audit, and taking steps to mitigate those risks.

Types of Tax Planning

Some common types of tax planning system are as follows:

- **Short-term Tax Planning:** This type of tax planning involves taking actions to minimize taxes in the current tax year. It may include deferring income or accelerating deductions to reduce tax liability in the current year.
- **Long-Term Tax Planning:** Long-term tax planning involves taking actions to reduce taxes over a longer period, typically several years or more. It may include strategies such as retirement planning or investment planning.
- **Permissive Tax Planning:** This involves taking advantage of tax breaks or incentives provided by the government to reduce tax liability. Examples include tax deductions for charitable donations or tax credits for energy-efficient investments.
- **Purposive Tax Planning:** Purposive tax planning involves structuring financial transactions or investments to minimize tax

liability. It may involve using legal tax loopholes or tax shelters to reduce taxes.

- **Marginal Tax Planning:** It involves analyzing the impact of additional income or deductions on the taxpayer's marginal tax rate. The goal is to identify the optimal level of income or deductions to minimize taxes.
- **Structural Tax Planning:** Structural tax planning involves reorganizing a business or personal finances to maximize tax efficiency.

Steps to follow While Planning the Taxes

- **Start Early:** It is generally advisable to start tax planning as early as possible rather than waiting until the last minute. By starting early in the year, individuals can ensure they are on track to meet their financial goals while minimizing their tax liability.
- **Assess Your Tax Situation:** The first step in tax planning is to assess your tax situation, including your income, expenses, and deductions. This will help you determine your tax liability and identify areas where you can reduce your taxes.
- **Identify Tax-Saving Opportunities:** The next step is to identify tax-saving opportunities such as deductions, credits, and exemptions that taxpayers can use to lower their tax liability.
- **Develop a Tax-Saving Strategy:** Based on your tax situation in step 1 and the available tax-saving opportunities in step 2, you can develop a tax-saving strategy that minimizes your tax liability and maximizes tax efficiency.

- **Implement Your Tax-Saving Plan:** Once you have developed a tax-saving plan, you need to implement it by taking action to reduce your taxes. This may involve investing, donating to charity, or structuring your business finances tax-efficiently.
- **Monitor Your Tax Situation:** Tax laws and regulations can change over time, so it's important to monitor your tax situation regularly and make adjustments as needed to ensure that your tax plan remains effective.

Optimise Your Taxes

India offers two primary tax regimes under which one can file the tax i.e. The old regime and the new regime. Each has its own tax slabs, deductions, and exemptions. Choosing the right tax regime can help individuals to save income tax.

- **Old Tax Regime:** The old regime is the tax system that prevailed before the introduction of the new regime. Under this regime, there are over 70 exemptions and deductions available, including HRA and LTA, that can reduce your taxable income and lower tax payments. The most popular and generous deduction is Section 80C, which allows for a reduction of taxable income

up to Rs.1.5 lakh. The taxpayers are given a choice between the old and the new tax regime.

- **New Tax Regime:** A new tax regime was introduced in Budget 2020 wherein the tax slabs were altered, and taxpayers were offered concessional tax rates. However, those who opt for the new regime cannot claim several exemptions and deductions, such as HRA, LTA, 80C, 80D and more. Because of this, the new tax regime did not have many takers. The government in Budget 2023 introduced 5 key changes to encourage taxpayers to adopt the new regime.

Comparison of Tax Rates in Old and New Regimes

Income Slab	Old Tax Regime	New tax Regime (until 31st March 2023)	New Tax Regime (From 1st April 2023)
₹0- ₹2,50,000	-	-	-
₹2,50,000 - ₹3,00,000	5%	5%	
₹3,00,000- ₹5,00,000	5%	5%	5%
₹5,00,000- ₹6,00,000	20%	10%	5%
₹6,00,000- ₹7,50,000	20%	10%	10%
₹7,50,000- ₹9,00,000	20%	15%	10%
₹9,00,000- ₹10,00,000	20%	15%	15%
₹10,00,000- ₹12,00,000	30%	20%	15%
₹12,00,000- ₹12,50,000	30%	20%	20%
₹12,50,000- ₹15,00,000	30%	25%	20%
>₹15,00,000	30%	30%	30%

Invest in Tax-Saving Instruments

Tax planning is about how wisely you invest in the right

instruments to achieve your financial goals. The following sections under which the Income Tax Act offer tax deductions and exemptions to reduce your tax liabilities. The

deductions are available from Sections 80C through to 80U and can be claimed by eligible taxpayers.



Sections	Income Tax Deduction for FY 2022-23((AY 2023-24)	Who can Invest?	Maximum deduction available for FY 2022-23 (AY 2023-24)
Section 80C	Investing into very common and popular investment options like LIC, PPF, Sukanya Samriddhi Account, Mutual Funds, FD, child tuition fee, ULIP etc	Individual Or HUF	Upto Rs 1,50,000
Section 80CCC	Investment in Pension Funds	Individuals	
Section 80CCD (1)	Atal Pension Yojana and National Pension Scheme Contribution	Individuals	
Section 80CCD(1B)	Atal Pension Yojana and National Pension Scheme Contribution (additional deduction)	Individuals	Upto Rs 50,000
Section 80CCD(2)	National Pension Scheme Contribution by Employer	Individuals	Amount Contributed or 14% of Basic Salary + Dearness Allowance (in case the employer is Government) 10% of Basic Salary+ Dearness Allowance(in case of any other employer) - Whichever is lower
Section 80D	Medical Insurance Premium, preventive health checkup and Medical Expenditure	Individual Or HUF	Upto Rs 1,00,000
Section 80DD	Medical Treatment of a Dependent with Disability	Individual Or HUF	Normal Disability (atleast 40% or more but less than 80%): Rs 75000/- Severe Disability (atleast 80% or more) : Rs 125000/-
Section 80DDB	Medical expenditure for treatment of Specified Diseases	Individual Or HUF	Senior Citizens: Upto Rs 1,00,000 Others: Upto Rs 40,000
Section 80E	Interest paid on Loan taken for Higher Education	Individual	No limit (Any amount of interest paid on education loan) Upto 8 assessment years
Section 80EE	Interest paid on Housing Loan	Individual	Upto Rs 50,000 subject to some conditions
Section 80EEA	Interest Paid on Housing Loan	Individual	Upto Rs 1,50,000/- subject to some conditions
Section 80EEB	Interest paid on Electric Vehicle Loan	Individual	Upto Rs 1,50,000 subject to some conditions
Section 80G	Donation to specified funds/ institutions. Institutions	All Assesses (Individual, HUF, Company etc)	100% or 50% of the Donated amount or Qualifying limit, Allowed donation in cash Upto Rs.2000/-



Section 80GG	Income Tax Deduction for House Rent Paid	Individual	Rs. 5000 per month 25% of Adjusted Total Income Rent paid- 10% of Adjusted Total Income- whichever is lower
Section 80GGA	Donation to Scientific Research & Rural Development	All assesses except those who have an income (or loss) from a business and/or a profession	100% of the amount donated. Allowed donation in cash upto Rs.10,000/-
Section 80GGB	Contribution to Political Parties	Companies	100% of the amount contributed No deduction available for contribution made in cash
Section 80GGC	Individuals on contribution to Political Parties	Individual HUF AOP BOI Firm	100% of the amount contributed. No deduction available for contribution made in cash
Section 80RRB	Royalty on Patents	Individuals (Indian citizen or foreign citizen being resident in India)	Rs.3,00,000/- Or Specified Income- whichever is lower
Section 80QQB	Royalty Income of Authors	Individuals (Indian citizen or foreign citizen being resident in India)	Rs.3,00,000/- Or Specified Income- whichever is lower
Section 80TTA	Interest earned on Savings Accounts	Individual Or HUF (except senior citizen)	Upto Rs 10,000/-
Section 80TTB	Interest Income earned on deposits (Savings/ FDs)	Individual (60 Yrs or above)	Upto Rs 50,000/-
Section 80U	Disabled Individuals	Individuals	Normal Disability: Rs. 75,000/- Severe Disability: Rs. 1,25,000/-

Other than the earlier mentioned ways, few more points are also considered when it comes to staying informed for smart tax planning.

- **Staying Informed for Smart Tax Planning:** Keeping abreast of recent changes in tax laws is crucial for effective tax planning. Tax regulations are dynamic, and understanding the latest amendments ensures that your tax strategy remains relevant and optimized.

- **Digital Tax Planning Tools:** Simplify Your Finances with Technology In the digital age, leveraging technology can significantly simplify the tax planning process. Various user-friendly apps and online tools are available to assist individuals in organizing their financial information, tracking expenses, and identifying potential tax-saving opportunities. Consider exploring digital platforms that align with your financial goals and streamline the tax planning

- journey.
- **Additional Resources:** Empower Your Financial Journey In addition to staying informed, there are valuable resources that can empower your financial journey:
- **Government Websites:** Access official government websites, such as the income tax department's portal, for comprehensive and up-to-date information on tax regulations, forms, and announcements.
- **Tax Calculators:** Utilize online tax



calculators to estimate your tax liability based on current income, exemptions, and deductions. These tools can provide a quick overview of your financial standing.

- **Financial Planning Platforms:** Explore reputable financial planning platforms that offer insights, articles, and interactive tools to enhance your understanding of tax planning. These platforms may also provide personalized advice based on your financial profile.

- **Tax Advisory Services:** Consider consulting with tax advisory services for expert guidance tailored to your specific financial situation. Professionals can provide personalized strategies and help navigate complex tax scenarios.

- **Educational Courses:** Enroll in educational courses or workshops focused on taxation and financial planning. These resources can deepen your knowledge and equip you with practical skills to make informed financial decisions.

Conclusion

Navigating the Indian income tax system may seem daunting, but with a clear understanding of the basics and recent changes, taxpayers can optimize their taxation effectively. By choosing the right tax regime, making informed investments, and staying updated on tax laws, individuals can ensure a more tax-efficient financial journey. A well-thought-out tax plan not only saves money but also contributes to overall financial well-being.



LT COL DHARMJOT SINGH, SM

Lt Col Dharmjot Singh, SM was commissioned into 7 MARATHA LI in Mar 2003. The Officer has served in the varied terrain including CI Ops, HAA and UN Msn DR Congo. He has also served as Trg Offr at Regt Centre and GSO 1 (SD) at HQ DGAR. The officer is an avid mountaineer of India Army having successfully summited Mt Everest (8850M) and led Mt Dhaulagiri (8167M) as Dy Ldr. He is presently posted as Joint Director (Finance) with AGIF.



LIBERTY FROM LOAN TRAP: *Strategies for Achieving Financial Freedom*

By Col Satyarth Rai, Dir (Loans), AGIF

A **Dream** written down with a date becomes a Goal

A **Goal** Written down into steps becomes a **Plan**

A **Plan** backed by action, makes your **Dream** come true....



Army Group Insurance Fund (AGIF) is a welfare organisation that provides Insurance cover to its members of Indian Army and runs various welfare schemes to provide financial aid. One of the popular welfare schemes is Advances (Loans) provided by AGIF to make your **Dream** come true. House Building Advance, Conveyance Advance and Personal Computer Advance are

three such schemes popular among the members. Their equivalent in banking terms are House Loan and Car loans.

Loans themselves are not inherently bad, as they can serve as useful financial tools for achieving various **goals**, such as purchasing a flat or constructing a house, education of children, or buying your dream

car. For individuals navigating the complexities of financial management, loans often present themselves as a necessary evil—a means to bridge the gap between **desires** and **reality**. However, what begins as a lifeline can quickly transform into a suffocating web known as the **Loan Trap**.



Understanding the Lure of Loans: Why Do We Borrow?

The decision to take out a loan is often rooted in practicality and necessity. From financing education to purchasing a home or coping with unexpected expenses, loans offer a pathway to access funds that may not be readily available through personal savings or income. In the context of military personnel, unique challenges such as frequent relocations, family responsibilities, and the exigencies of service can further necessitate reliance on loans to meet financial needs. Loans can offer several benefits to individuals when used responsibly and strategically. Some of the key benefits of taking out a loan include:

Access to Capital. Loans provide access to funds that may not be readily available to individuals, allowing them to make essential purchases, investments, or cover expenses.

Financial Flexibility. Loans offer flexibility in managing finances by providing a lump sum of money that can be used as needed. This flexibility can help individuals navigate cash flow fluctuations or unexpected expenses.

Asset Acquisition. Loans enable individuals to acquire assets, such as homes, vehicles, or real estate properties, without having to pay the full purchase price upfront. This allows borrowers to spread the cost of the asset over time while enjoying its benefits immediately. In case of JCOs/ORs, AGIF provides home loan at 7%, whereas they are earning 7.1% from savings in the AFPP fund.

Investment Opportunities.

Loans can be used to finance investment opportunities that have the potential to generate returns higher than the cost of borrowing. This includes investing in stocks, bonds, real estate, or starting a business. However, this requires expertise in the investment field and in my opinion, military persons should avoid taking such risks without expert advice.

Tax Deductions. In case of Home loans, the interest paid up to two lakhs is tax exempted. This can result in potential tax savings for borrowers.

Emergency Fund. Loans can serve as a financial safety net during emergencies when savings are insufficient to cover unexpected expenses, such as medical bills or home repairs.

Consolidation and Refinancing. Loans can be used to consolidate multiple debts into a single loan with a lower interest rate or more favorable terms. Refinancing existing loans can also help borrowers save money by securing better terms or lowering monthly payments.

Achievement of Goals. Whether it's pursuing higher education, buying a home, starting a business, or traveling, loans can help individuals achieve their long-term goals by providing the necessary financial resources.

While loans offer several benefits, it's essential for borrowers to carefully consider their financial situation, assess the costs and risks associated with borrowing, and develop a repayment plan to ensure they can manage loans responsibly. Borrowing beyond one's means or taking on excessive loans can lead to financial difficulties and negative

consequences in the long run. Some associated drawback of taking excessive loans are as follows:-

Drawback of Taking Excessive Loans

Interest Payments. When you take out a loan, you typically have to pay interest on the amount borrowed. Over time, the interest payments can add up, increasing the total cost of the loan significantly. High-interest rates can make loans particularly expensive. Interest loans also vary with the kind of loan you are taking. Like, home loan will have less rate of Interest (ROI) than a personal loan. In a typical home loan, which runs for 18-20 years, you end up paying double the amount then what you borrowed.

Loan Burden. Accumulating too much loan can lead to a heavy financial burden, as you have to allocate a significant portion of your salary toward making loan payments. This can restrict your ability to save, invest, or spend on other essential expenses. As a thumb rule, your monthly payout on loan EMI's should not be more than 1/3rd of your salary. If it is beyond 50% of your salary then you are certainly running into the risk of getting **Loan Trapped**.

Risk of Default. If you're unable to make loan payments on time, you risk defaulting on the loan. Defaulting can damage your credit score, making it harder to qualify for future loans or obtain favorable interest rates. At AGIF we do not sanction new loans, if there is a default in previous loans. It can also result in additional payments (of additional interest on default amount), penalties,

and disciplinary action at unit level depending on the type of default.

Financial Stress. Managing multiple loans or dealing with high levels of borrowed money can cause significant stress and anxiety. Constantly worrying about meeting loan payments (EMIs) can affect your mental health and overall well-being. What is the fun of making so many houses, if you will not remain alive to live in them.

Loan Trap

Borrowing to cover existing loans or everyday expenses can lead to a cycle of loans, where you continually rely on borrowing money to make ends meet. This can perpetuate financial instability and make it challenging to achieve long-term financial goals. People can get **trapped in loans** for several reasons, often stemming from financial difficulties, lack of financial literacy, or unforeseen circumstances. The term '**Loan Trap**' generally refers to a situation where a borrower becomes stuck in a cycle of debt due to high-interest rates, fees, and other unfavorable terms associated with the loan. Here are some common ways individuals may find themselves **trapped in loans**:-

Financial Emergencies. A sudden financial emergency, such as a medical expense or marriage, may lead someone to take out a loan without fully understanding the terms or considering alternative options. Desperation to cover immediate expenses can lead to impulsive borrowing decisions at unfavorable rates.

High-Interest Rates. Loans with high-interest rates, such as personal loans or credit

card loans, can quickly become unmanageable, especially if the borrower struggles to make timely payments. The high cost of borrowing makes it challenging to pay off the loan principal, leading to a cycle of borrowing money. Remember old movies, where Bhiku Ram, poor farmer kept paying to his village Sahukar, but the loan never finished.

Limited Access to Traditional Banking System. Individuals with poor financial literacy or limited access to traditional banking services may turn to alternative lenders (Unit Baniya) that offer loans with unfavorable terms, such as higher interest rates or fees. These loans can be more accessible but also more costly and harder to repay.

Lack of Financial Literacy. Many people may not fully understand the terms and consequences of taking a loan, leading them to **Loan Trap**. Without a clear understanding of interest rates, fees, repayment schedules, and potential penalties, borrowers may find themselves in over their heads.

Overborrowing. Taking on too much loan or borrowing beyond one's means can lead to a cycle of borrowing to cover existing debt or everyday expenses. This can result in a situation where the borrower relies on loans to make ends meet, leading to a spiral of increasing loan and financial strain.

Unforeseen Life Events. Unexpected life events such as illness, divorce or a natural disaster can disrupt financial stability and make it difficult to meet loan obligations. In such situations, individuals may resort to borrowing more to cope with

the financial challenges, further exacerbating their loan burden.

Predatory Lending Practices. Some lenders engage in predatory practices, such as deceptive advertising, high-pressure sales tactics, or hidden fees, to exploit vulnerable borrowers. These practices can trap individuals in loans with unfavorable terms and make it difficult to escape the debt cycle. Recent action of RBI on Chinese loan apps has highlighted this issue.

How to Avoid Loan Trap

Careful consideration of financial needs before taking a loan, exploring alternative borrowing options with lower interest rates, understanding the terms of the loan agreement, and having a clear realistic plan for repayment can help you in avoiding the **loan trap**. It's essential for borrowers to understand the terms of the loan agreement and to borrow only what they can afford to repay.

Avoiding the loan trap involves careful financial planning, responsible borrowing habits, and proactive measures to manage loans effectively. Here are some strategies to help individuals avoid falling into a loan trap:-

Budgeting. Create a budget to track income and expenses, and allocate funds for essential needs, savings, and loan repayment. By managing finances effectively, you can avoid overspending and reduce the need for borrowing. Remember the Thumb rule, not more than 1/3rd of your salary in paying loan EMIs.

Emergency Fund. Build an



emergency fund to cover unexpected expenses, such as medical bills or house repairs, without relying on loans. Aim to save enough to cover three to six months' worth of living expenses. Emergency funds have to be saved in liquid instruments, from where you can withdraw in 24-48 hours notice. Remember your one crore plot will not help you with a medical emergency. It's good as a long term investment for future financial goals but certainly not to meet your emergency requirement.

Evaluate Necessity. Before taking out a loan, carefully consider whether the expense is necessary and whether there are alternative ways to finance it. Don't take out a loan, just because your friend is taking it. Avoid borrowing for discretionary purchases or luxuries unless it's within your means. Role of unit Cdrs and Junior leaders is also important in guiding the individual. Financial awareness must be spread through Sainik Sammelan and Central Roll calls. Junior leaders, since they are more in touch with other ranks, must advise them to borrow responsibly. Unit Cdrs while signing the loan application, must **interview** the individual to understand his financial requirement and **intended purpose of using the borrowed money**.

Comparison Shopping. Compare loan offers from multiple lenders to find the most favorable terms, including interest rates, hidden charges, and repayment options and penalties. Look beyond the initial loan amount and consider the total cost of borrowing over the loan term. AGIF offers the

advances (loan) at the lowest possible rate then the market. Details of various advances and rate of Interest is as follows:-

Type of Advance	Category	Max Loan amount	Rate of Interest	Max loan tenure
HBA (Purchase/ Constr)	Offrs	80 Lakh	7.5 %	20 Yrs
	JCOs	35 Lakh	7 %	
	ORs	30 Lakh	7 %	
HBA (Repair & Renovation)	Offrs	20 Lakh	8 %	
	JCOs/ORs	20 Lakh	7.5 %	
CA (New Car)	Offrs	20 Lakh	8.25 %	08 Yrs
	JCOs/ORs	10 Lakh		
CA (2nd hand Car)	Offrs	10 Lakh		06 Yrs
	JCOs/ORs	05 Lakh		
CA (Two Wheelar)	Offrs	10 Lakh		05 Yrs
	JCOs/ORs	02 Lakh		
PCA	All	01 Lakh	8.5 %	04 Yrs

Understand Loan Terms. Read and understand the terms and conditions of the loan agreement before signing. Pay attention to interest rates, repayment schedules, fees, penalties, and any other terms that may impact the cost of the loan. AGIF does not charge any prepayment penalties and you can make prepayment any number of times as when you are able to save money or receive arrears of allowances for your field tenure.

Avoid High-Interest Loans. Steer clear of loans with excessively high-interest rates or predatory lending practices, such as loans from unit Baniya, personal loans, credit card loans, or chinese loans apps. These loans can trap borrowers in a cycle of debt with exorbitant costs.

Limit Credit Card Use. Use credit cards responsibly and avoid carrying balances on high-interest cards. Pay off the full balance each month to avoid accumulating interest charges and falling into debt. You must activate the Auto Debit facility

for paying credit card balance to avoid late payment fees.

Debt Repayment Strategy. Develop a debt repayment strategy, such as the snowball or avalanche method, to prioritize and pay off existing loans systematically. Focus on paying off high-interest loans first while making minimum payments on other obligations. AGIF has the inward transfer facility for home loans. You can use this facility to transfer your bank home loan of high-interest rate to AGIF at a much lower rate.

Explore Additional Income Sources. Consider supplementing your income through additional resources like, spouse starting a business or part time job, rental income from house etc. Use additional earnings to accelerate loan repayment and bolster savings.

Seek Financial Education. Improve financial literacy by educating yourself about borrowing, budgeting, saving, and investing. Take advantage of

resources such as financial literacy courses, workshops, books, and online tools to make informed financial decisions. There is a requirement of financial literacy from school level on topics like saving, budgeting, investing, power of compounding, loan trap etc. **AGIF Journal** is a step in this direction. Keep it safe for future reference.

Seek Assistance if Needed. If you're struggling with a loan or facing financial difficulties, discuss with your buddies and seniors in the coy/unit. There is nothing wrong in sharing your financial problems with Senior JCO or Coy Cdr. With their vast experience, they will help you to tide over the problem. You may also seek assistance from a reputable financial advisor. He can provide guidance, negotiate with creditors, and help you develop a plan to manage loans effectively.

Individuals can avoid falling into the loan trap by following above suggestions and adopting responsible financial habits to maintain control over their finances. Before borrowing, it's advisable to carefully assess your financial situation, explore alternative options, and only borrow what you can afford to repay comfortably. Additionally, understanding the terms and conditions of the loan agreement can help you make informed decisions and avoid potential pitfalls. Feel free to contact AGIF for any assistance.

The journey to financial liberation from the loan trap requires diligence, perseverance, and strategic planning. By understanding the factors contributing to excessive loans, recognizing warning signs, and taking proactive measures, individuals can reclaim control of their finances and pave the way towards a brighter, loan-free future with the support of responsible institutions like AGIF.



COL SATYARTH RAI

Col Satyarth Rai was commissioned in Regt of Artillery in Mar 1999. The officer joined 66 Fd Regt as YO and later on Commanded 171 Med Regt. Officer has served as AQMG (Ops) in HAA Corps and had instructional tenure with Junior Command Wing of Army War College, Mhow. He is presently posted as Director (Loan) with AGIF.





How to Protect *Long Term Savings* from Inflation and NPS

By Sanjeeva Mathur, Finance Professional & Promoter,
Serene Waters Financial Education

As we all know, Inflation is the rate at which the general level of prices for goods and services is rising, leading to a decrease in purchasing power. It's a common economic phenomenon that affects everyone, everywhere. Across the globe today, people are labouring under the burden of price increases on everyday items. The worst inflation spike in decades, has come about, with the events that began with the coronavirus pandemic of 2020 and was compounded by the Russian- Ukraine war since 2022.

During this prolonged period, the challenge for

policymakers and central banks worldwide has remained the same; to tame inflation. The general approach has been to hike interest rates speedily and sufficiently, in an attempt to slow down economies and put the brakes on rising prices.



Country	CPI inflation% Jan 2024
Argentina	211 %
Venezuela	189 %
Sudan	72 %
Turkey	64 %
Zimbabwe	27 %

For example; In Argentina inflation surged past 200%, the rate of price increases is now at the highest in 32 years. Older people have stopped inviting friends. People buy potatoes not in Kgs, but 2 or 3 pcs, as required so they don't get spoiled. Parents are spending twice as much on diapers. The Peso was devalued by 50% in Oct and now 800 pesos is 1 USD. This has increased fuel costs by 60%.

Common people of these countries have seen their long-term savings erode relentlessly, against this rising inflation. This brings us to the question; How do we the "Aam Admi" here in India make sure we stay protected against inflation?

While the strength and robustness of India's Economy ensures that we face only single digit inflation, it is still imminently prudent to understand how to stay protected. What are the options?

We often hear stories of families who migrated during the 1947 partition. For most of them, their investments in Physical Assets like Real Estate & Gold came to their rescue. These were the only safe bet, since Financial Markets were practically non- existent or were in

their infancy in those days.

Coming to today's world, these two avenues of investment still continue to remain quite popular with most of us. However, when we look at the nature of liquidity of both Real Estate & Gold, it is quite clear that selling real estate becomes more challenging at times of need and specially in situations of general overall economic crisis, and hence becomes highly illiquid. On the other hand, while Gold is highly liquid, there is always the concern of its safe storage and protection.

This leads us to the question, of how do we get our assets to help protect us, against inflation and uncertainty. Fortunately for us, the answers lie in the variety of products available in our Financial Markets today. Our Financial Markets today are highly evolved. They are also quite safe against mal-practices, since they are tightly regulated & controlled by appropriate Regulatory Bodies. Let us look at a few products that we can benefit from.

Overcoming Liquidity in Crisis Situation

- **Investment in GOLD** as this is the best hedge against long

term inflation. In India we have the convenience of 'Sovereign Gold Bonds' (SGBs) where apart from capital appreciation that the investor receives, there is also a nominal interest @ 2.5% p.a. The final redemption with RBI is completely tax-free. This completely eliminates the hassles of storing & protecting physical Gold.

- **Diversification Across Global Markets** - Investors today can could invest in strong Global Economies. Like: US Equities – say Index funds of S&P 500 – 10-year CAGR is 12.67% in USD! This would not only grow your investments in USD but also protects against losing purchasing power of the local currency.

The S&P 500® is widely regarded as the best single gauge of large-cap U.S. equities. The index includes 500 leading companies and covers approximately 80% of available market capitalization.

One can invest in international markets through index funds in India.

Example of 10-year returns is tabulated below:-

Dates	S&P 500	USD-INR	Investment in USD	Investment in INR	Gains Net of Taxes
31-Jan-13	(3,315)	(54.88)	(1,822)	(1,00,000)	(1,00,000)
19-Jan-24	10,598	83.14	5,806	4,82,751	2,67,926
CAGR	11.17%	3.86%	11.14%	15.43%	9.40%
			Gains	3,82,751	
			Tax @ 30%	1,14,825	
			Net of Tax	2,67,926	



The returns would depend on the returns on equity in USA and INR-USD exchange rate.

The gains from international funds are classified under Non-Equity Funds and are added to the taxable income (salary or business) and taxed according to the individual tax slabs.

Other Options in Front of Indian Investors

- **Equity markets** – The SENSEX has given a CAGR of 15.6% since 1979. Passive investing through Index Funds can be used for strategic asset allocation that is

goal based, where investors have a 'Buy and Hold' strategy across a long-time frame. Index Funds are likely to give higher returns than large cap stocks at lower expense ratio. In the USA the AUM under passive funds has already overtaken AUM under active funds.

Investors should actively explore building part of their retirement corpus under Nation Pension Scheme (NPS). Apart from getting an additional tax deduction of Rs. 50,000 it allows investors to invest in a couple of modes.

Under Active Choice Mode - Maximum Equity exposure

permitted in NPS is 75% up to the age of 50 years. From the time you are 51 years of age, the maximum exposure to Equities allowed under NPS Choice will decrease by 2.5% every year till the maximum Equity Exposure drops to 50%. So, at 60, your Equity Exposure will be 50%.

Under Auto Choice Mode - Aggressive Life Cycle Fund (LC75) - Equity exposure of up to 75% till the age of 35 years. From your 36th year onwards, Equity allocation is decreased by 4% every year.

Scheme returns are available on www.npstrust.org.in/weekly-snapshot-nps-schemes

Pension Fund	Inception Date	AUM (Rs Crs)	Subscribers	NAV	Returns 1 Year	Returns 3 Years	Returns 5 Years	Returns 7 Years	Returns 10 Years	Returns Inception
Aditya Birla Sun Life Pension Management Ltd.	09-May-17	528.06	49,024	24.0674	24.38%	15.69%	15.91%	NA	NA	14.00%
Axis Pension Fund Management Limited	21-Oct-22	562.73	50,432	12.3320	23.47%	NA	NA	NA	NA	18.31%
HDFC Pension Management Co. Ltd.	01-Aug-13	32,138.72	18,19,098	44.7719	23.39%	16.43%	16.53%	15.60%	14.90%	15.39%
ICICI Pru. Pension Fund Mgmt Co. Ltd.	18-May-09	10,506.22	6,92,530	60.8063	27.60%	17.61%	16.78%	15.47%	14.59%	13.08%
Kotak Mahindra Pension Fund Ltd.	15-May-09	1,864.24	1,07,202	56.0810	25.84%	17.73%	16.83%	15.47%	14.65%	12.45%
LIC Pension Fund Ltd.	23-Jul-13	4,773.75	3,99,162	38.0401	23.15%	17.37%	15.77%	14.29%	13.47%	13.57%
Max Life Pension Fund Management Limited	12-Sep-22	144.79	10,526	12.1830	25.49%	NA	NA	NA	NA	15.71%
SBI Pension Funds Pvt. Ltd.	15-May-09	15,635.63	15,92,709	49.2357	23.73%	15.78%	15.24%	14.48%	14.05%	11.46%
Tata Pension Management Pvt. Ltd.	19-Aug-22	170.54	20,621	13.0648	26.33%	NA	NA	NA	NA	20.73%
UTI Retirement Solutions Ltd.	21-May-09	2,015.68	1,17,531	58.8513	25.11%	16.88%	15.78%	15.11%	14.52%	12.84%
DSP Pension Fund Managers Private Limited	26-Dec-23	9.73	412	10.1116	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	1.12%
Benchmark Return as on 19.01.2024					25.40%	17.37%	16.93%	16.18%	14.99%	

Therefore, in NPS not only your returns from Equity Asset Class are closer to the benchmark return but they are far higher than average inflation rates prevailing in India.

We can compare this with the current PPF rate of 7.1% on a 15-year product. While the returns in PPF are both tax free, guaranteed and completely secure, they are also lower because 85% of the money is invested in debt (mostly government securities). Investments in PPF also have a monetary cap every year. So, for investments beyond the PPF threshold limit, for long term asset allocation, equity is likely to provide very high returns.

Comparing returns from Equity Asset Class with PPF, small differences in returns impact long term returns significantly.

Asset Allocation	PPF (85% Debt)	Equity
Investment per month	5000	5000
Number of Years	15	15
Expected Returns	7.10%	15.00%
Amount Invested	9,00,000	9,00,000
Future Value	15,98,662	33,42,534
Number of times PPF Maturity Amount		2.09

On Equity the LTCG will be charged @ 10% over and above an exemption limit of Rs. 1 Lac available each year. LTCG is payable only to the extent of actual redemption and the rest of the fund continues to

grow. In the event the redemption proceeds are used to purchase house, these gains are tax-free u/s 54F up to a limit of Rs. 10 Crores.

To Summarize the Key Advantages of the NPS are following

- **Asset Allocation** – Under both active and auto choice the equity exposure gradually reduces towards the vesting age. This relieves the investors from regular rebalancing requirements.
- **Tax Benefits** - NPS programs provide a larger tax deduction of up to Rs 2 lakh in old Tax Regime. The advantage of NPS is that you may take a lump sum withdrawal of up to 60% of the whole corpus at maturity, with 40% of that amount being tax-free. Investors can have the flexibility of systematic withdrawal plan that is tax-free.
- **Lowest Total Expense Ratio** - NPS is the most cost-effective managed retirement fund, with a 0.1% management fee.

Overcoming Liquidity in Crisis Situation

In comparison with Physical Assets, Financial Assets provide more safety from mal-practises, due to regulatory controls. They provide flexibility in terms of liquidity, transaction cost, tax benefit, partial withdrawal, greater control on decision making and personal freedom, less litigation and interference, minimum maintenance and ability to move money across asset classes to take advantage of all opportunities that are available.



SANJEEVA MATHUR

Mr. Sanjeeva Mathur is a finance professional and the promoter of a financial education company "Serene Waters". He has over 30 years of valuable experience of creating, promoting and distributing financial products & services. Sanjeeva is a passionate speaker specially on Financial Planning and various topics under Capital Markets.

Sanjeeva is also engaged as an external faculty for conducting sessions on varied topics on Capital Markets with Securities Exchange Board of India (SEBI), Indian Economic Services (IES), Indian Corporate Law Services (ICLS), Indian Revenue Services (IRS) and other Government and Public services. Sanjeeva holds a Masters in Chemistry from Delhi University and is a Management Graduate from IIM Kozhikode.



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***Investors should consult their financial advisors if in doubt about whether the product is suitable for them.**

Scheme Risk-O-Meter



Investors understand that their principal will be at Very High Risk

Benchmark Risk-O-Meter



(It may be noted that risk-o-meter specified above is based on internal assessment. The same shall be updated as per provision no. 17.4.1.i of SEBI Master Circular on Mutual Fund dated May 19, 2023, on Product labelling in mutual fund schemes on ongoing basis).

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For detail terms & conditions of aatmanirbhar SIP. Please visit our website www.axismf.com

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Market
performances
change.
An **investment**
philosophy
shouldn't.



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सेना सामूहिक बीमा निधि

लाभ योजनाएँ

- ए0जी0आई0एफ0 (AGIF) एक अनिवार्य सामूहिक बीमा सह बचत योजना है जो निम्नलिखित उद्देश्यों को प्रदान करने के लिए रूपांकित की गई है :-
- सेवा में रहते हुए युद्ध / युद्ध जैसी स्थिति सहित सभी जोखिमों के लिये सेना के सदस्यों को जीवन बीमा प्रदान करना ।
- सेवानिवृत्ति / रिलीज अवतारण के समय एक मुश्त परिपक्वता लाभ (Lump Sum Maturity), वित्तीय रूप में प्रदान करना ।
- मासिक अंशदान और लाभ का प्रावधान

वर्ग	मासिक अंशदान			लाभ	
	बचत तत्व (₹)	जोखिम श्रेणी तत्व (₹)	योग (₹)	बचत तत्व	जोखिम तत्व (₹)
नियमित सेना				सेवानिवृत्ति पर एक मुश्त परिपक्वता प्रदान करता है।	बीमा आवरण और अशक्तता लाभ प्रदान करता है
अधिकारी	8,722.00	1,278.00	10,000/- प्रति माह		बीमा – 1 करोड़ अशक्तता – 25 लाख*
जेसीओ / अन्य पद	4,440.00	560.00	5,000/- प्रति माह		बीमा – 50 लाख अशक्तता – 12.5 लाख*
सेना डाक सेवा (प्रतिनियुक्त)					
अधिकारी	3,762.50	1,427.50	5,190/- प्रति माह		बीमा – 75 लाख अशक्तता – 25 लाख*
जेसीओ / अन्य पद	1,867.50	657.50	2,525/- प्रति माह		बीमा – 37.5 लाख अशक्तता – 12.5 लाख*
प्रादेशिक सेना (टीए)					
अधिकारी	38,244.00	9,756.00	48,000/- प्रति वर्ष		बीमा – 50 लाख अशक्तता – 15 लाख*
जे सीओ / अन्य पद	20,118.00	3,882.00	24,000/- प्रति वर्ष		बीमा – 25 लाख अशक्तता – 7.5 लाख*
सेना सुरक्षा कोर (डीएससी)					
जेसीओ / अन्य पद	1,646.50	943.50	2,590/- प्रति माह		बीमा – 37.5 लाख अशक्तता – 12.5 लाख*

* अशक्तता (Disability) राशि 100 प्रतिशत अशक्तता के लिए है। 20 प्रतिशत की अशक्तता तक आनुपातिक रूप से कम की जाती है और केवल उन लोगों पर लागू होता है जिन्हें IMB द्वारा सेवा से बाहर कर दिया जाता है और वो किसी भी पेंशन की प्राप्ति में नहीं हैं। नीती 01 मई 2018 से लागू है।

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Rupee Bonds Deal Maker of the year 2015 by Business World Magna Awards



Ranked No. 7 in the League Table for domestic INR Corporate Bonds for the year period Jan – Dec 2023.



- Ranked No. 4 non-institutional participant for NCD private placement for the year 2022-23
- Ranked No. 3 for Commercial Paper placements for the year 2022-23
- Ranked No. 2 for Public Debt Issues for the year 2022-23



THOMSON REUTERS

Ranked No. 3 in the India Debt League Table for the year period Jan – Dec 2023.



Ranked No. 1 in the Top Lead Managers of India Rupee Bonds League Table for the period 1st Jan – 31st May 2022.



Ranked No. 2 for Book runners of India Debt Capital Market for FY 2016-17.

Received BSE's Top Performer Award in Wholesale Debt Market (Corporate Bonds) - 8 years in a row (2011-12 - 2018-19) & 2021-22

Received BSE's Top Performer Award in Primary Market Segment (Debt Public Issue Bids - Members) for the year 2018-19, 2019-20, 2021-22

Received BSE's Top Performer Award in the Corporate Bonds Settlement for the year 2018-19, 2020-21, 2021-22

Received BSE's Top Performer Award in the Wholesale Debt Market (Government Securities) for the year 2020-21



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कैडेट्स

- **Stipend** मिलते समय सभी लाभ नियमित सेना अधिकारियों के समान।
- **Stipend** न लागू होने पर निम्नलिखित।

वर्ग	अंशदान	बीमा आवरण (₹)	अशक्तता आवरण (₹)	टिप्पणी
एनडीए एएफएमसी, टीईएस, सीएमई, एमसीईएमई, एमसीटीई के कैडेट	7200/- प्रशिक्षण की अवधि के लिये। अतिरिक्त 1355/- प्रति निर्वासित	15 लाख	15 लाख (100 प्रतिशत अशक्तता)	— 20 प्रतिशत से अधिक अशक्तता के लिये आनुपातिक रूप से समायोजित किया गया। — 20 प्रतिशत से कम अशक्तता के लिए अनुग्रह सशक्तता भत्ता प्रशिक्षण के प्रारंभिक वर्षों में ₹50,000/- और आखिरी प्रशिक्षण वर्ष में ₹1 लाख।
बीएससी (नर्सिंग) कैडेट	4625/- प्रशिक्षण की अवधि के लिये। अतिरिक्त 645/- प्रति निर्वासित	8 लाख	4 लाख	शर्तें उपरोक्त के सामान हैं।

बचत तत्व पर गुणवत्ता लाभ (MATURITY BENEFIT ON SAVINGS ELEMENT)

- सदस्य द्वारा सैन्य सेवा के दौरान किए गए योगदान के आधार पर एक मुश्त परिपक्वता लाभ का भुगतान सेना से सेवानिवृत्ति/ विमोचन/ अवतारण के समय अर्जित ब्याज के साथ किया जाता है।
- सदस्य की मृत्यु होने पर बीमा राशि के अलावा लाभार्थियों को परिपक्वता लाभ का भुगतान किया जाता है।
- एजीआईएफ इलेक्ट्रॉनिक निधि स्थानान्तरण (एन0ई0एफ0टी0) के माध्यम से परिपक्वता लाभ का भुगतान करता है और दस्तावेजों की समय से और सही प्राप्ति पर सेवानिवृत्ति के अगले दिन सदस्य के बैंक खाते में जमा किया जाता है।
- 15 वर्षों की वास्तविक सेवा पूर्ण होने के पश्चात, सदस्य अपनी सेवा अवधि में अपने बच्चों की शिक्षा 12 वीं और उससे ऊपर या विवाह के लिए 90 प्रतिशत तक परिपक्वता लाभ की निकासी कर सकता है।
- पहली निकासी के अतिरिक्त, जिन सदस्यों के पास सेवानिवृत्ति के लिए दो साल से कम समय है वे भी गृह निर्माण, मरम्मत या परिवर्तन हेतु परिपक्वता लाभ का 90 प्रतिशत तक निकासी कर सकते हैं।
- दो निकासी के बीच न्यूनतम अंतर छह महीने से अधिक होना चाहिए।

- कुल योगदान, बचत तत्व में योगदान का हिस्सा और 31 मार्च 2024 को सेवानिवृत्ति पर सदस्यों को देय राशि का विवरण इस प्रकार है।
- नियमित सेना के अधिकारी

योजना में शामिल होने की तिथि	31 मार्च 24 तक योगदान की गई राशि (₹)	बचत तत्व की ओर योगदान 31 मार्च 24 (₹)	बचत तत्व में अर्जित राशि 31 मार्च 24 (₹)
01 जनवरी 82	1103625.00	897628.70	2858293.52
01 जनवरी 83	1102425.00	896718.30	2799279.33
01 जनवरी 84	1100985.00	895807.80	2734989.07
01 जनवरी 85	1099305.00	894532.70	2666908.54
01 जनवरी 86	1097385.00	893075.50	2596264.40
01 जनवरी 87	1095225.00	891496.00	2524090.02
01 जनवरी 88	1092825.00	889674.60	2451245.30
01 जनवरी 89	1090425.00	887853.30	2385355.41
01 जनवरी 90	1087350.00	885690.30	2315444.20
01 जनवरी 91	1084050.00	883413.40	2249522.66

- नियमित सेना के जेसीओ/ अन्य पद

योजना में शामिल होने की तिथि	31 मार्च 24 तक योगदान की गई राशि (₹)	बचत तत्व की ओर योगदान 31 मार्च 24 (₹)	बचत तत्व में अर्जित राशि 31 मार्च 24 (₹)
01 जनवरी 90	536130.00	445178.61	1112210.07
01 जनवरी 91	534930.00	444310.17	1087116.22
01 जनवरी 92	533730.00	443441.73	1064758.39
01 जनवरी 93	532530.00	442573.29	1044932.66
01 जनवरी 94	531330.00	441704.85	1027427.04
01 जनवरी 95	530130.00	440836.32	1011961.36
01 जनवरी 96	528930.00	439967.76	998284.07
01 जनवरी 97	527730.00	439099.20	986214.45
01 जनवरी 98	525930.00	437760.16	970063.28
01 जनवरी 99	522930.00	435480.16	945385.33
01 जनवरी 00	519930.00	433200.16	923502.73
01 जनवरी 01	516930.00	430920.16	904108.67
01 जनवरी 02	513930.00	428625.76	886788.47
01 जनवरी 03	510930.00	426326.56	871184.00
01 जनवरी 04	506930.00	423154.60	851905.60
01 जनवरी 05	500930.00	418237.12	824477.67
01 जनवरी 06	491930.00	410860.96	786522.30
01 जनवरी 07	482930.00	403484.80	751503.57



टिप्पणी

- उपरोक्त आंकड़े केवल नियमित सेना के लिए हैं और अन्य श्रेणी के सदस्यों के लिए भिन्न होंगे।
- आंकड़े बोर्ड ऑफ गवर्नर्स (BOG) द्वारा तय किए गए और पीएओ/सीडीए द्वारा काटे गए निर्बाध योगदान और प्रत्येक वर्ष एजीआईएफ द्वारा भुगतान किए गए ब्याज पर आधारित हैं।
- बचत तत्व के रूप में अर्जित राशि का भुगतान सदस्यों को वास्तविक योगदान के आधार पर किया जाता है और रुकावटों के कारण भिन्न हो सकता है।
- आज तक भर्ती किए गए सभी सदस्यों के लिए समान तालिका मौजूद है। हालाँकि स्थान और प्रासंगिकता के लिए सीमित डेटा प्रदर्शित किया गया है।

गैर-पेंशनभोगियों के लिए सेना सामूहिक बीमा निधि चिकित्सा लाभ योजना

तत्कालीन विकलांगता लाभ योजना को दिनांक 01 मई 2018 से संशोधित किया गया है। अशक्तता लाभ लागू नहीं होगा, यदि :-

- सेवानिवृत्त पर मेडिकल बोर्ड द्वारा मूल्यांकन के अनुसार विकलांगता 20 प्रतिशत से कम है।

अशक्तता विभिन्न प्रतिशत के लिए देय चिकित्सा लाभ :-

अशक्तता प्रतिशत	देय राशि	
	अधिकारी (₹)	जेसीओ / अन्य पद (₹)
20	5,00,000/-	2,50,000/-
30	7,50,000/-	3,75,000/-
40	10,00,000/-	5,00,000/-
50	12,50,000/-	6,25,000/-
60	15,00,000/-	7,50,000/-
70	17,50,000/-	8,75,000/-
80	20,00,000/-	10,00,000/-
90	22,50,000/-	11,25,000/-
100	25,00,000/-	12,50,000/-

- वह व्यक्ति जो किसी भी प्रकार की पेंशन प्राप्त कर रहा हो।
- कार्मिक अपने स्वयं के अनुरोध पर पेंशन/मुक्ति पर आगे बढ़ रहे हैं।
- किसी व्यक्ति को अनुशासनात्मक आधार पर/ अवांछनीय आधार पर बर्खास्त कर दिया गया।
- कार्मिक को विस्तार दिया गया, जो निम्न चिकित्सा श्रेणी (एलएमसी), अस्थायी या स्थायी थे या विस्तार की शुरुआत की महत्वपूर्ण तिथि पर अस्पताल में थे और बाद में एलएमसी में जारी किए गए थे या विस्तारित कार्यकाल की अवधि के दौरान श्रेणी SHAPE-5 में अमान्य कर दिए गए थे।
- विकलांगता नशीली दवाओं की लत या शराब की लत के कारण होती है।
- नामांकन से पहले की उत्पत्ति की बीमारियाँ।
- विकलांगता प्रतिशत की व्यापक सरबंदी एजीआईएफ चिकित्सा लाभ योजना पर लागू नहीं है।

अनुग्रह राशि भत्ता

सदस्यों को भुगतान की गई चिकित्सा लाभ राशि के अलावा, उन लोगों को अनुग्रह भत्ता दिया जाता है जो 100 प्रतिशत अशक्तता के साथ अमान्य हो जाते हैं और चिकित्सा प्राधिकरण द्वारा लगातार उपस्थिति भत्ता प्रदान किया जाता है। अधिकारियों और जेसीओ/ ओआर के लिए क्रमशः 25 लाख रुपये और 12.5 लाख रुपये का कोष प्रबंधन के तहत संपत्ति (एयूएम) में अलग रखा गया है और 01 मई 2023 से एजीआईएफ द्वारा प्रबंधित किया जाता है। इस कोष पर ब्याज आय (प्रत्येक वर्ष एमएमएफ पर घोषित ब्याज के बराबर) प्रत्येक तिमाही में संबंधित सदस्य को प्रेषित किया जाता है। लाभार्थी की मृत्यु पर, कॉर्पस राशि वापस एयूएम में जमा कर दी जाती है। अनुग्रह भत्ते के भुगतान के लिए 100 प्रतिशत अशक्तता के अलावा अशक्तता पर विचार इस प्रकार हैं:-

- पूर्ण नेत्रहीनता (दोनों आंखें) ।
- अधरांगघात (Paraplegia) ।
- चतुरांगघात (Quadriplegia) ।
- मानसिक आघात, ट्राउमा संक्रमण पक्षाघात के परिणाम स्वरूप अपरिवर्तनीय मस्तिष्क क्षति जिसके कारण अचेत अवस्था या स्थायी निष्क्रियता या समकक्ष स्थिति होने का कोई कारण ।
- दोनों अंगों को क्षति, अर्थात् दोनों घुटनों के ऊपर या दोनों बाजुओं के केहूनी के ऊपर का विच्छेदन।

निर्वाह भत्ता योजना

सेना सामूहिक बीमा निधि के तहत सेवा के दौरान मृत कर्मियों के दो विशेष रूप से विकलांग बच्चों के लिए रु 12000/- प्रति माह भुगतान का प्रावधान है। पात्रता की शर्तें निम्नानुसार हैं :-

- उपरोक्त में अशक्तता की सीमा 40 प्रतिशत से कम नहीं होनी चाहिए और चिकित्सा प्राधिकारी द्वारा प्रमाणित होनी चाहिए।
- बच्चे जीविका कमाने में असमर्थ होने चाहिए।



- सेवा में रहते हुए सेवा कर्मियों की मृत्यु से पहले बच्चे की अशक्तता स्वयं स्पष्ट अर्थात् उजागर होनी चाहिए।
- योजना में शामिल अशक्तता इस प्रकार हैं :-
 - ऑटिस्टिक स्पेक्ट्रम विकार।
 - मस्तिष्क पक्षाघात।
 - मानसिक मंदता।
 - एकाधिक विकलांगताएँ:-
 - अंधापन।
 - कम दृष्टि।
 - कुष्ठ रोग ठीक हो गया।
 - श्रवण बाधित।
 - लोकोमोटर विकलांगता।
 - मानसिक बिमारी।

विस्तारित बीमा (EI) योजना

विस्तारित बीमा योजना (Extended Insurance Scheme), एक अनिवार्य समूह योजना है। बीमा आवरण का विस्तारित अवधि जिसके अंतर्गत सेवानिवृत्ति/



डिस्चार्ज/रिलीज के समय उनसे एक बार अंशदान लेकर एक विशिष्ट अवधि के लिए बीमा आवरण दिया जाता है। 31 मई 2022 से ये योजना इस प्रकार से हैं :-

वर्ग	अंशदान (एक बार प्रतिदेय) (₹)	बीमा आवरण (₹)	आवरण की अवधि
अधिकारी	1,60,000/-	15 लाख	अधिकारियों के लिए सेवानिवृत्त से 26 वर्ष तक या 80 वर्ष आयु तक जो भी पहले हो।
जेसीओ/जवान	68,000/-	7.5 लाख	जेसीओ/जवान के लिए सेवानिवृत्त से 30 वर्ष तक या 75 वर्ष आयु तक जो भी पहले हो।

सामाजिक सुरक्षा निधि (एसएसडी) योजना

- सामाजिक सुरक्षा जमा योजना (Social Security Deposit Scheme) मृतक कर्मियों के नाबालिग बच्चों और विधवाओं के हितों की रक्षा करती है। नाबालिग बच्चों की बीमा लाभ राशि राष्ट्रीयकृत बैंकों में ए0जी0आई0एफ0 द्वारा संचयी/गैर संचयी तरीके में तब तक निवेश किया जाता है जब तक वे वयस्क नहीं होते। विधवा की राशि, उनके अनुरोध के आधार पर भी ए0जी0आई0एफ0 द्वारा तीन साल तक की अवधि के लिए प्रबंधित की जाती है। यदि एफ0डी0 गैर-संचयी है, तो त्रैमासिक ब्याज का भुगतान किया जाता है। निर्धारित अवधि के अंत में, पूरी तरह से मूलधन/परिपक्व राशि का भुगतान लाभार्थी को इस पर लागू टी0डी0एस0 काटने के बाद किया जाता है। नाबालिग बच्चों के मामले में, उनके रखरखाव के लिए प्राकृतिक/कानूनी अभिभावक को त्रैमासिक ब्याज दिया जा सकता है।

सेना समूह बीमा योजना के लिए नामांकन

- सेना में शामिल होने पर, प्रत्येक ए0जी0आई0 सदस्य को लागू बीमा दावे की स्थिति में मृत्यु

लाभ प्राप्त करने के लिए व्यक्ति/व्यक्तियों को नामांकित करना अनिवार्य है। सभी सदस्यों को सेना समूह बीमा योजना पत्र संख्या ए/56271/36/एजी/इन्सयोरेंस (कोर्ड) दिनांक 26 मार्च 2019 को जारी किए गए दिशा-निर्देशों के अनुसार नामांकन करना आवश्यक/अनिवार्य है।

- पात्रता।** सभी मौजूदा सदस्यों (विवाहित और अविवाहित) को संशोधित नामांकन फॉर्म के अनुसार एक नया नामांकन करना होगा।
- वैधता।** पुराने नामांकन फॉर्म की वैधता 31 जनवरी 2020 से समाप्त हो गई है। सभी बीमा दावों (01 फरवरी 2020 से प्रभावी) को केवल संशोधित नामांकन फॉर्म के साथ होना चाहिए।

अविवाहित कार्मिक

- माता और पिता।
- अविवाहित कार्मिकों की दशा में आश्रित अवयस्क भाई एवं अविवाहित विधवा बहनें कर सकते हैं। माता-पिता दोनों के जीवित न होने पर ही नामांकित किया जा सकता है।
- यदि किसी व्यक्ति के परिवार में कोई नहीं है वह किसी व्यक्ति या व्यक्तियों या व्यक्तियों के

निकाय या कॉर्पोरेट निकाय के पक्ष में दूसरों के रूप में नामांकित हो सकता है।

- 100% शेयर एक नॉमिनी को दिया जा सकता है। शेयर को उसमें बताए गए व्यक्तियों के बीच भी विभाजित किया जा सकता है। लेकिन आंशिक शेयरों का कुल योग 100% से अधिक नहीं होना चाहिए।
- विवाहित कार्मिक**
 - कानूनी रूप से विवाहित पत्नी और बच्चों के नाम भाग- II आदेश के आधार पर व्यक्ति/इकाई/अभिलेख द्वारा डाले जाएंगे।
 - माता और पिता।
 - नाबालिग भाइयों और अविवाहित/विधवा बहनों को केवल तभी नामांकित किया जा सकता है, यदि पत्नी, बच्चे और माता-पिता दोनों जीवित नहीं हैं।
 - उत्तराधिकार के कानून के अनुसार बीमा लाभ का आनुपातिक हिस्सा विवादों के मामले में सभी पहली श्रेणी कानूनी उत्तराधिकारियों (मां, पति या पत्नी और बच्चों) को भुगतान किया जाता है।
 - विवरण की शुद्धता।** संशोधित नामांकन प्रपत्र में व्याख्यात्मक नोट्स भी शामिल किये गये हैं। गलत और दोषपूर्ण विवरण नामांकन को अमान्य कर देगा।

ऋण लाभ योजनाएँ

- गृह निर्माण अग्रिम योजना (House Building Advance - एच बी ए)**
 - एच बी ए राशि ₹80 लाख, ₹35 लाख और ₹30 लाख अधिकारी, जेसीओ तथा जवान के लिए है।
 - एचबीए के लिए ब्याज दर अधिकारियों के लिए 7.5% और जेसीओ/अन्य पद के लिए 7% है
 - अवधि 20 साल तक या वर्तमान रैंक में सेवानिवृत्ति से 6 महीने पहले, जो भी पहले हो, है।

- मौजूदा घर की मरम्मत/परिवर्तन पर अधिकारियों के लिए 8% और जेसीओ/अन्य पद के लिए 7.5% ब्याज दर है।
- घर मरम्मत/बदलाव के लिए ऋण की राशि ₹ 20 लाख तक है और ऋण चुकाने की अवधि 10 वर्ष तक है।
- घर बनाने के लिए जगह तथा उस पर मकान बनाने की अनुमति गृह निर्माण अग्रिम योजना के तहत हो गयी है।
- गृह निर्माण अग्रिम योजना के तहत घर की मरम्मत/बदलाव और घर के खरीद/निर्माण का लाभ साथ-साथ उठाया जा सकता है।
- वाहन अग्रिम (Convance Advance - सी ए) योजना**
 - ब्याज दर 8.25% है।
 - चार पहिया वाहनों के लिए अग्रिम राशि अधिकारियों के लिए 20 लाख और जेसीओ/अन्य पदों के लिये 10 लाख हैं।
 - चार पहिया वाहनों (ईवी) के लिए अग्रिम राशि अधिकारियों के लिए 25 लाख और जेसीओ/अन्य पदों के लिये 15 लाख हैं।
 - दो पहिया वाहनों के लिए अग्रिम राशि अधिकारियों के लिए 10 लाख और जेसीओ/अन्य पदों के लिये 2 लाख हैं।
 - संपूर्ण सेवा में अधिकतम तीन बार सीए की अनुमति है, जिसमें से चार पहिया वाहन अग्रिम केवल दो बार तक ही सीमित है।
- पर्सनल कम्प्यूटर एडवांस योजना (Personal Computer Loan - पी सी ए)**
 - ब्याज दर 8.5% है।
 - लोन की राशि 1 लाख है।
 - पहला लोन समाप्त होने पर दूसरा लोन भी लिया जा सकता है।



- **दस्तावेज में कमी।** आवेदन के साथ संलग्न दस्तावेजों में कमी की गयी है ताकि सदस्यों को आवेदन करने में असुविधा न हो।
- आर्मी पोर्टल के माध्यम से लोन (सी ए/पी सी ए) के लिए ऑनलाइन आवेदन किया जा सकता है।
- **ऋण राशि के प्रेषण के लिए खाता विवरण** सदस्यों को ऋण राशि केवल उनके वेतन खाते में भेजी जाती है। तदनुसार, सदस्यों को सलाह दी जाती है कि वे आवेदन के साथ अपने बैंक और वेतन खाते का विवरण अग्रेषित करें।

समय से पहले सेवानिवृत्ति के लिए अनापत्ति प्रमाण पत्र

जिन सदस्यों ने एजीआईएफ से ऋण लिया है और समय से पहले सेवानिवृत्ति पर जाने के इच्छुक हैं, उन्हें अपना बकाया ऋण वापस करना चाहिए और पीएमआर अनुरोध को संसाधित करने से पहले एनओसी (No Objection Certificate) प्राप्त करना अनिवार्य है।

एजीआईएफ नामांकन फॉर्म का संशोधन

एजीआईएफ नामांकन फॉर्म को 26 मार्च 2019 से संशोधित किया गया है। सभी सदस्यों से अनुरोध है कि वे जल्द से जल्द अपने एजीआईएफ नामांकन को संशोधित करें।

धोखाधड़ी करने वालों से सावधान रहें

एजीआईएफ से बकाया राशि या ऋण पाने के लिए मदद की पेशकश के बारे में सतर्क और कपटपूर्ण फोन कॉल से सावधान रहें। इस तरह के कॉल के शिकार न हों। कृपया किसी भी मामले में उल्लेख संख्या के तहत ऐसी कॉल प्राप्त होने पर एजीआईएफ से संपर्क करें। एजीआईएफ आपके भुगतान के लिए आपसे कभी भी किसी खाते में नकदी जमा करने की अपेक्षा नहीं करेगा।

निदेशक (कोऑर्ड) - सिविल नंबर 011-26142369, एस्कॉन 34439 (सैन्य)

निदेशक (क्लेम्स) - सिविल नंबर 011-26145709, एस्कॉन 39275 (सैन्य)

निदेशक (लोन) - सिविल नंबर 011-26142749 एस्कॉन 39274 (सैन्य)

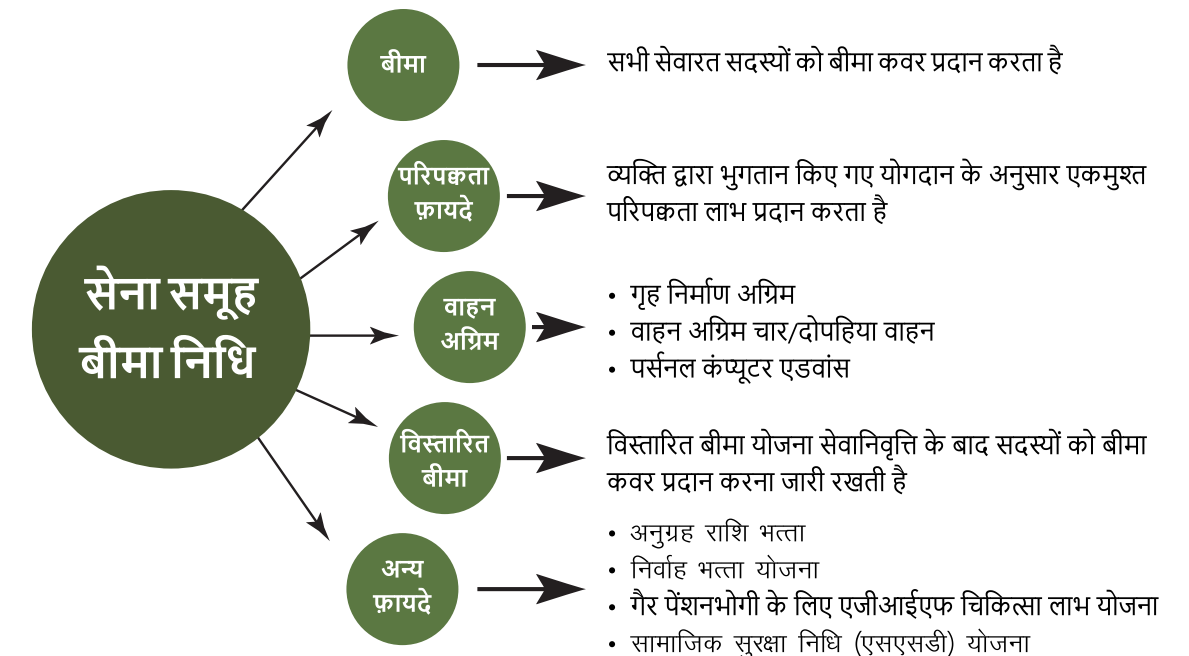


सेना समूह बीमा निधि (एजीआईएफ) की मूल बातें समझना

हवलदार/क्लर्क दलीप सिंह

स्वतन्त्रता आजादी के बाद कई युद्ध और विद्रोही अभियान हुए जिनमें बड़ी संख्या में सैनिकों ने देश की खातिर अपने प्राणों की आहुति दी। किसी बीमा कवर के अभाव में इन शहीदों के परिवारों को आर्थिक कष्ट से गुजरना पड़ा। इस प्रकार, किसी भी स्थिति में उनके परिवारों को आर्थिक रूप से सुरक्षित करने के लिए सैनिक कर्मियों के लिए समूह बीमा योजना की आवश्यकता महसूस की गई। सेना समूह बीमा निदेशालय ने 01 जनवरी 1976 को कार्य करना शुरू किया।

- एक ही छत के नीचे अनेक योजनाएँ।



“सैनिक सम्मेलन के दौरान सिपाही भोला राम अपने कंपनी कमांडर से कुछ प्रश्न पूछते हुए”



सर, हम एजीआईएफ योजना के बारे में समझना चाहते हैं...

बिल्कुल, हम बीमा योजना से शुरू करते हैं.....





योजनाएं

- **बीमा कवर।** एजीआईएफ सेना के सभी सेवारत सदस्यों को बीमा कवर प्रदान करता है। नियमित सेना अधिकारियों और जेसीओ/ओआर को क्रमशः ₹10,000/- और ₹5,000/- के मासिक प्रीमियम पर ₹ एक करोड़ और ₹50 लाख का कवर मिलता है। बीमा कवर के निम्नलिखित लाभ हैं:-
 - उच्च बीमा।
 - कम प्रीमियम मूल्य निर्धारण।
- आत्महत्या, एड्स और आकस्मिक मृत्यु सहित मृत्यु के कारणों की परवाह किए बिना बीमा कवर का भुगतान किया जाता है।
- बीमा कवर में युद्ध और युद्ध जैसी स्थितियों में होने वाली मौतें शामिल हैं।
- पीएओ/सीडीए द्वारा वेतन और भत्ते के माध्यम से सीधे प्रीमियम एकत्र किया जाता है।

सर, सुना है एजीआईएफ की लोन स्कीम सबसे बढ़िया है...



बिल्कुल सही, एजीआईएफ सबसे कम आरओआई पर लोन देता है और इसके काफी फायदे हैं...



ऋण योजनाएं

हाउस बिल्लिंग एडवांस (एचबीए), कन्वेन्स एडवांस (सीए) और पर्सनल कंप्यूटर एडवांस (पीसीए) न्यूनतम ब्याज दरों (आरओआई) और दस्तावेजों के साथ सदस्यों को दिया जाता है। एजीआईएफ की ऋण योजनाओं के लाभ निम्नलिखित हैं:-

- **गृह निर्माण अग्रिम**
 - आरओआई देश में किसी भी अन्य इकाई की तुलना में हमेशा कम है।
 - आरओआई निश्चित है (फ्लोटिंग नहीं) और ब्याज दर चक्र के साथ नहीं बढ़ता है; हालाँकि, जब भी एजीआईएफ अपनी ब्याज दरों को कम करता है, सभी पुराने ऋणों के लिए भी इसे कम कर दिया जाता है।
 - न्यूनतम दस्तावेज़ीकरण।
 - कोई प्रोसेसिंग और कानूनी शुल्क नहीं।
 - सिबिल स्कोर आवश्यक नहीं।
 - सीडीए(ओ) पुणे/पीएओ (ओआर) के माध्यम से ईएमआई वसूली।
 - किसी भी घातक दुर्घटना की स्थिति में बीमा।
 - कोई लॉक इन अवधि नहीं। कोई फौजदारी शुल्क नहीं।
- बिना किसी शुल्क के आंशिक भुगतान की सुविधा।
- एक सैन्य संस्थान होने के नाते संचार/ पत्राचार करना आसान है।
- ऋणों की त्वरित प्रोसेसिंग।
- एजीआईएफ में अधिकतम ईएमआई की अनुमति 240 महीने है।
- आर्मी डेटा नेटवर्क से आईटी प्रमाणपत्रों की ऑनलाइन डाउनलोड सुविधा।
- **वाहन अग्रिम** (चार पहिया और दो पहिया वाहन)।
 - आर्मी डेटा नेटवर्क के माध्यम से ऑनलाइन आवेदन जमा करना।
 - हाइपोथिकेशन की कोई आवश्यकता नहीं।
 - नई कार, पुरानी कार और दोपहिया वाहनों के लिए समान ब्याज दर, जबकि बैंकों/ वित्तीय संस्थानों में पुरानी कारों और दोपहिया वाहनों के लिए ऊँची दरें हैं।
- **पर्सनल कंप्यूटर एडवांस**
 - अग्रिम राशि ₹1 लाख।
 - पीसी सहित प्रिंटर, यूपीएस और अन्य सहायक उपकरण।



सर, हम एजीआईएफ परिपक्वता लाभ के बारे में समझना चाहते हैं...

एजीआईएफ हमें सेविंग एलिमेंट्स पे सबसे ज़्यादा रिटर्न देता है...



सर, सुना है एजीआईएफ रिटायरमेंट के बाद भी हमें बीमा लाभ मिलता है



बिल्कुल सही सुना है, आओ डिटेल् में समझता हूँ...



- **परिपक्वता के फ़ायदे** किसी सदस्य की सेवा पूरी होने पर एजीआईएफ व्यक्ति द्वारा भुगतान किए गए योगदान के अनुसार एकमुश्त परिपक्वता लाभ प्रदान करता है। सदस्य परिपक्वता निधि के लाभ निम्नलिखित हैं:-
 - 15 साल की शारीरिक सेवा पूरी होने के बाद, सदस्य अपने बच्चों की शिक्षा या शादी के लिए अपनी परिपक्वता राशि का 50/90% तक निकाल सकते हैं।
 - इसके अलावा घर के परिवर्तन/मरम्मत के उद्देश्य से सेवा के अंतिम दो वर्षों में 90% तक राशि भी निकाली जा सकती है।
 - चक्रवृद्धि ब्याज के साथ परिपक्वता लाभ का भुगतान।
 - बचत तत्व पर एंएफपीपी से अधिक ब्याज दिया जाता है।
 - बचत तत्व का सेवानिवृत्ति/मृत्यु/ मुक्ति के समय चक्रवृद्धि ब्याज के साथ भुगतान किया जाता गया।
- **विस्तारित बीमा (ईआई)**। ईआई योजना सेवानिवृत्ति के बाद सदस्यों को बीमा कवर प्रदान करना जारी रखती है। नियमित सेना अधिकारियों और जेसीओ/ओआर को क्रमशः ₹1,60,000/- और ₹68,000/- के एकमुश्त वापसी योग्य प्रीमियम पर ₹15 लाख और ₹ 7.5 लाख का कवर मिलता है। ईआई योजना के लाभ इस प्रकार हैं :-
 - किसी चिकित्सीय परीक्षण की आवश्यकता नहीं।
 - यहां तक कि निम्न मानक जीवन (निम्न चिकित्सा श्रेणी) को भी समान प्रीमियम पर समान राशि के लिए कवर किया जाता है।
 - दस्तावेज़ और ईआई दावा प्रक्रियाएँ सरलीकृत। दावे के लिए केवल तीन दस्तावेज़ यानी मृत्यु प्रमाण पत्र, NOK का पहचान प्रमाण और बैंक खाता विवरण आवश्यक हैं।
 - दावों पर जिला सैनिक कल्याण कार्यालय का समर्थन समाप्त कर दिया है।
 - ई-भुगतान प्राधिकरण पत्र (ई-पीएल) और ईआई प्रमाणपत्र सभी सेवानिवृत्त लोगों को ऑनलाइन भेजा जा रहा है।



हवलदार/क्लर्क दलीप सिंह

नंबर 14859911एल हवलदार/क्लर्क दलीप सिंह को 17 सितंबर 2012 को भारतीय सेना की सेना सेवा कोर में नामांकित किया गया। इन्होंने मुख्यालय ईस्टरन कमांड, मुख्यालय 87 माउंटेन ब्रिगेड और 5221 सेना सेवा कोर बटालियन में सेवा दी। एनसीओ वर्तमान में दिसंबर 2021 से आर्मी ग्रुप इंश्योरेंस फंड निदेशालय में तैनात है।



आर्मी ग्रुप इन्शुरेंस फंड से परिपक्वता (मैच्युरिटी से पूर्व) अग्रिम (एडवांस) मैच्युरिटी राशि निकासी के नुकसान

सुबेदार (क्लर्क एसडी) देवेन्द्र कुमार सिंह

आर्मी ग्रुप इन्शुरेंस फंड से परिपक्वता (मैच्युरिटी से पूर्व) अग्रिम (एडवांस) 50 प्रतिशत मैच्युरिटी राशि निकासी के प्रावधान का प्रस्ताव आर्मी ग्रुप इन्शुरेंस फंड के 53वें बोर्ड ऑफ गवर्नरस के सम्मेलन, जिसका आयोजन 02 मई 2008 को सम्पन्न हुआ था। उसके पश्चात सभी कमांड हेडक्वार्टर्स से सुझाव माँगा गया था। सभी कमांड हेडक्वार्टर्स से प्राप्त सुझाव के आधार पर यह निर्णय लिया गया कि आर्मी ग्रुप इन्शुरेंस फंड के सदस्य को परिपक्वता अग्रिम मैच्युरिटी राशि निकासी की सुविधा 01 जनवरी 2009 से लागू की जाए। परिपक्वता अग्रिम 50 प्रतिशत मैच्युरिटी राशि निकासी के लिए निम्नलिखित शर्त रखी गई:-

- आर्मी ग्रुप इन्शुरेंस फंड के सदस्य (ऑफिसर, सरदार साहिबान या फिर जवान) जिनकी सर्विस कम से कम 15 वर्ष पूरी हो चुकी हो।
- परिपक्वता मैच्युरिटी राशि निकासी की अनुमति पूरी सर्विस में केवल एक बार ही बच्चों की पढाई या फिर शादी हेतु निकाल सकते हैं।
- परिपक्वता मैच्युरिटी राशि निकासी की गणना निकासी के पहले माह की अन्तिम तारीख तक ही की जायेगी।
- शुरुवात में यह सुविधा केवल नियमित सेना

के सदस्य के लिए ही लागू की गयी थी। यह सुविधा आर्मी पोस्टल सर्विस (डिपुटेनिस्ट), डिफेंस सर्विस कोर तथा टेरिटोरियल आर्मी को लागू नहीं थी।

- परिपक्वता अग्रिम निकासी के आवेदन के साथ प्रोसेसिंग शुल्क के तौर पर ऑफिसर के लिए 400 रुपये तथा सरदार साहिबान और जवान के लिए 200 रुपये का ड्राफ्ट या चेक के द्वारा सेक्रेटरी, आर्मी ग्रुप इन्शुरेंस फंड के नाम से जमा करने का प्रावधान था।

परिपक्वता अग्रिम मैच्युरिटी राशि निकासी की सुविधा का संशोधन आर्मी ग्रुप इन्शुरेंस फंड के 55वें बोर्ड ऑफ गवर्नरस के सम्मेलन के दौरान जिसका आयोजन 21 अप्रैल 2009 को हुआ था, परिपक्वता मैच्युरिटी राशि निकासी की सुविधा आर्मी पोस्टल सर्विस कोर (डिपुटेनिस्ट) तथा डिफेंस सर्विस कोर के सदस्यों को भी 01 जून 2009 से लागू कर दी गई। इसमें रेगुलर आर्मी के सदस्य के जैसे परिपक्वता अग्रिम मैच्युरिटी निकासी की सभी शर्तों के अलावा केवल एक अतिरिक्त शर्त और जोड़ दी गई, कि इनका आवेदन कमांडिंग ऑफिसर/ ऑफिसर कमान के अनुमोदन के पश्चात उनके डाइरेक्टरेट द्वारा प्रतिहस्ताक्षरित/ अनुमोदित होने के बाद ही आर्मी ग्रुप

इन्शुरेंस फंड को भेजा जायेगा। तत्पश्चात ही उस आवेदन के उपर परिपक्वता मैच्युरिटी राशि निकासी की प्रक्रिया अपनायी जायेगी।

वर्ष 2017 के अप्रैल माह से परिपक्वता अग्रिम मैच्युरिटी राशि निकासी के प्रोसेसिंग शुल्क के तौर पर ऑफिसर के लिए 400 रुपये तथा सरदार साहिबान और जवान के लिए 200 रुपये के प्रावधान को समाप्त कर दिया गया।

अक्टूबर 2021 से परिपक्वता मैच्युरिटी राशि निकासी की नीति में एक बार फिर से 76वें बोर्ड ऑफ गवर्नरस के सम्मेलन, जिसका आयोजन 26 अक्टूबर 2021 को किया गया था जिसमें निम्नलिखित संशोधन कर दिया गया:-

- परिपक्वता मैच्युरिटी राशि निकासी की सुविधा पूरी सर्विस में अधिकतम दो बार कर दिया गया। पहले 50 प्रतिशत निर्धारित किया गया था जिसको बढ़ाकर 90 प्रतिशत तक कर दिया गया।
- एक परिपक्वता मैच्युरिटी राशि से दूसरी परिपक्वता मैच्युरिटी राशि के निकासी के बीच कम से कम 06 महीने का अन्तर होना चाहिए।
- पुराने मकान की मरम्मत हेतु भी 90 प्रतिशत अग्रिम मैच्युरिटी राशि निकासी का प्रावधान किया गया जो कि केवल आर्मी ग्रुप इन्शुरेंस फंड के उन्हीं सदस्य को लागू होगा जिनका सेवाकाल मात्र दो वर्ष शेष रह गया है।

वर्तमान में आर्मी ग्रुप इन्शुरेंस फंड द्वारा मैच्युरिटी राशि पर 8.10 प्रतिशत के वार्षिक चक्रवृद्धि ब्याज की दर से ब्याज दिया जाता है। सिविल एजेंसी से लोन लेने की तुलना में आर्मी ग्रुप इन्शुरेंस फंड से परिपक्वता मैच्युरिटी राशि निकालना बेहतर विकल्प है बशर्ते इस राशि का इस्तेमाल बच्चों की पढाई-लिखाई या फिर ऐसी जरूरत के लिए लिया जाए जो बेहद अनिवार्य

है तथा कही और से ऋण लेना बहुत महंगा हो। अनेक सदस्य आर्थिक/ वित्तीय बाजार की सरगर्मी में भावुक होकर इस राशि को निकाल कर कहीं और निवेश करना चाहते हैं। ऐसा करने से पहले यह अनिवार्य है कि सदस्य जोखिम और लाभ का सही आकलन करे। साथ ही कर (Tax) का भी आकलन जरुरी है। इन सभी मापदण्डों पर आर्मी ग्रुप इन्शुरेंस फंड (ए.जी.आई.एफ) परिपक्वता लाभ खरा उतरता है।

दूसरी तरफ कोई भी मेम्बर आर्मी ग्रुप इन्शुरेंस फंड से परिपक्वता मैच्युरिटी राशि निकालकर अगर उसे बैंकिंग सेक्टर या फिर दूसरे वित्तीय संस्था में इन्वेस्ट करता है, उस हालात में उसे आर्मी ग्रुप इन्शुरेंस फंड से मिलने वाले लाभ की तुलना में कम लाभ या फिर अपना मैच्युरिटी राशि भी गवा देने की संभावना बनी रहती है।



सुबेदार (क्लर्क एसडी) देवेन्द्र कुमार सिंह

सुबेदार (क्लर्क एसडी) देवेन्द्र कुमार सिंह 28 अगस्त 1996 को सेना में भर्ती हुये हैं। इन्होंने अपने 27 वर्ष और 05 महीने के सेवाकाल में विभिन्न रेजीमेंट/स्थापना (इस्टैबलिश्मेंट) में अलग अलग नियुक्ति पर पदस्थापित रहे हैं। जिसमें आर्मी भर्ती कार्यालय, भोपाल में भर्ती क्लर्क, 35 आर एण्ड ओ फ्लाइट कैं हेड क्लर्क, 510 एडी मिसाइल रेजीमेंट के पार्ट टू ऑर्डर सेल का इन्चार्ज की ड्यूटी का निर्वाहन कर चुके हैं। वर्तमान में 21 अक्टूबर 2020 से सुप्रिटेण्डेंट (मैच्युरिटी-3) के पद पर कार्यरत हैं। इनका चयन यूनाइटेड नेशन, सूडान के लिए वर्ष 2011 में हुआ था।



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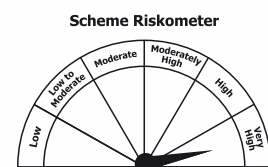
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GENERAL SECTION



ARMY WELFARE PLACEMENT ORGANISATION (AWPO)

- Army Welfare Placement Organisation (AWPO) is a welfare organisation established in May 1999, under the Ceremonial & Welfare Directorate, Adjutant General's Branch and is mandated to facilitate placements for Army Veterans in a second career. In addition to addressing the second career aspirations of the Army Veterans, AWPO also works towards job placements for Army widows and their wards in various organisations. AWPO is now **registered as a society** under the Societies Registration Act of 1860. Today, AWPO has a pan India presence with **17 regional offices** at all major cities and **54 placement cells** in various regimental centres spread all across the country.
- About 1200 Officers and upto 60000 Personnel below Officer Rank (PBOR) retire from the Army every year. This strength of this well trained and disciplined human resource of ex-servicemen (ESM) need optimum leveraging into the Civil/Corporate Sector / Government Organisations so that the experience and skills obtained by them during service are well utilized.
- **Methodology of Support by AWPO.** AWPO facilitates the army veterans, widows and wards in the following manner:-
 - **INTERACTIVE WEBSITE**- AWPO functions on an interactive and user friendly website **www.exarmynaukri.com**. This platform enables both the potential ESM employee and the employer to find a suitable job opportunity/ select a suitable candidate from any region across the country. It provides all placement related information to the veterans including online registration. The website gives out guidelines for making of CVs, has details of skill development courses and certifications, regular updates of current avenues available for our veterans are shared on the website which enables them to apply for various positions.
 - **CAREER COUNSELLING AND RESUME BUILDING** Career Counselling and Resume building in case of Junior Commissioned Officers (JCOs) / and Other Ranks is being done.
 - **OUTREACH** AWPO has been proactively reaching to various organisations/ corporate/ autonomous bodies to seek job opportunities and accordingly provide them suitable veterans.
 - **COACHING FOR GOVT EXAMS** AWPO facilitates appropriate coaching to retirees and potential retirees for Government Jobs at Formation and Regimental Centre level.
- **UPSKILLING** AWPO prepares ESM to be confident entrepreneurs, facilitate various Entrepreneurship/ self-help opportunities as also conducts training through various start-up subject matter experts.
- **INITIATIVES OF AWPO.**
 - **PLACEMENTS** Since its re-organisation as a society in year 2010, AWPO has placed **1959 Officers, 21142 JCOs and 99175 OR** in various corporate, educational institutions, autonomous bodies and Government/ Semi-Government Establishments.
 - AWPO has also secured a total of **1579 suitable jobs for widows and dependents**, enabling them to settle down in adversity.
 - **MoUs FOR BULK PLACEMENTS** AWPO has also entered into MoUs with Railways, Dedicated Freight Corridor Corporation of India Ltd (DFCCIL), Delhi Metro Railway Corporation (DMRC), Delhi Development Authority (DDA), Education Institutes such as Jawaharlal Nehru University(JNU), National Testing Agency (NTA), Staff Selection Commission and a number of such Organisations.



The aim is to provide jobs to larger number of ESM as close their residence as possible.

• **ENTREPRENEURSHIP**

OPPORTUNITIES To encourage and facilitate ESM to venture into entrepreneurship, trg has been organised for ESM in conjunction with a CSR partner by AWPO in various fields like Assembly and Maintenance of Solar Panels/ Lights, Jam preparation, Jelly and Ketchup processing, Maintenance of Electronic Vehicles, Online HR Recruitment, Market Research and IT awareness etc. These training capsules are being regularly organised at Regimental Centres and Formations. Entrepreneurship models like Safal outlets, Flipkart Agents, and Organic Farming are also being taken up by ESM. AWPO also created opportunity for Veterans to become Digital Entrepreneurs. This will create digital awareness and help them becoming Village Level Entrepreneurs

- **UPSKILLING** AWPO with its CSR partners has been carrying out up skilling of our Veterans as well as Widows, Wards and Dependents in IT and Soft skills, this will make them Industry ready and enable them secure jobs. Through AWPOs up skilling programs, veterans, widows, wards and dependents gain more than just technical and soft skills, they become part of a supportive community that fosters personal growth, networking, mentorship and empowerment. The association encourages collaboration and exchange of ideas among participants, further enriching their learning experience. AWPO has given training to more than 850 veterans in Entrepreneurship in various fields.

- **TRAINING FOR GOVERNMENT EXAMS** Conduct of courses through a Training Partner for preparing ESM in various Regimental Centres and Formations for various central and state government

examinations. Out of 1104 personnel trained so far, **498 personnel have cleared the examinations.**

- **OPENINGS OVERSEAS** AWPO is working with Foreign Industries for placement of Army Veterans abroad. This will give our veterans an opportunity to work overseas and gain valuable experience.
- Over a period of time, AWPO has established substantial credibility and aims at enhancing its placement figures and increase the satisfaction levels among the veterans.

Contact Us

Army Welfare Placement Organisation
Integrated HQ of MoD (Army)
Adjutant General's Branch/CW Dte
67, Maude Lines, Cavalry Road
Delhi Cantt – 110010
Tele No: 25675385/25671552
Website: www.exarmynaukri.com
E-mail: hq.awpo@awpo.in



WELFARE SCHEMES: ADJUTANT GENERAL'S BRANCH

Financial Assistance Related Schemes/ Initiatives

• **Children Education Concession.**

Govt of India, Min of Def vide their letter No 6(1)/2009/Edu. Concession/Ddt 13 Sep 2017 and letter No 6-1/2009 /Edu. Concession/ D(Res-II) dt 23 Mar 2018, grants Educational Concessions to the children of Armed Forces Officers, JCOs & Other Ranks Missing/ Disabled/ Killed in action. Tuition fees, hostel charges and transportation are fully reimbursed. Cost of book/ stationery upto 2000/- pa, cost of uniform upto 2000/- pa and clothing upto 700/- pa per student is also claimable.

- **Telephone Concessions.** This concession is given to Gallantry Award Winners, War Widows and Disabled Soldiers. All beneficiaries are entitled to get exemption from payment of registration and installation charges. Gallantry award winners are also exempted from payment of normal rental charges. A rebate of 50% on normal rental charges is applicable to war widows and disabled soldiers. They are also given priority under Non-OYT/ Special category for release of tele connection.

- **Rail Concessions.** Complimentary passes are issued by Divisional Railway Manager and Headquarters Office of Indian Railways as under:-

- **Gallantry Award Winners & Widows.** The Chakra Series gallantry Awardees and widows after their demise are facilitated with First Class/AC-2/ AC-3 Tier Complimentary Card Pass along with one companion in all express/mail trains.

- **Widow of Def Pers Killed in Action.** War Widows and Widows of Defence personnel killed in action against terrorists and extremists are facilitated with 75% concession for travel in 2nd class Mail/Express trains. For widows, attested copy of Pension Payment Order (PPO) and valid photo identity card issued by respective ZSBs/ KSB, are also required to be produced.

- **Financial Assistance to Officers & JCOs/OR** Financial Assistance incl Medical Distress Grant is provided from AG's Welfare Fund to give financial relief to all rks including ESM and their widows/ NOK/ dependents, when they are under distressed circumstances for their maintenance and subsistence. Cases of officers are dealt by Accts Section of CW Dte & cases of JCOs/OR (Physical Casualties) are dealt by CW-4. All cases of Battle Casualties are being dealt by DIAV. Application for assistance is processed on Form DD-40 along with copy of discharge book, original medical bills, occupation and income of grown-up children of the

petitioner and copy of last 3 months bank statement.

- **Investment Model Booklet.** AG's Branch has compiled a brochure on the "Investment Model" which will give some insight into multiple avenues and instruments of investment that are available in the environment. These booklets have been posted on Army Web under AG's Br/ DG DC&W/CW Dte page and can be downloaded from there.

- **Edn Related Schemes** (Subject to change, based on negotiations with Schools/ Colleges/ Institutions).

- **Prabal Army Super 50' (Free Residential Coaching Pqme).** The AG's Branch in collaboration with Centre for Social Responsibility & Leadership (CSRL) is running a flagship programme 'Prabal Army Super 50', providing free residential coaching to prepare selected wards of serving pers/ESM for NEET & JEE. Presently, there are three centres operational at Pune, Sukna and Beas.

- **Allen Career Institute.** Allen Career Institute offers coaching for Medical and Engineering Stream at subsidised rates for all wards and free coaching including boarding and lodging for selected 50 wards based on their All India Written Exam. Concession of 15% on Tuition Fees for wards of Officers and



JCOs/OR in pan India Allen Institutes and discount of ₹15,000/- for Wards of Battle/ Physical Casualties.

• Akash-Byju's Institute.

Aakash-Byju's Institutes are offers 60% scholarship on the Tuition Fee and Classroom Fee for CI 11th 12th & 12th passed for medical stream, CI 11th & 12th passed for engineering stream and CI 8th 9th & 10th for foundation classes. Free coaching (100% Scholarship) for top 30 meritorious students is also offered for two years Medical Course (CI 11th) and 30 toppers of Repeaters Medical Course (CI 12th passed) at Aakash Byju Centre in Kota.

• Resonance Eduventures.

Conducts All India free of cost screening test for wards for Army personnel who are appearing or have appeared in Class 10th exams. Top 50 students are invited to Kota to form a "SIGMA-50" batch. One batch each will be formed for Engineering and Medical entrance exams. Students will be offered scholarships ranging from 50% to 90% on tuition as well as hostel depending on their performance.

• Provns of Loan / Scholarship

• Education Loan.

Welfare Division of C&W Dte under AG's Branch has introduced "Education Loan Scheme" for wards all Serving Army Personnel for undergraduate and higher studies both for India and abroad. Loan amount is upto ₹10 lakhs @ 7% (reducing balance) for tenure of 05 years or upto 06 months before date of retirement. Application can be downloaded from Army Intranet in the AG's Branch/ CW Dte page.

• Sports Scholarship.

Sports culture amongst wards of serving personnel, sports scholarships have been introduced children achieving po-dium finish in National level sports (applicable for indl/ team/ Paralympics events) in recognised sports and games. Scholarship varies from ₹ 30,000/- to ₹ 01 lakh (for indl sports) & from ₹ 01 lakh to ₹ 03 lakhs (for team events)

• Med Related Welfare Initiatives.

• Palliative Care Centres (PCCs).

The Palliative Care Centres (PCC) cater to med care of serving personnel, ESM and

their dependents, suffering from life-threatening terminal ill-ness. It provides 'free of cost' medical care and aid to such disabled patients.

• Early Intervention Centres (EICs).

Early Intervention Centres (EIC) cater to identification of Children with Special Needs (CwSNs) at an early stage, and thereafter provision of 'free of cost' assessment and therapy towards the development of such specially-abled children.

• Paraplegic Rehabilitation Centres (PRCs).

Paraplegic Rehabilitation Centres (PRCs), are being operated for quadriplegic/ paraplegic pers from all three services; who sustain spinal cord injury on active service. The Centres provide care and medical aid including 'free of cost' boarding, lodging and financial rehabilitation to the patients.

• Locations.

There are Seven (07) PCCs, Ten (10) EICs and Two (02) PRCs are running under aegis of various HQ Comds. The locations are as under:-

Ser No	HQ Comd	Loc of PCC	Loc of EIC	Loc of PRC
(aa)	HQ Eastern Comd	Barrackpore	Kolkata, Guwahati	-
(ab)	HQ Western Comd	Delhi Cantt	MH, Jalandhar	Mohali
(ac)		Jalandhar	AH (R&R), Delhi	
(ad)	HQ Central Comd	Lucknow	Lucknow, Jabalpur	-
(ae)	HQ Southern Comd	Pune	Comd Hosp, Pune	Kirkee
(af)		Chennai	MH, Secunderabad	
(ag)	HQ Northern Comd	Jammu	166 MH, Jammu	-
(ah)	HQ South Western Comd	-	Jaipur	-

- **Eligibility & Admission Procedure.** Serving pers, ESM and dependents of serving pers and ESM. Applications need to be forwarded directly to concerned PCC/ EIC / PRC, under intimation to respective HQ Comd (Medical) and HQ Comd (A).

- **Concession by Reputed Universities/ Edn Institutes/ Schools.** List of universities/ institutes and schools offering various concessions are tabulated below:-

Ser	Name of University/ Institute	Contact Number	Email/ Website
(a)	Manav Rachna University, Faridabad (Haryana)	0129-4198600, 0129-4198100	info@mriirs.edu.in www.mriirs.edu.in
(b)	Jaypee University of Information Technology, Waknaqhat (HP)	01792-257999	www.juit.ac.in
(c)	Rai Kumar Goel Institute of Technology, Delhi-Meerut Road, Ghaziabad (UP)	1800120777755, 0120-2788273, 0120-2784224	deanse@rkgit.edu.in
(d)	University of Engineering & Management, Kolkata	033-23572059	vc@uem.edu.in www.uem.edu.in
(e)	Parul University, Vadodara (Gujarat)	02668-260300 02668-260307	info@paruluniversity.ac.in www.paruluniversity.ac.in
(f)	FLAME University, Pune	020-67906206 9823852818	enquiry@flame.edu.in www.flame.edu.in
(g)	Manipal Academy of Higher Education	0820-2922323 0820-2571201	dradm@manipal.edu registrar@manipal.edu www.manipal.edu
(h)	Indian Institute of Technical Training (IIT-T) (School of Nursing & Paramedical Sciences), Kartholi, Bari Brahamna, Jammu	01923-222798	Mdirector.iittjammu@gmail.com www.iittjammu.com
(i)	The Scindia School, Gwalior	0751-2480750	principal@scindia.edu www.scindia.edu
(k)	Pinegrove School, Dharampur & Subathu, Solan (HP)	01792-264106 01792-275690	darampur@pinegroveschool.com subathu@pinegroveschool.com https://pinegrove.in
(l)	Mussoorie International School (Uttarakhand)	0135-2632763 0135-2632007 0135-2630250	principal@misindia.org www.misindia.net
(m)	Hopetown Girls School, Dehradun (UK)	0135-6170800 0135-6170809	schooloffice@hopetown.in www.hopetown.in
(n)	Hopetown Girls School, Dehradun (UK)	0135-6170800, 6170809	schooloffice@hopetown.in www.hopetown.in
(o)	Lawrence School, Sanawar, Dist-Solan (HP)	01792-261208/ 261209	office@sanawar.edu.in www.sanawar.edu.in
(p)	Hayde Heritage Academy, Kotdwara (Uttarakhand)	01382-229876, 08954103100	ask@haydeheritage.com www.haydeheritage.com
(q)	United World Academy, Bangalore	7624981601	admin@uwn.org.in
(r)	Colonel Shambhoo's Defence & Sports Academy, Fatehpur Road, Sabalpura, Sikar (Rajasthan)	9352160507 9414037464	Training.cdsda@gmail.com www.scolshambhoos.com

Contact
Col, CW 3&4.

Email : qemwelfare-34@qov.in
Tele Mil: 35133, 35143 | Civ Tele: 011-23018110



DIRECTORATE OF INDIAN ARMY VETERANS (DIAV)

DIAV under the aegis of Adjutant General's Branch has remained relentless in its pursuit of its core focus area of providing *Single Window* welfare and grievance redress facility to our veterans, veeranganas and next of kin. Team DIAV has been resolute in its commitment towards the cause with absolute respect, care and compassion. Continuous encouragement and acknowledgment of our efforts by the esteemed fraternity infuses renewed vigour in our endeavours. DIAV is just coming out of its formative years and treading towards its consolidation phase.

We have undertaken new initiatives in our approach to outreach and delivery of care and support. Our website, the Indian Army Veterans Portal www.indianarmyveterans.gov.in has recently been upgraded, it is multilingual, one stop online platform on all matters concerning our veterans and NoK. Its unique

user-friendly features of careful compilation of relevant advisories, information, downloadable forms for grants along with option to **'Ask a Question'** & **'Register a Grievance'** are value additions in our responsiveness.

Further, **Veerangana Sewa Kendra (VSK)** has been operationalised within the premises of DIAV that was inaugurated by the President AWWA on 10 Nov 2022. VSK is a **tech-enabled Call Centre for outreach, info - dissemination, query-response and grievance-redress for Indian Army Veeranganas and NoK**, a step towards strengthening our *Single Window* approach. VSK staff comprises six Veeranganas who have come forward as enablers for the cause providing inherent connect and empathy with the target population. Within a short span of four months VSK has connected with over 2,60,190 Veeranganas/ NoK, registered 632 grievances and responded to 225 queries digitally

and over calls. Expansion of this facility is planned to cover all Army veterans shortly.

We immensely value the support of our noble intentioned citizens, corporate houses and other organisations that have partnered with us in our *sacred responsibility of taking care of our own*. We have facilitated resolution of pension anomalies resulting in over ₹ 10.50 Crores getting credited into the accounts of affected pensioners. Our new initiatives to enable our prospective retiree JCOs/ORs for dignified 2nd innings is manifesting into creation of a pool of certified Trainers and Assessors enabling the national skills ecosystem for better delivery of skills to empower our youth.

During the year gone by, DIAV interacted with some of our veteran achievers, who are making pathbreaking contributions in varying fields of *rural development*,

Naari Shakti, Social Engineering, Women Safety, Education, Agriculture, Sports, Atmanirbharta in Defence Sector, Ganga Rejuvenation & Green Initiatives, Employment Creation to shaping the youth. Consequently, providing multiplier effect in nation's growth, heralding *AmritKal*. Our veterans continue to uphold the moto, *'Country First Always'*. Thus, emerging true role model citizens of our nation. Our veterans continue to inspire generations!

With the announcement of OROP-II, surge in hoax calls, phishing attempts have been reported. There have been previous incidents where fake calls purportedly to many veterans and NoK were received with an attempt to deceive. Incidents of SMS followed by calls on the pretext of cessation electricity or tele or broadband services on account of outstanding bill as also for returning excess amount paid and winning of surprise lottery followed by asking the call recipient to provide OTP has led many to lose hard earned money. All our veterans and NoK to remain are advised alert from such dubious endeavors by miscreants. Remember, no Bank, AGIF, SPARSH/

PCDA, DIAV or genuine entity will ever ask for OTP or personal particulars. We urge you all to BEWARE!!!

AG's Branch Welfare Schemes through DIAV

- **Education Grant to Children for Higher Studies.** ₹25000/- and ₹50000/- for post graduation and professional courses respectively being provided to the children of Battle Casualty and Physical Casualty case.
- **Marriage Grant.** ₹ 1,00,000/- being provided for daughter marriage/ orphan. son marriage/ re-marriage of widow (Applicable for PC/ BC Fatal & BC (Dis) with 60% and above Disability and invalided Medically Bd out cases (IMB).
- **Computer Grant.** ₹ 35,000/- being provided as one time Computer grant to the children of Physical Casualty (Applicable after 1st degree course/graduation & above).
- **Mob Eqpt.**
 - Mod retrofitted Scooter (Second issue after 15

years) and Motorized Wheel Chair (Second issue after 07years) are being provided to BC & PC case under CSR initiative from Hero Motor Company Ltd and India Infoline Fin Ltd respectively.

- One time grant of ₹70,000/- and ₹40,000/- for modification of car and modification of bathroom respectively being provided to BC/ PC case.

You may contact DIAV Helpline for any issue at the undermentioned contact details:-

Service Pensioner (ESM)

- **Tele:** 01125664200
- **WhatsApp (Message Only):** 9910610866
- **Email:** veteranscell-army@nic.in

Family Pensioner (Veerangana/ NoK)

- **Tele:** 01125664100
- **WhatsApp (Message Only):** 9910964067
- **Email:** diav.vsk@nic.in

*Taking Care of Our Own,
No matter What!!*





Safeguarding Against Emerging *Cyber Threats* and Financial Frauds

By Col Kunal Sharma

India's rapid digitisation of its financial space has indeed brought about significant changes, including increased access to financial services and greater convenience for users. However, it has also exposed the financial sector to new challenges, such as scams and data breaches. In the fiscal year 2023, the Reserve Bank of India documented bank frauds exceeding Rs 302.5 Billion. From the pervasive rise of UPI-related frauds to the cunning schemes enticing victims with unrealistic investment returns, the financial realm has witnessed a diverse array of fraudulent activities. QR code scams, part-time job deceptions and the alarming emergence of courier scams targeting the youth have added new dimensions to the threat landscape.

"Pay your bill now or you will lose electricity"; the message reads and within no timeframe the money is gone. AI is likely to worsen this problem, giving malicious actors new ways to steal money online. Imagine receiving a fake call in a loved ones voice, asking for money. Imagine a deep fake video of yourself on social media asking for help and losing everything to the fraudsters. Young professionals including our service personnel have lost tens of thousands of rupees and retired elders including our veterans have lost life savings to criminals, who drew them in by falsifying data, hacking their accounts through malicious apps and drew money without any authorisation.

India's cybercrime hotspot Jamtara,

Jharkhand has been identified as the hub of all such criminal activities wherein they pocketed lakhs of rupees daily through credit card frauds. Cyber criminals operating out of villages referred to as "New Jamtara" also have been linked to thousands of complaints, which have been traced back to UP, Rajasthan and Telangana and the online thefts have amounted to hundreds of crores rupees. The fake accounts were created with forged cards of victims and even UPI accounts were activated online by using their identities after acquiring Aadhaar Card, Pan Card and Mobile numbers.

These fraudsters specialised in pilfering credit card holders' information, committed online

crimes by sending a deceptive link to the targets for converting their reward points into cash. Once the cardholder clicked on the link, the perpetrators impersonating as bank representatives would cunningly request their bank details to facilitate the money transfer. Once victims completed a Google form with their bank details, the culprits would swiftly siphon the funds, directing them into accounts overseen by their masterminds. The potential victims may also fall for trap phone calls or messages. Once victim called the number embedded in the message, they were told to download a screen-mirroring app on phones or computer systems. "Once it was done, the cheats acquired all the PINs, ATM passwords and CVVs and did the transactions as they wanted to .

Financial Scams in India

UPI Scam: The advent of UPI transactions marked a significant milestone in digital payments in India. However fraudsters adapted quickly, devising various schemes to exploit unsuspecting consumers. UPI related frauds posed a substantial threat to the Indian payment ecosystem, with tactics ranging from disguising requests as fraudulent cashback offers and QR codes to creating spoofed Virtual Payment Address (VPAs) for refunds and disaster financial support.

Bank Frauds including Digital Banking & Credit Card Scams: Bank frauds encompass a range of deceptive activities including loan frauds, cheque frauds, forged documents and unauthorized transactions, all contributing to significant financial losses for both financial institutions and individuals.

With the rising popularity of digital transactions, the occurrence of online banking and credit card fraud has become increasingly pervasive. Common tactics employed by fraudsters include phishing attacks, identity theft and fraudulent transactions utilizing pilfered card details.

Investment Scams: Investment scams continue to lure individuals with enticing opportunities that promise quick and guaranteed returns. These fraudulent schemes prey on people's aspirations for high returns and often involve fictitious companies or fake investment products. The perpetrators create deceptive websites enticing victims to invest in stocks or cryptocurrencies. Telegram and WhatsApp groups are utilized to mass-invite individuals for investment purposes, deceiving victims into believing they are making reliable investments in stocks, businesses or cryptocurrencies.

Courier Scams: A concerning trend in the form of a new courier scam is emerging, with cyber fraudsters specifically targeting young individuals, causing both worry and distress. These scammers reach out to victims, claiming that courier parcels, allegedly containing drugs or other illegal items, are being sent in their names to foreign countries. Residents, particularly young people are advised to verify any unexpected communication from courier services and to refrain from providing personal information or making any financial transactions without thorough verification.

Scams Targeting Elders: 'Phantom Hacker' scams involved imposters to gain access to someone's computer and personal information through technical support. A 24 year old

fraudster from Haryana has been sentenced to 51 months in prison by a US court for defrauding an elderly American woman for \$150,000 (Rs 1,24,33,642) through a computer hacking scheme. He tricked the target into giving them money through a pop-up notice that appeared on her computer screen. The notice explained that elderly woman had been "hacked" and instructed her to call a helpline number for support. She complied to the instructions and fraudsters directed her to remove cash from her bank accounts for safekeeping at the "Fed", resulting in her losing \$150,000 to the fraudsters. The fraudster participated in a wider scheme targeting elderly Americans nationwide, resulting in over \$1.2 million in total losses.

Hacking Swiggy Accounts: The fraudsters were arrested after the accused siphoned off money from the Swiggy account of targets through their Lazy Pay Account. The accused using the 'Interactive Voice Response System' (IVRS), hacked the Swiggy accounts of people and placed orders for grocery items through the hacked accounts and later sold them at a lower price.

"Pig Butchering Scams" by China: After the Chinese loan apps scam, the latest scam from actors in China is "Pig Butchering Scam" by phishing websites. Fraudsters are creating hundreds of websites and trading apps that look similar to the websites of Indian brokers to dupe people. In traditional pig-butchering scams, criminals pretend to cultivate a romantic or personal relationship with victims through dating apps or social media. After gaining their trust over weeks of virtual conversations, the fraudsters manipulate them into investing in phony cryptocurrency



investments. Once the criminals squeeze as much digital currency as they can out of the victims, they take off with the funds, sometimes robbing innocent people of their life savings. India has banned over 100 Chinese operated investment scam websites that have been preying on Indian citizens. These websites were found to be intricately linked to multiple bank accounts, with funds being transferred between accounts to confound investigating agencies. The money was converted into cryptocurrency to further obfuscate the trail.

Biometric Data Breach: Recently the personal information of 815 million Indians containing personally identifiable information, including Aadhaar cards was compromised and made available for purchase on the dark web. Biometric data, which includes unique identifiers like fingerprints, retina scans and facial recognition, is highly sensitive and has the potential to grant unprecedented access to an individual's identity. As biometrics are integrated into various aspects of our lives, from unlocking smartphones to accessing bank accounts, it becomes essential to establish clear regulations and safeguards.

iOS Trojan Stealing Facial Recognition Data to Break into Bank Accounts:

One of the reasons many people choose the iPhones over their Android counterparts is due to security. However, this misconception could be changing as the first ever Banking Trojan designed to target iPhone users has been detected. The Android trojan GoldDigger has now been modified with new capabilities that make it easier for this malware to drain victims' bank accounts.

The trojan's new variation has been dubbed GoldPickaxe, with versions specifically designed for both Android and iOS devices. After the installation on the phone, GoldPickaxe can collect facial recognition data, identity documents and intercepted text messages, which makes it easier to siphon off funds from banking and other financial apps.

Tiny Banker Trojan (TINBA): "Tiny Banker Trojan" also known as Tinba, is a type of malware specifically designed to steal financial information, such as banking credentials and credit card details from infected computers. It records every keystroke made on an infected system, captures usernames, passwords and other sensitive information entered by the victim. It intercepts data submitted through web forms, such as credit card details, social security numbers and answers to security questions. Tinba injects malicious code into the victim's web browser, allowing attackers to manipulate web pages, intercept transactions and alter account balances without the victim's knowledge. Removing a Tiny Banker Trojan can be challenging due to its persistence and stealth.

Hackers Take Control of Google Account: Cybercriminals have found a way to gain access to people's Google accounts without needing their password. The new exploit gives hackers continued access to Google services even after a user's password has been reset. Google accounts can be compromised due to a vulnerability in third-party cookies which are used by websites and browsers to track users and increase their efficiency. In addition, Google's authentication cookies help users save their login details and log in without having to re-

enter them. However, hackers have now found a way to bypass two-factor authentication and retrieve these cookies. In this case, Google recommends turning on Enhanced Safe Browsing in Chrome to protect against phishing and malware downloads.

Fraudulent SpyLoan Apps: One of the ways being adopted by fraudsters to lure potential victims is to provide lucrative offers such as quick loans with less paperwork. However, people while downloading such loan apps, unknowingly permit them to access contacts, photo albums and other sensitive data on phones. Contrary to the terms and conditions mentioned while approving loans, the apps without any notice increase interest rates and demand them to pay off the loan amount within a week instead of the pre-determined 90 days (minimum time frame). When a person defaults on instalments, the loan app developer illegally accesses the personal details such as photos, and videos and threatens to share them on social media platforms. Google's App Defense Alliance has identified 17 such SpyLoan apps operating in India. 12 million people have downloaded those apps and are reported to have faced harassment. After notifying the issue to Google, have already been taken down.

AA Kredit Amor Cash GuayabaCash EasyCredit Cashwow CrediBus FlashLoan Préstamos Crédito YumiCash	Go Crédito Instantáneo Préstamo Cartera Grande Rápido Crédito Finupp Lending 4S Cash TrueNaira EasyCash
17 SpyLoan Apps	

Government's Drive against Cyber Crime & Financial Frauds

Presently, when cyber attacks are intensively targeting the government institutions, the Indian government in 2024 budget nearly doubled the allocation for cybersecurity projects from Rs 400 crore in 2023-2024 to Rs 759 crore in 2024-2025. Majority of these projects have been taken up by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY). The government has taken strict actions against approximately 1.4 Lakh mobile numbers used for cybercrime as a measure to curb digital financial frauds.

- The Department of Telecommunication has analysed 35 Lakh Principal entities sending bulk SMSs. Out of these, 19,776 Principal entities involved in sending malicious SMS have been blacklisted and 30,700 SMS headers and 1,95,766 SMS templates have been disconnected till date.
- More than 500 arrests have been made, around 3.0 lakh SIMs blocked, 50,000 IMEI blocked and 592 fake links/APK and 2194 URL have been blocked since April 2023.
- Integration of Citizen Financial Cyber Fraud Reporting and Management System (CFCFRMS) platform with National Cybercrime Reporting Portal (NCRP) will facilitate centralisation of the platform to enable effective collaboration between police, banks and financial institutions, allowing for real-time monitoring and prevention of fraudulent activities.
- The banks and financial

institutions are also required to phase out the use of regular 10 digit numbers and shift to using specific number series as 140XXX for commercial or promotional activities as prescribed by TRAI.

- The Department of Telecommunication (DoT) has developed the AI & Facial Recognition Powered Solution for Telecom SIM Subscriber Verification (ASTR), an AI machine learning based tool to detect mobile connections taken on fake/ forged documents.
- Banks and financial institutions have also been instructed to conduct additional customer awareness and sanitisation programs and regional languages on the security of digital payments.

Protecting the Mobile Devices from Financial Frauds:

Protecting yourself from financial scams requires vigilance, awareness and caution. CERT-In has also initiated a "Cyber Swachhta Fortnight" in February 2024, aimed at securing cyberspace from botnets, which pose a significant threat to end-user systems. Here are some steps you can take to safeguard your finances:-

- Educate Yourself:** Knowledge is your best defense. Stay informed about common scams and fraud tactics.
- Verify Identities:** Be cautious when sharing personal or financial information. Verify the identity of anyone who asks for sensitive information.
- Use Strong Passwords:** Use strong and unique passwords for your online accounts, including banking and financial services.
- Enable Two Factor Authentication (2FA):** Whenever possible, enable 2FA for your online accounts.

- Be Cautious with e-Mails:** Be skeptical of unsolicited emails, especially those that ask for personal or financial information.
- Beware of Phone Calls:** Scammers often impersonate banks or government agencies over the phone. Do not provide sensitive information to callers who claim to be from such organizations.
- Protect Your Devices:** Keep your computer, smartphone and other devices updated with the latest security patches and antivirus software.
- Secure Wi-Fi Connections:** Avoid conducting sensitive financial transactions on public Wi-Fi networks.
- Check Your Bank Statements:** Regularly review your bank and credit card statements for any unauthorized or suspicious transactions.
- Research Investment Opportunities:** Be wary of investment opportunities that promise high returns with little risk.
- Report Suspicious Activity:** If you suspect that you've encountered a financial scam, report it to the appropriate authorities.
- In Case of Being Stuck in a Cyber Fraud- One must follow following steps:
 - Call Your Bank:** Notify your bank's customer service immediately. Report the incident and provide details of the fraudulent activity. Request them to freeze or block any compromised accounts or cards to prevent further unauthorized transactions.
 - Lodge a Complaint with National Cyber Crime**



Reporting Portal (NCRP): Go to the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal at <https://www.cybercrime.gov.in/>. If you don't have an account, register on the portal.

- **File a Complaint:** Lodge a detailed complaint, providing as much information as possible about the cyber fraud.
- **Visit the Nearest Cyber Police Station:** Report the cyber fraud to the local police, especially if there's a local jurisdiction

involved. Provide the necessary details to file an FIR.

- **Gather Evidence:** Collect all relevant documentation, including transaction records, emails, messages, and any other communication related to the fraud.
- **Contact CERT-In:** In case of a significant cybersecurity incident, you can also report the incident to CERT-In.



COL KUNAL SHARMA

Col Kunal Sharma was commissioned into the Intelligence Corps in Jun 2022. The officer has attended all mandatory professional courses and has also undergone the prestigious HCC and ISOC Courses. He is an alumunous of DSSC, Wellington. He has been an Instructor Class A in MINTSD, Pune. He has tenanted a Staff appointment of GSO-1 (Ops) in a field formation and Commanded in Intelligence unit in J&K. He is presently posted in FOS, AWC.

Conclusion

With the rise of technology and the continued economic growth evident in modern society, acts of fraud have become much more prevalent in the financial industry, costing institutions and consumers hundreds of billions of dollars annually. Fraudsters are continuously evolving their approaches to exploit the vulnerabilities of the current prevention measures in place. This has brought to light the weaknesses in the financial architecture and the need to re-evaluate the compliance standards, practices and culture.



Understanding Wills: A Quick Guide

By Manoj Kumar Narayanan

Life brims with uncertainty. In the midst of this, we spend the larger part of our lives, creating and growing our wealth. However, as **Benjamin Franklin** rightly pointed out, there are in life also two certainties. **"In this world nothing can be said to be certain, except Death and Taxes"**. Most of us, are quite concerned about at least one of them -Taxes; We plan how to avoid them completely or at least minimise or reduce them. What about the other certainty- Death?

In the various Seminars & 'Investor Education Programs' that we conduct, we always ask a question. "For Whom are we earning, saving & Investing?". The answer without fail, has always been- "For our Family & Dear ones". However, to the next question "So how many of us here have written a **"WILL"**. The shocking answer is always just one or two. Amongst the thousands of people

we have addressed, only a handful have a 'WILL' in place. This is a worrying paradox. Before continuing further, dear reader, please take a minute to answer these two questions. If you have a WILL in place, Congratulations to you! You can be proud to count yourself as being part of a minority of Indians who have acted with responsibility. Statistical estimates about the percentage of people in India who have a WILL in place, vary from as low as 1%, or in the most optimistic scenario not more than 10% of the population. We create Wealth, we protect and grow that Wealth all our lives, yet most of us do not plan the Transmission of that Wealth to our intended Beneficiaries. We have no proper plan for what happens after we depart.

Why is a 'WILL' Important?

Upon a person's demise, In the absence of a WILL, title to the

person's properties will immediately devolve according to the 'Laws of Inheritance' which vary according to the Religion and Region one is born in. These Laws merely determine who receives the property & in what proportion. This inevitably leads to big confusion and disputes. A WILL however allows one to determine exactly what and how much to give to whom. A Testator (person making the WILL) can provide for even a non- family member or a Charity. The Testator can also leave out any undeserving legal heir.

Let us understand with an illustration—

Person "A" a Hindu Male dies without a WILL. He leaves behind his **mother, wife and two children.** He leaves behind Assets: Bank Accounts, Fixed Deposit, Shares, Debentures, Mutual Funds, Jewellery, Motor Vehicles, Furniture and Fixtures,



Immovable Property - Land, Building, Flat, Shops, Office. The 'Law of Inheritance' applicable to him simply states that all the 4 heirs will get equal shares of the total property. Now who will take what / how much of each, this is an area of possible confusion & disputes. Everyone may be interested in the same asset etc. This could lead to expensive and protracted litigation. Which could be avoided if there is a WILL which clearly states what exactly and how much is to be given to whom.

It is estimated that in India's Civil Courts today, more than **66%** of all cases are related to inheritance disputes involving both movable & immovable property. A substantial number of these could have been avoided if a proper WILL had been left behind by the persons who passed away. The tragic backstory of each of these, is someone who toiled for a lifetime, creating wealth, but was just too busy to properly transfer it to the ones, it was intended for. The simple answer therefore, if we want to bequeath our wealth to our loved ones with clarity, instead of confusion, frustration & years of possible litigation is, we need to make a proper and clear **'WILL'**. The biggest reason for not making a WILL, we hear from people is **"I have clear Nominations for all my Financial Assets, and I have no real estate or jewellery, so where is the need for a WILL!"**.

Let us Clarify This

- **Nomination is not equal to Ownership** – Nomination only enables the assets to be transferred from the organisation (Bank, Life Insurance company, etc) to the Nominee smoothly. The **Nominee becomes only a caretaker of the assets.**

- **Ownership in the asset however, will pass as per the WILL** or in the absence of a WILL, as per applicable **'Laws of Inheritance'**.
- **So, if he is not a beneficiary as per the WILL or in its absence, by Law. A Nominee merely holds the asset as a Trustee** for the actual Beneficiary.

So having a Nomination in place, certainly is important as it makes the asset transfer from the Organisation easier, without too much of complicated paperwork. It does not however confer any ownership in the asset.

Hence Nomination is never a substitute for a WILL. However, in the case of AGIF, as per Army Order 4/91, the AGIF nomination is applicable unless riveted exclusively through WILL. In this reference, AO-4/91 reads as under:-

A "WILL" executed in general terms bequeathing all movable and immovable property may not be sufficient to revoke any nomination already registered with the Insurer. Where it is intended to bequeath monies payable under a life insurance policy to a person other than the nominee already registered with the Insurer, it should be specifically provided in the "WILL" in the following form:-

"I also revoke the nomination(s) made by me in respect of policy (s) of Life Insurance on my own life".

What Then is a 'WILL'?

While there are several types of WILLS, a 'WILL', in its simplest form, is a legal document that outlines the wishes of an individual regarding

the distribution of their assets & possessions after their demise. It serves as a testament to one's desires, ensuring that one's legacy is upheld according to one's wishes. A WILL becomes effective only after the demise of the person making it. **So just how difficult is it to create a 'WILL'?**

The surprising answer - Not too difficult at all, because:

- There is no specified format for drafting a WILL, nor is a lawyer really required.
- It does not have to be on Legal or Stamp Paper. Normal paper is also sufficient.
- It can be written in any language.
- A WILL can be typed out or even hand-written.
- A WILL is not set in stone. It can be revoked, cancelled, amended or totally changed any number of times before a person dies.
- A WILL does not even require to be Registered.

What is Important in a WILL are following:

- It should be made by a person of sound mind who is not a Minor as per Law. (18 years or older).
- The language in the WILL shall be simple, precise, unambiguous and clear.
- The WILL shall be signed by the Testator (person making the WILL) in the presence of at least 2 witnesses who are of sound mind and are not minors.
- The witnesses will also attest with their signatures to confirm that the WILL has been made by the Testator. The Witnesses are not required to know the contents of the WILL.
- The Witnesses / Attestors or their

spouses must not be beneficiaries in the WILL.

- The date of preparation of the WILL must be clearly indicated.
- The words "Last WILL and Testament of" should be used in the title to make it clear that the document is indeed the Testator's last WILL.
- Specific mention can be made that the Testator is of sound mental health and has not been coerced by anyone while making the WILL.
- WILL should clearly identify the testator's assets and specify how they are to be distributed among the beneficiaries.
- The Testator should appoint an 'Executor' responsible for administering the estate and ensuring that the terms of the WILL are carried out. Since the Executor plays a crucial role in probate proceedings and managing the distribution of assets, he or she should be ideally a person younger than the Testator and some one who cares about & feels the family's pain.

Types of WILLS

The normal **Testamentary WILL** is the most common type of WILL. There are others like **Joint WILL Mutual WILL** (created by two or more individuals usually spouses) - Conditional WILL (where the distribution of assets is contingent upon a specific condition being met)...etc.

There is also a Privileged WILL which is granted certain privileges under specific circumstances.

Privileged WILL:

- This is when any soldier, airman or mariner being employed in an expedition or engaged in actual

warfare, creates a WILL during active service or voyage.

- Privileged WILLS may be in writing, or may be made by word of mouth.
- It may be written wholly or in part by another person, and signed by the testator. In such case it need not be attested.
- The WILL may be written wholly by the testator, with his own hand. In such case it need not be signed or attested.
- If the soldier, airman or mariner has written instructions for the preparation of his WILL, but has died before it could be prepared and executed, such instructions shall be considered to constitute his WILL.
- The soldier, airman or mariner may make a WILL merely by word of mouth by declaring his intentions before two witnesses present at the same time.

Importance of WILLS

The importance of WILLS cannot be overstated as they serve several vital purposes:

- **Preservation of Legacy:** A WILL allows individuals to preserve their legacy and ensure that their hard-earned assets are passed down to their chosen beneficiaries, whether family members, friends, or charitable organizations.
- **Protection of Minor Children & vulnerable family members with special needs:** For parents with minor children, a Will provides an opportunity to appoint guardians who will care for and raise their children in the event of their untimely demise. So also, for family members with special needs. This can offer peace of mind and ensure their

well-being.

So Finally - When is the Right time to make a WILL?

The answer is **Today**.

If one is above 18 years of age and has any asset or possession, even if it is only an Insurance Policy, one must make a WILL at the earliest. Let's get started.



MANOJ KUMAR NARAYANAN

Mr Manoj Kumar Narayanan is a 'Summa Cum Laude' scholar in Law and an alumnus of the IIM- Bangalore. He is a Business Leader with over 30 years of rich experience across domains. He has Taught Law, CRM & Behavioural Economics at institutions of Higher Learning including the NISM (National Institute of Securities Management) as a visiting faculty.

He is a good & clear communicator with conviction that "Financial Literacy" is an empowerment for inclusive growth in society. He is constantly working to percolate awareness & knowledge about "Personal Finances" with clear focus on the area of 'Wealth Transfer'.



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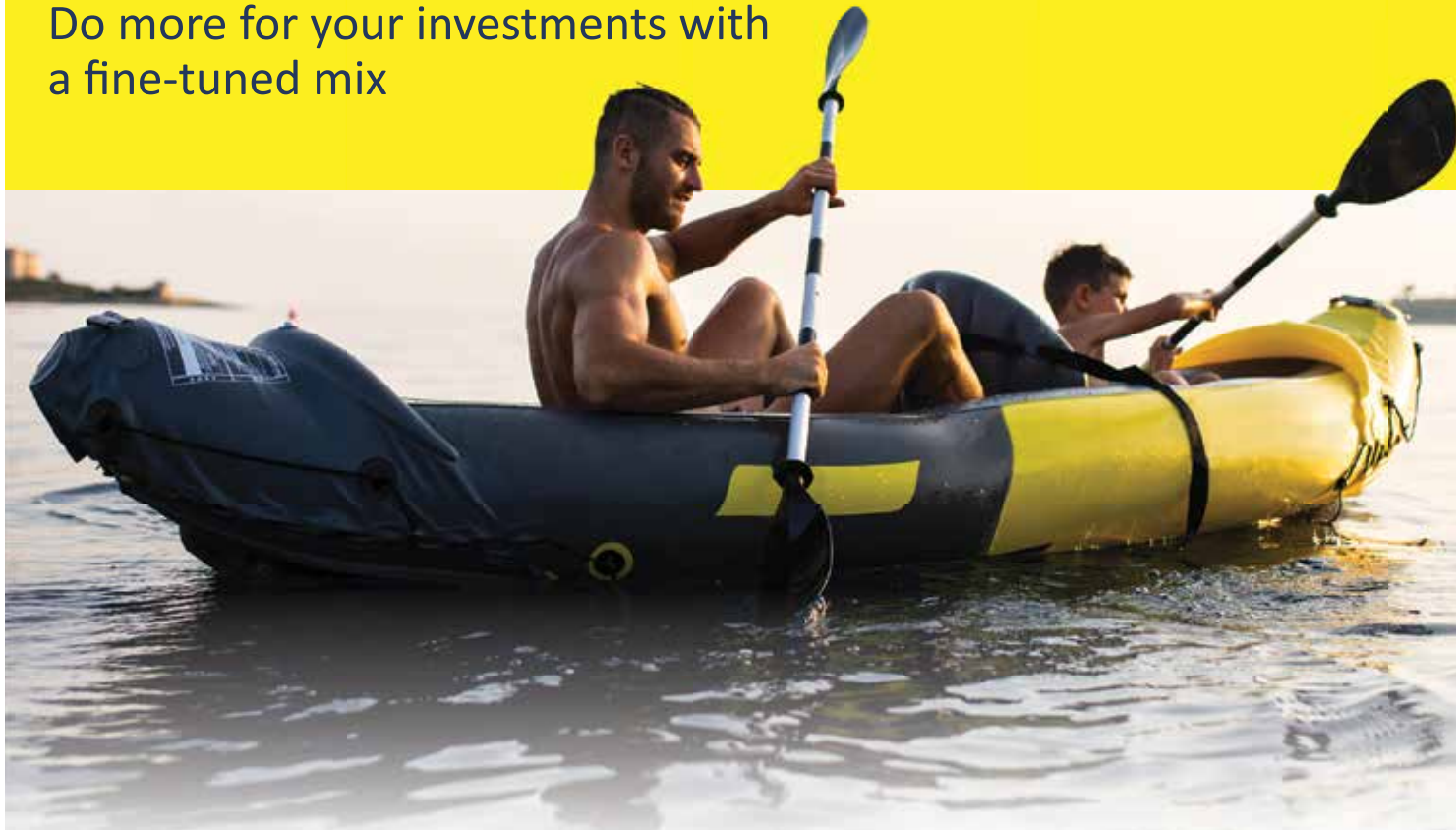
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Please refer Scheme Information Document (SID) for detailed Investment Strategy.

Name of the scheme

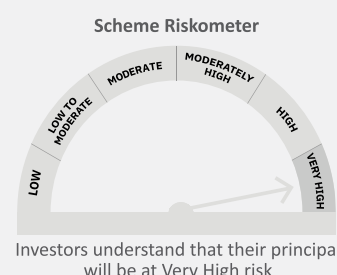
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- Long-term capital growth
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